



# Hindustan Times

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.



DROPPING SEPTEMBER 24

# MIVI ONE

We've made things before this.  
Things people carry every day.  
Now, we're about to make something new.

Not because the world needs another product.  
Because we believe it deserves a better one.

Our new chapter begins  
with something pretty powerful.

MIVI ONE (5G)



Snapdragon

Flipkart  
Unique



MINUTES





Amazing, Every Day

## Same Trust, Bold New Chapter

Every moment holds a chance to be amazed.

At Crompton, we turn those chances into little wonders through intuitive technology, thoughtful design, and the quiet promise that things will simply work.

Decades of care, refreshed with fresh energy, bring to you products that look stunning, make life easier and spark delight.

More Calm. More joy. More time to be amazed.

## Amazing, Every Day



1. A Crompton Subsidiary

Brands Of Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals Limited







# Hindustan Times

FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.



**BRICS SUMMIT**  
12 - 13 September 2026  
New Delhi, India

BUILDING FOR RESILIENCE, INNOVATION,  
COOPERATION AND SUSTAINABILITY

**People-Centric Approach**  
**Spirit of Humanity First**



CBC 14129/13/0014/2627



## INDIA IS READY TO HELP END UKRAINE WAR: EAM IN KYIV

Rezaul H Laskar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** India stands ready to help in all efforts to end the war in Ukraine, external affairs minister S Jaishankar told the top Ukrainian leadership in Kyiv on Thursday, days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged Russian President Vladimir Putin to move from "endless war to the end of war".

Peace efforts and the development of bilateral ties, including trade and investment, figured in discussions between the Ukrainian leadership and Jaishankar, the first external affairs minister to make a stand-alone visit to Kyiv. Jaishankar said on social media that approaches to end the conflict and deepen bilateral cooperation also figured in his meeting with President Volodymyr Zelensky. →P6

## Belgium, India boost ties; pacts on defence manufacturing inked

Rezaul H Laskar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Belgian counterpart Bart De Wever on Thursday agreed to bolster cooperation in defence, advanced technology and law enforcement and set a target for doubling trade in five years, as defence firms of the two countries concluded co-production agreements for a wide range of military equipment.

Modi and De Wever, the first Belgian PM to visit India in two decades, reviewed bilateral ties and held focused discussions on collaboration in semiconductors, chemicals, pharmaceuticals, fintech, advanced manufacturing, ports and logistics, and clean energy.

The creation of resilient supply chains to reduce dependency on China and more predictable trade arrangements, including leveraging the proposed India-European Union (EU) free trade



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Belgian counterpart Bart De Wever in New Delhi on Thursday.

RAJ K RAJ / HT

agreement, against the backdrop of geo-economic turmoil unleashed by US trade policies and tariffs also figured in the discussions between the two leaders.

Modi noted at a joint media interaction that food, fuel and supply chains have been impacted by uncertainty because

of conflicts in different parts of the world, and said democratic values and the market economy make India and Belgium natural partners. He also highlighted new opportunities presented by India's economy in this challenging environment.

"Defence and security cooperation continued on →8

## 'INDIA IS WAITING FOR COMPARATIVE TARIFF ADVANTAGE TO SEAL U.S. DEAL'

Rajeev Jayaswal

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Commerce minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday that finalisation of the interim Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) with the US awaits a tariff structure that gives India a comparative advantage over its competitors. "As soon as the US is able to give us the preferential rate in comparison to our competition, we will finalise the BTA and announce the final details," he said. →P11

## 3 YRS ON, MANIPUR STRIFE TOLL AT 306; 49 REMAIN MISSING: MINISTER TO HOUSE

Thomas Ngangom

letters@hindustantimes.com

**IMPHAL:** At least 306 people have been killed, and 49 are still missing in the ethnic violence that broke out in May 2023, Manipur home minister Govindas Konhoujam informed the state's legislative assembly on Thursday. The minister was responding to a query by Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) legislator Sapam Ranjan Singh. →P8

## Rapid warming

+2.2°C to +2.6°C

Nino 3.4 index reading, late July to mid-August (up from +1.5°C in May-July)

## 8°C above normal

Subsurface ocean temperatures in parts of the tropical Pacific in July and early August

## WHY THIS ONE STANDS OUT

First WMO update on the phenomenon to be called "unequivocal" in the agency's 50-year history. Peak intensity forecast: very strong

**WHAT INDIA CAN EXPECT**  
● Limited impact on the withdrawing southwest monsoon  
● Weaker northeast monsoon likely  
● Warmer-than-normal winter, with reduced rainfall

## 100% chance of El Nino lasting till Feb '27: WMO

Jasjeew Gandhiok

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** El Nino has firmly established itself and will intensify into a "very strong" event over the coming months, the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) said on Thursday, with a near 100% likelihood that it will persist through February 2027 — raising the risk of floods, drought and extreme heat across large parts of the world. For India, this may translate to a milder winter with reduced rains for Rabi crops, experts said. "Forecasts from WMO's Global Producing Centres indi-

cate an exceptionally high likelihood of nearly 100% that El Nino will persist through to February 2027," the agency said, adding that this was the first time a WMO update on the phenomenon had been "so unequivocal", reflecting strong agreement across its forecasting network. Fuelled by exceptionally warm ocean conditions across the tropical Pacific, El Nino is expected to strengthen further and peak towards the end of this year, with climate impacts continuing well into 2027, the update said.

Sea surface temperatures continued on →8

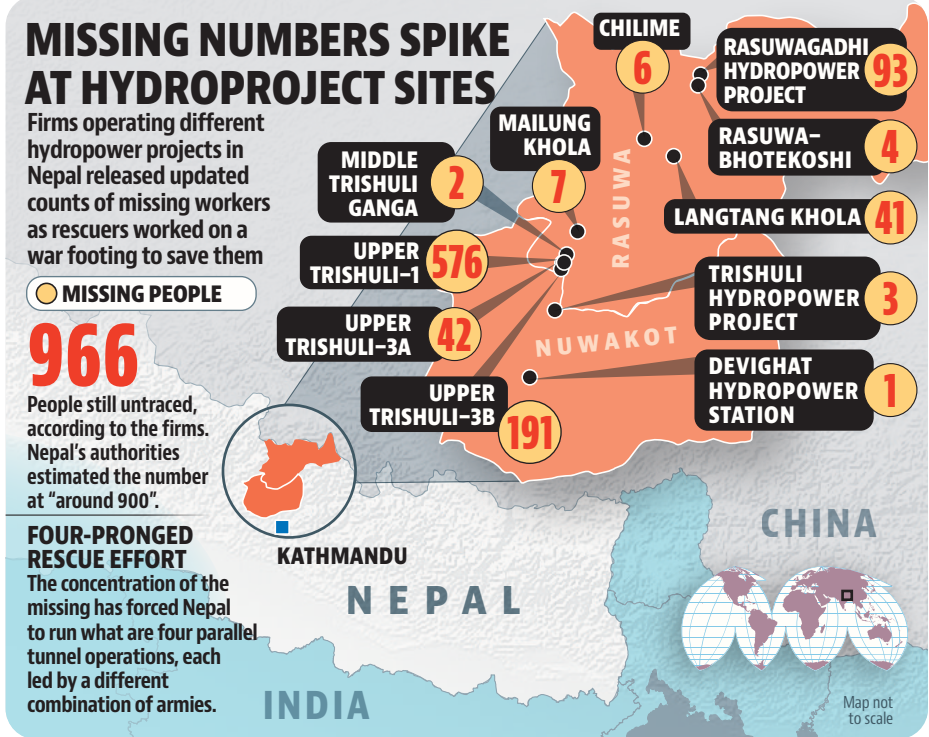
## IRAN TARGETS U.S. BASE IN KUWAIT AS IT MOURNS VICTIMS OF STRIKE

**DUBAI:** Iranian mourners carried caskets on Thursday at a funeral for victims of a US airstrike said to have struck a wedding party, and Tehran launched missiles and drones overnight at a US base in Kuwait, after the war's biggest escalation in more than a month.

Iranian officials say four people died and nearly 70 were wounded by a strike that hit a home during a wedding. State TV reported on Thursday that a fifth person, a 22-year-old woman, had since died in hospital. The US military said it was aware of the Iranian reports but maintained that it "never targets civilians". →P11

## NVIDIA TO BUY HUGGING FACE FOR \$13 BILLION

**NEW YORK:** Nvidia Corp. has agreed to acquire artificial intelligence startup Hugging Face in a transaction valued at about \$13 billion. The price includes an up to \$1 billion equity-based retention program for Hugging Face employees that join Nvidia. The chipmaker giant said it will keep Hugging Face's platform open and consistent with the startup's existing practices. →P11



## NOISE POLLUTION ACTIVIST SLAPPED ON CAMERA

Gayatri Vajpeyee

letters@hindustantimes.com

**PUNE:** An activist who has been campaigning against the use of loudspeakers and DJs during Ganeshotsav was slapped by a former Ganesh mandal president, while the former was speaking to the media on Thursday. The Pune police have arrested one person, identified as Santosh Chavan, in connection with the assault.

Vidyanand Bapat, 37, an active member of the Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti, has been vocal about the need to curb noise pollution during Ganeshotsav and has argued that traditional celebrations should not come at the cost of residents' peace and public health. →P5

## 38 RESCUED AFTER FERRY BREAKS DOWN OFF GATEWAY OF INDIA

**MUMBAI:** A ferry taking passengers on a 30-minute harbour cruise from the Gateway of India broke down approximately 1.5 nautical miles from the coast on Thursday evening after a rope got entangled in the propeller. All 38 people on board the 'Anwari', including four crew members, were rescued. Another excursion vessel, 'Azad Hind', which was near the stranded boat, towed 'Anwari' to safety by 9.30 pm. →P5

## 31-member JPC set up to examine FCRA bill

Saubhadra Chatterji

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Thursday constituted a 31-member joint committee of Parliament (JPC) to review the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, more than three weeks after the proposal to send the controversial legislation to a parliamentary panel was accepted in the Lower House.

A Lok Sabha bulletin added that Bharatiya Janata Party law-

maker Sanjay Jaiswal, a four-term MP from Bihar, is the chairperson of the panel. The panel has 14 BJP MPs, including Jaiswal and a total of 19 National Democratic Alliance lawmakers.

The Congress has five berths. The Samajwadi Party, Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) and Indian Union Muslim League have one member each. The Trinamool Congress and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam have two members each in the panel. →P6

## HC CLEARS REVIVAL OF 48-ACRE MILL IN CHUNABHATTI

**MUMBAI:** The Bombay High Court has paved the way for the revival of Swadeshi Mills and development of its 48-acre Chunabhatti land. The court allowed an appeal filed by Grand View Estates Pvt Ltd, a Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group company, and the Rashtriya Mill Mazdoor Sangh, who had challenged a single-judge bench's February order turning down a proposal to revive the mill company.

"We find that the revival of the company would be conducive and not detrimental to commercial morality and to the interests of the public," the court said. →P3

{ GLORIA STEINEM } 1934-2026

## Feminist icon who reshaped the fight for equality



Gloria Steinem in 1985

Reuters

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW YORK:** Gloria Steinem, the American writer, lecturer, activist and organizer who fought for gender equality and women's civil and reproductive rights for more than five decades, has died, her foundation said. She was 92 years old.

The co-founder and consulting editor of Ms. Magazine championed the feminist move-

ment from the late 1960s onwards and inspired generations of women.

She died on Wednesday, her foundation said in an Instagram post on Thursday.

"From reluctant spokesperson to a beacon of positive change, hers is a singular journey - an American leader who can speak to us all," film and theatre director Julie Taymor said of Steinem in a 2017 New York continued on →8

## THE INDIA YEARS THAT SHAPED A TRAILBLAZER

Feminist stalwart Gloria Steinem also had a deep association with India, where she encountered and absorbed many foundational ideas that later shaped her work. Long before Steinem became one of the most visible advocates for women's rights, she was a young American woman in her early 20s in Delhi, where she spent part of her time as a student at Miranda House. →P2



**SPOT THE LIC AGENT IN THIS PICTURE**



**WE BET YOU CAN'T BECAUSE HE IS VERY MUCH PART OF THE FAMILY!**

Connect with our agent today, who is your family friend, and discuss how life insurance can help you in meeting your financial goals and planned retirement.

Scan the QR code and Download My LIC App

Visit: [licindia.in](http://licindia.in)

Our WhatsApp No. 8976862090

Call Centre Services (022) 6827 6827

Follow us :  LIC India Forever | IRDAI Regn No.: 512

LICP12025-2634/Eng



## NUMBER THEORY

PART 2

### Is SIR cleaning up rolls or disenfranchising voters?

By Abhishek Jha and Roshan Kishore

The first part of this series looked at the key numbers from the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) results. The larger question, however, remains. What exactly is driving these results? A definite answer is not easy, especially because India's last published Census figures, from 2011, are now obsolete. The concluding part of this series will try to juxtapose some numbers and arrive at possible explanations.



READ: SIR's cut 118mn so far: More than Brazil's '22 poll turnout



#### 1 Higher deletions in larger urban centers support theories of duplicate entries in elector rolls

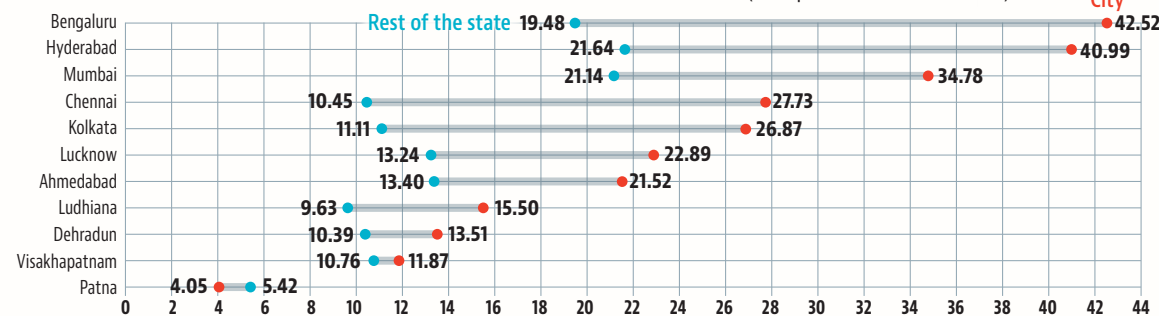
Delhi's draft SIR roll has underlined a theory HT first proposed in a story on March 2. India's largest urban centers, which are also likely to receive the highest number of migrants, have seen relatively larger deletions from rolls in SIR.

This could well be due to the fact that many workers were registered as voters in their native places as well as their place of migration, and chose to retain the former registration when SIR forced them to make a choice.



READ: 5 key trends that have emerged from SIR exercise

Net SIR deletions in urban centres versus the rest of the state (% of pre-SIR count of electors)



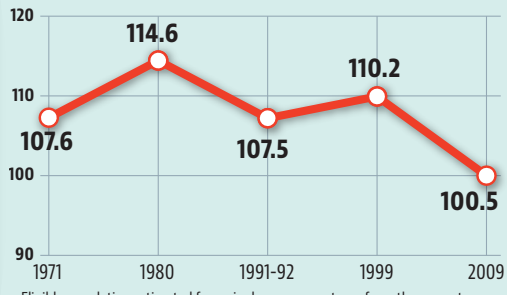
Change for Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Ludhiana, Dehradun, and Visakhapatnam is up to the draft roll; for Lucknow and Ahmedabad up to the final SIR roll; and for Chennai, Kolkata, and Patna up to the roll used in their latest assembly election. Mumbai and Bangalore include all constituent districts.

Source: ECI

#### 2 But an exact confirmation or rejection of this theory requires latest population data

Here is a rather contrarian and provocative take on the entire SIR controversy. If voters were indeed registered in more than one constituency and the SIR is actually getting rid of a lot of duplication, then it also means that India's adult population is lower than what we believe it to be. While this is not to discount possible wrongful deletions during SIR, if all 118 million were being deleted wrongly, it should have led to protests across the country. A comparison of India's previous electoral rolls with elector count in the closest election supports this theory, as the number of electors has always been higher than the voting-age population. The gap did reduce in the 2009 election, which followed an SIR exercise between 2002 and 2004 and drives to increase Electors Photo Identity Card (EPIC) coverage.

#### Registered electors in Lok Sabha elections as % of eligible population estimated from the nearest census



Eligible population estimated from single-year age returns from the nearest census. For example, the 2009 elector count is compared with the 20 years and above population in 2011, which would be 18 years and above in 2009. 1991-92 data excludes Jammu and Kashmir, where 1991 census was not conducted and accounts for the late election in Punjab. 1980 data excludes Assam, where 1981 census was not conducted.

Source: TCPD-IED

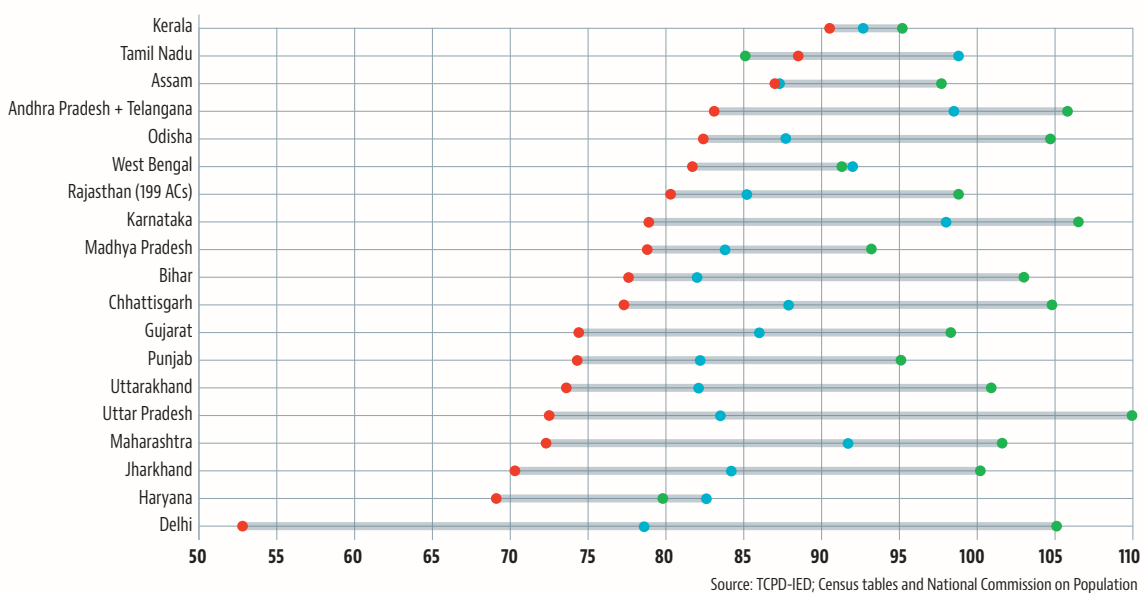
#### 3 Right now most states show a lower-than-estimated population voter count for even pre-SIR electors

This is the most perplexing part about the data. If the logic is that another SIR was needed to purge the rolls of deadwood entries, then the pre-SIR rolls should have shown a higher number of electors than what comparable adult population projections suggest. But all 20 states and UTs for

which a projection is available show a lower number of pre-SIR voters than their estimated adult population. The gap has only increased in the post-SIR numbers, as is to be expected. In 2009, state-wise elector numbers diverged from the census population data on both sides.

The gap between elector rolls and population in India (Numbers in percent)

● Pre-SIR electors as share of projected 2026 adult population ● Post-SIR electors as share of projected 2026 adult population ● 2009 Lok Sabha electors as share of 20 years and above population in 2011 census



Source: TCPD-IED; Census tables and National Commission on Population

What do all these numbers mean? Some of the deletions in SIR are entirely natural, such as those of people who have died. Some might be rooted in socio-economic factors, such as marriage and migration for work. Some might indeed be wrongful exclusions because of institutional oversight or the sheer scale of the exercise. We will

never be able to know their exact shares. But in a situation where most states were already reporting lower numbers of electors than population projections suggest; another possibility cannot be ruled out: India's adult population may be lower than the projections suggest. We will have to wait for the 2027 Census data to solve the mystery.

{ SPORT } OVERTAKES MITHALI RAJ

#### Smriti Mandhana becomes highest woman run-scorer



Indian batting stalwart and women's team vice-captain Smriti Mandhana scripted history on Thursday by overtaking legendary compatriot Mithali Raj to become the highest run-scorer in women's international cricket across all formats. The 30-year-old reached the landmark during India's Women's Asia Cup 2026 Group A clash against Hong Kong at the Dubai International Stadium on Thursday. Mandhana scored a 64-ball 124-runs knock, surpassing Mithali Raj's tally of 10,868 runs, and helping India win by 137 runs.

→P12

{ MY INDIA } AID TO SCHOOLS

#### 'Schools ensured nat'l song is sung in full after warning'



Schools in West Bengal started ensuring that the national song is sung in full after the state government threatened to stop aid, chief minister Suvenudh Adhikari said on Thursday. "We made it mandatory to sing all six stanzas of 'Vande Mataram' in schools. Initially there were objections...I said the government aid will be stopped. Then they budged," Adhikari said during an event in Kolkata. "I asked the education secretary to send me videos of schools. I noticed that everyone stood, but not all lips were moving. I told they will have to move their lips too." HTc

## Chronicling the India chapter of feminist pioneer's journey

Paras Singh

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Gloria Steinem, an American journalist, author and activist who was one of the most enduring faces of the feminist movement and the face of the reproductive and civil rights of women in the US, has died, her foundation announced Thursday. She was 92.

Steinem also had a deep association with India, where she encountered and absorbed many foundational ideas that later shaped her work. Long before Steinem became one of the most visible advocates for women's rights, she was a young American woman in her early 20s in Delhi, trying to work out what to do with her life.

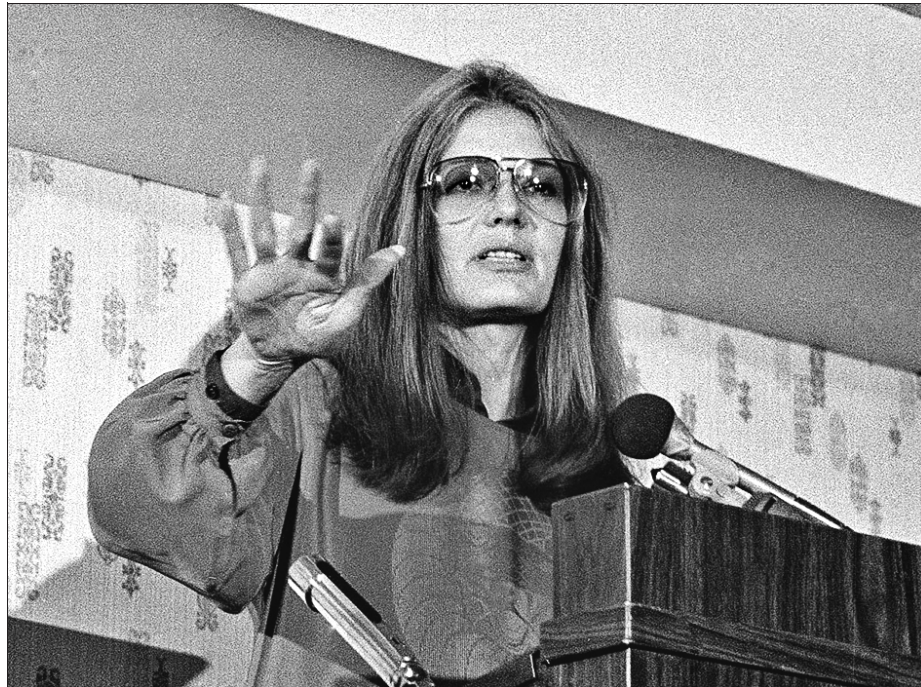
In 1956, shortly after graduating from Smith College, Steinem arrived in India on a Chester Bowles Asian Fellowship. She spent part of her time in Delhi as a student at Miranda House, then a relatively unusual destination for a young American woman travelling alone.

"Her association with Miranda House began during her formative years when she spent a year at the college. Her experience in India and her time at the college left a lasting impression on her worldview and her subsequent journey as a feminist and social activist," said the college, which also held a condolence meet on Thursday.

At Miranda House, her classmates taught her to wear a sari and navigate city buses. She took up odd jobs to support herself, including helping design sandals, writing promotional material and doing modelling assignments. She also featured as the face of a DCM (Delhi Cloth Mill) nylon sari advertisement.

But it was outside the classroom that India left its deepest mark. Steinem became associated with MN Roy's Radical Humanists and travelled with Gandhian activists. She worked in villages in what is now Tamil Nadu, alongside people involved in Vinoba Bhave's Bhodan movement, which sought to persuade landowners to give land to the landless. Her India experience exposed her to poverty, caste, inequality and grassroots organising.

For days, she trudged from village to village, everywhere encountering stories of atrocities and violence. "But mostly we just listened. To my amazement, long and emotion-filled meetings often ended with village leaders pledging to take no revenge on caste groups whose



Gloria Steinem in 1979. Two decades earlier, shortly after graduating from Smith College, Steinem arrived in India on a Chester Bowles Asian Fellowship.

members had attacked their group in neighbouring villages," she wrote in her 2015 memoir, *My Life on the Road*.

In her Substack dated March 21, 2025, Steinem pulled an excerpt from her essay titled "Doing Sixty" from her 1995 book "Moving Beyond Words". "When I reflect on the importance of India in my life, I think most of all of sitting on a New Delhi veranda in the 1970s, drinking tea with Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay, whose first name was (and is) enough to identify her in many countries of the world. Biographical dictionaries list her as a "freedom fighter, social worker, writer." In the 1950s, when I first met her, she was also in her fifties and already a legend for her leading role in the Freedom Struggle with Gandhi and Nehru—an activism for which she spent five years in British jails—and for her pioneering of the Indian handicraft movement.

Our meeting was arranged by my oldest friend in India, Devaki Jain, because we wanted to ask Kamaladevi's advice. Since Gandhi's nonviolent tactics were so well suited to women's movements around the world, we were thinking of studying his letters and writings, distilling what was most useful, and creating a kind of Gandhian/feminist handbook," she wrote.

Steinem shot to fame in America in the 1960s as a journalist, a writer, a political activist and a feminist. She went on to campaign for reproductive rights and became a social com-

mentator on issues such as prostitution, human trafficking and pornography. In 1971, she founded Ms. magazine, a feminist publication that focused on problems faced by women. She founded the National Women's Political Caucus in 1971 and later the Coalition of Labor Union Women and the Women's Media Center and Voters for Choice, which was aimed at promoting policies to maintain safe, legal and accessible abortion services for women.

In Delhi in 2007, she recalled spending two years in the country in the 1950s, saying that what she learned here remained a continuous influence throughout her life.

Steinem continued her involvement with Ruchira Gupta's Apne Aap Women Worldwide organisation, which works with trafficked women and children. While talking to Mint in 2014, she said that she was excited by the movement in the wake of the December 16, 2012 gang rape case. "It's what I love about India. The people will put up with only so much and then it will all erupt as they say enough," she had said.

"While laws are important, change must begin from the family. Human beings are profoundly sensitive to context. So patriarchal families will produce patriarchal sons and daughters who will be submissive," she also said.

More than five decades after young Steinem arrived in Delhi, the city hosted a very different version of her. In January 2014, at 79, she returned to the India

International Centre to launch "As If Women Matter: The Essential Gloria Steinem Reader." The event brought her together with some of India's leading feminists, including Ela Bhatt, Devaki Jain and Ruchira Gupta.

Steinem was born on March 25, 1934, in Toledo, Ohio, the second of two children to Leo Steinem, an itinerant antiques salesman, and Ruth Nuneviller, a journalist who was the first editor in-chief of the school newspaper at the University of Toledo.

Her parents separated when she was 10, and Steinem lived with and cared for her mother, who had suffered several nervous breakdowns. After graduating from Western High School in Washington, Steinem attended Smith College in Northampton, Massachusetts, where she studied government. On her way to India, aged 22, and recently having broken off an engagement, Steinem had an illegal abortion, she recounted in *My Life on the Road*.

Steinem was a leader of the so-called Second Wave of feminism, which started in the 1960s. After women in the US fought for, and won, the right to vote in 1920, Second Wave feminists sought economic and social equality in areas ranging from sexuality to the labour market.

But she faced criticism for her association with CIA. She acknowledged that a youth festival she had organised was largely funded by the agency but defended her motives.

## Meeting Gloria, in the afterglow of freedom

Devaki Jain

letters@hindustantimes.com

Incredible as it might appear, I met Gloria Steinem in 1956 at the home of one of the three young men who had built post-independence institutions such as the Cottage Industries Emporium—Lakshmi Jain, Som Benegal and DD Joshi. They were three bachelors aged around 30 or less, living in a lovely apartment in Golf Links in Delhi. The rent-free apartment was an offer by another one of those who had jumped aboard the wave of post-independence service to enable the refugees of Partition to be rehabilitated—Dr Shanthi

GLORIA LAID THE FOUNDATION FOR THE PUBLIC RECOGNITION OF WOMEN'S MIND, SKILLS, POLITICAL AND SOCIAL VOICES

Ghosh.

The post-independence atmosphere in Delhi was like a celebration, as so many people had jumped in to build so many of the institutions that we see and favour today. Visitors to India were eager to know more about this great revival, and thus to meet any of those

engaged in this reconstruction. One such area was the revival of handicrafts and handicrafts, and my "boy friend" at that time, Lakshmi Jain, was a star sought out by these foreigners.

So a mutual friend had brought Gloria to LC Jain's habitat in 1956; Gloria and I met and it was like magic. We decided to "hang out" together and wandered in Delhi, especially Old Delhi, talking and playing Holi when that happened and so on. While this aspect of her opinion is not well known, Gandhi and his ideas deeply impressed her. So when I visited New York in 1958, we went to the Gandhi statue together and laid flowers.

Seven decades have passed since that time and her apartment has been my home in New York for all these decades. Her work, her writings, her lifestyle are all so consistent: a sincere, deep regard for "difference," for humility—all wrapped in an amazingly rich intellect. We might grieve her passing, but to my mind, she has laid the foundation for the public acknowledgement of women's mind, skills, political and social voices.

Devaki Jain is an economist and writer who was awarded the Padma Bhushan for her contribution to feminist economics and social justice. The views expressed are personal



# HC clears development of 48-acre Swadeshi Mills; relief for SP Group

Division bench says revival would benefit mill workers who “endured tremendous loss and suffering”

HT Correspondent  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The Bombay High Court has paved the way for the revival of Swadeshi Mills and development of its 48-acre Chunabhathi land, bringing to an end a prolonged legal battle over the fate of one of Mumbai's largest erstwhile textile mills.

A division bench of justices AS Gadkari and Kamal Khata on Wednesday allowed an appeal filed by Grand View Estates Pvt Ltd, a Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group company, and the Rashtriya Mill Mazdoor Sangh (RMMS), challenging a single-judge bench's February order

turning down a proposal to revive the textile mill company and halt its liquidation.

“We find that the revival of the company would be conducive and not detrimental to commercial morality and to the interests of the public at large,” the division bench said. It added that the revival of Swadeshi Mills would benefit 2,834 mill workers, who had “endured tremendous loss and suffering for over two decades”.

Swadeshi Mills Company Ltd was one of Mumbai's prominent textile mills, founded by Jamsetji Tata in 1890. At its peak, the mill employed nearly 3,000 workers and owned substantial assets, including a 48-acre land parcel in Chunabhathi. After the mill ran into financial difficulties and was eventually ordered to be wound up in September 2005, its land and other assets remained locked in prolonged liquidation and redevelopment disputes.

Grand View Estates and For-

bes & Company, which together hold a 53.25% stake in Swadeshi Mills, subsequently sought to revive the company and requested a permanent stay on its winding-up. The proposal included settling workers' dues and developing the company's land.

However, the proposal was opposed by two minority shareholders, who argued that the company should instead be wound up and its properties sold through public auction.

In February 2026, a single-judge bench of the Bombay High Court rejected the proposal, holding that it was a “backdoor attempt” to take over the valuable Chunabhathi land for real-estate development rather than genuinely reviving the textile business.

Grand View Estates and the RMMS then challenged the order before a division bench. On Wednesday, the bench noted that the two minority sharehold-

ers who opposed the proposal were not backed by an investor who wished to run the textile mill or acquire its land through public auction and develop it.

The division bench also said the single-judge bench had disregarded the benefits the mill workers stand to derive more than two decades after the company was wound up. It noted that money invested by Grand View and Forbes had been lying in a bank account for more than 21 years, awaiting disbursement to the workers.

“In our view, this litigation by the two shareholders is nothing else but an elitist form of extortion,” the judges said. “Grand View and Forbes, on the other hand, having invested money, are losing crores of rupees every month that the proposal remains unimplemented; the resulting delay causes them huge commercial loss,” they added, while striking down the single-judge bench's order.

## quickcontext

1 Swadeshi Mills was one of Mumbai's prominent textile mills, founded by Jamsetji Tata in 1890.

2 At its peak, the mill employed nearly 3,000 workers and owned substantial assets, including a 48-acre plot in Chunabhathi.

3 After the mill ran into financial trouble in the 1990s, the Bombay High Court ordered the company's winding up in 2005. Its plant and machinery were sold, while Mhada built over 1,600 tenements to house former mill workers on a portion of the land.

4 Grand View Estates and Forbes & Company, which together hold a 53.25% stake in Swadeshi Mills, subsequently sought to revive the company. The proposal included settling workers' dues and developing the company's land.

5 In February 2026, a single-judge bench of the Bombay High Court rejected the proposal, holding that it was a “backdoor attempt” to take over the valuable Chunabhathi land.



# Now, festival feasts must pass the FDA test



Caterers for all community or festival feasts must fill an FDA form and submit it at least seven days prior to an event. HT ARCHIVES

Hepzi Anthony

letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The FDA on Thursday unveiled a first-of-its-kind festival enforcement calendar, under which all food served at festivals and community events will first have to undergo FDA scrutiny. FDA commissioner Tukaram Mundhe told reporters that the idea was to prevent adulteration and distribution of substandard food at large community events.

Caterers for all community or festival food distribution programmes like Bhandara, Iftaar, Mahaprasad and Langar will now have to fill the FDA proforma and submit it at least seven days prior to an event to give FDA officials time to ensure that food safety guidelines are being followed. Organisers of community mandals have been directed to involve only licensed caterers, while food dealers will have to source raw materials only from valid licenced outlets and retain the bills for one year.

The FDA calendar categorises festivals into three categories: national festivals, popular regional festivals and local village festivals that could involve village fairs, Urs and pilgrimages. Level 1 covers major state-level festivals such as Diwali, Eid, Ganeshotsav, Navratri, Christmas and New Year while Level 2 covers regional festivals such as Mahashivratri, Makar Sankranti, Gudi Padwa, and Guru Nanak Jayanti. Level 3 will focus on local festivals like local fairs, Urs or pilgrimage processions.

The FDA has also categorised high-risk foods that are particularly in use during specific festivals and will carry out checks on these, such as dairy products around Jannmashtami, non-veg food around Eid, edible oils before Diwali and Dussehra, and cakes, chocolates, and cream-based food products around Christmas and New Year.

The implementation will be done in a four-stage process ranging from 21 days before the festival to 30 days after the festival when the FDA teams will monitor everything from flour mills to godowns and warehouses and even transport vehicles. They will also deploy their food-testing vans at various food outlets to address consumers' grievances immediately by testing the food. This campaign will also include following up and fighting the case in court and disposing of the adulterated food. The enforcement could continue till 30 months after the festival if legal processes and the disposal of adulterated food are involved.

The action will also be applicable to dark stores, quick commerce and festival gift hampers. “Whether it is Eid or Diwali, people should get healthy, safe food during festivals,” Mundhe said.

Earlier, the FDA would swing into action only around specific major festivals, resulting in laxity at other festivals and delays in implementation, besides imbalance in action. The comprehensive order is meant to curb such irregular action. “This is part of the zero-tolerance policy against food adulteration,” said Mundhe.

## STUDENT SAYS KARATE COACH RAPED HER OVER TWO DECADES

Vinay Dalvi

vinay.dalvi@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** A 48-year-old karate teacher, who trained members of the Mumbai Police's all-women Nirbhaya Squad, has been arrested by the Kurla police for allegedly raping a former student over a 20-year period under the pretext of marriage.

The accused, identified as Mahesh Navale, runs a coaching academy and teaches at several colleges across Matunga, Sion, and Chunabhathi.

According to the police, the 36-year-old complainant, who now works for an Information Technology firm, first met Navale in 2006 while participating in a National Cadet Corps (NCC) self-defence course at a college in King's Circle, Matunga. Navale, who was hired to instruct the students, allegedly told her that although he was married, his wife was unfaithful and he intended to separate soon.

Officers said Navale subsequently took the complainant to a lodging facility in Gorai, where he sexually assaulted her and threatened her against speaking out. Over the next two decades—from 2006 to 2026—he continued to sexually assault her at various locations across Kurla and Navi Mumbai, repeatedly promising to marry her while allegedly capturing illicit photos and videos.

“When the complainant recently decided to distance herself from him, he began blackmailing her, threatening to leak the photos and videos,” a police officer said, adding that Navale had also extorted money from the victim and warned her that he would “see her” if she approached the authorities.

The Kurla police picked up Navale on Thursday and registered a case against him under Section 69 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which penalises sexual intercourse obtained through deceitful means.

The woman alleged that she was first raped when she was 17, demanding that charges be framed under the Pocco Act.

# Indian law governing child custody does not recognise joint parenting: HC

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The Bombay High Court has held that Indian statutory framework governing child custody and guardianship does not recognise the concept of joint parenting, and that the welfare of the child, rather than parental rights, must remain the paramount consideration in custody disputes.

A single-judge bench of justice Gauri Godse said courts must exercise their discretionary powers based on a child's entitlement to the love and care of both parents, rather than on parental rights.

The court made the observations while setting aside a Mumbai Family Court order granting an estranged couple joint par-

enting and 50:50 vacation time with their 14-year-old son.

“There is no compelling equal parenting, and the legal foundation in Indian law is the welfare of the minor child and therefore parents' legal rights can never override the child's welfare,” justice Godse said.

The couple, both residing in different places in Powai, had secured a divorce by mutual consent after filing consent terms, which covered residential arrangements for the wife and the 14-year-old boy and monthly maintenance for him. Under the consent terms, the child was to ordinarily reside with his mother and spend half of his school vacations in the company of his father.

But later, disputes arose between them over the custody



of their only child and, on September 20, 2024, the Family Court held that both parents were entitled to joint parenting of the child and 50:50 vacation time. The mother was made responsible for the custody, care, and safety of the child during his stay with her, as well as for the child's maintenance expenses and 50% of his educational

expenses. The father was held responsible for paying 50% of the child's educational expenses. Aggrieved by the order, both parents approached the high court, questioning parts of the joint parenting plan “imposed” by the Family Court — majorly based on the wishes expressed by their son during his personal interaction with the Family

Court judge, in which he had expressed his wish to be with both parents.

The high court on Tuesday allowed their petitions and struck down the Family Court order, observing that a joint or shared parenting plan cannot be imposed on the parties without affording them an opportunity for a meaningful hearing.

Justice Godse said such a joint parenting plan may result in further complications in already troubled situations and may affect the welfare of the child and may have an adverse psychological impact on him or her.

“A joint parenting plan would mean a meaningful role for each parent in decision-making and the child spending sufficient, high-quality time with both parents,” the court said.

## 10k Dharavi homes to be ready by 2029: CM

Ateeq Shaikh

ateeq.shaikh@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The first batch of 10,000 apartments under the Dharavi Redevelopment Project (DPR) will be ready by early 2029, Maharashtra chief minister Devendra Fadnavis said on Thursday.

Fadnavis said that when he was invited to perform the ground-breaking ceremony for the city's most ambitious redevelopment project yet, he declined. Instead, he had said, the first set of rehabilitation units should be delivered by early 2029. “When this is ready, I want to invite the Prime Minister for an event to hand these homes to the residents,” Fadnavis said while addressing developers at NAREDCO's Real Estate & Infrastructure Investors' Summit 2026.

The ground-breaking ceremony was held on September 12, 2024, a low key affair at the Railway Ground in Matunga. Earlier, at the summit, Pranav Adani, managing director,

Adani Realty, told the gathering that redeveloping 621 acres in Dharavi would touch more than a million lives. “As our chairman Gautambhai always reminds us, we are not starting on a blank canvas. I am deeply conscious that Dharavi is a vibrantly alive ecosystem, packed with homes, workshops, markets, faiths, friendships and many generations of memory. We want to protect Dharavi's livelihoods, preserve its community networks and provide its eligible residents the dignity of a secure home, modern infrastructure and better public spaces.”

Each eligible resident will get a 350-sq ft flat, in situ, while ineligible residents will be housed elsewhere in Mumbai.

Fadnavis also said that through the slum cluster redevelopment approach, the government intends to make Mumbai slum-free in ten years. He also said that the government has started working on creating a fourth Mumbai in the Virar-Palghar region.

# Over 600 shopkeepers evicted by BMC after SC order on Orchid City Centre Mall

Linah Baliga

leena.baliga@htlive.com

**MUMBAI:** More than 600 traders at Orchid City Centre Mall on Bellasis Road have been forced to shut shop after the BMC on Tuesday began action to vacate the mall in compliance with a Supreme Court order. The traders, who primarily deal in mobile accessories, said they had been “put out on the street overnight” and we looking at huge financial losses, as their businesses were stopped abruptly.

“The BMC wants to seal the premises,” said Kesharam Choudhary, who sells mobile phone covers and accessories at the mall since 2015. “We used to earn at least ₹1 lakh a month here. We paid rent, salaries to our staff and managed to live comfortably.” Around 90% of the businesses in the mall are reportedly related to mobile accessories while the remaining premises include other commercial galas, warehouses used by

delivery partners and a bank.

According to Choudhary, business was disrupted for nearly two years after a fire in the mall in 2020, but had gradually recovered after the premises became operational again. “After the mall reopened, business picked up. Now suddenly we have been asked to vacate,” he said. The BMC has launched coordinated action to completely shut the mall following the Supreme Court's August 25, 2026 order, which directed that the entire building not be used for any purpose until comprehensive repairs to the fire-damaged structure were completed and the BMC was satisfied that the structure was completely safe for movement and operations.

Santosh Salunkhe, assistant municipal commissioner of D Ward, said that the mall's upper floors were damaged in the fire. “The repair work was not completed but the ground and first floors were operational,” he said.



Traders at the mall on Bellasis Road, who primarily deal in mobile accessories, said they had been “put out on the street overnight” and are looking at huge financial losses. RAJU SHINDE/HT PHOTO

Salunkhe added that the mall would be permitted to reopen only after the required statutory compliances were completed such as a completion certificate from the BMC and fire-compliance status.

Rahul Kolekar, designated

directions are complied with.”

Following a court order, D Ward officials, local police, utility representatives, and mall management held a coordination meeting, instructing the administration to comply voluntarily.

The civic body then launched joint action via its building, proposals, and fire departments, posting public notices at the premises to prohibit entry, use, and occupation. Municipal authorities ordered the disconnection of the mall's water supply and initiated action against its municipal licenses. Electricity supply is slated for disconnection, remaining active only for essential construction and repair work. Police protection has been requested to maintain law and order throughout the process. Authorities have urged owners, developers, and occupants to cooperate, warning that non-compliance will trigger stringent action, including forced eviction and sealing of the building.

# HC orders takedown of AI deepfakes, obscene content about Shruti Haasan

Karuna Nidhi

karuna.nidhi@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The Bombay High Court on Thursday directed social media platforms to take down objectionable content concerning actor Shruti Haasan for alleged large-scale infringement of her personality and publicity rights via unauthorised use of her name, image and likeness in AI-generated deepfakes, fake pornography, merchandise, and commercial endorsements.

A single judge bench of Justice Madhav Jamdar observed that Haasan had made out a “very strong prima facie” case for protection of her personality rights. “There is substance in the contention raised by the plaintiff (Haasan) that the continuing dis-

semination of AI-generated deepfakes, manipulated images, chatbots, and other infringing content has caused and continues to cause irreparable injury to the plaintiff's goodwill, reputation, and commercial interests,” the court said.

The bench further observed that “such injury cannot be adequately compensated by monetary damages alone, as once deepfake content is disseminated across the internet, it is capable of unlimited replication and circulation, resulting in permanent dilution of the plaintiff's personality rights and public image.”

Haasan moved the high court in July through advocates Rashmin Khandekar, Ameet Naik and Madhu Gadodia. She sued 18 entities, including Google, Meta, X Corp (formerly Twitter), celebrity booking platforms and e-commerce intermediaries over alleged “misappropriation of her personality right”.

“The defendants are extracting clips of movies or other cinematic graphic works which contain performances of the plaintiff (Haasan), for creating Graphic Interchange Formats (GIFs), deep fake videos etc., without her consent...This is done in a manner which

brings disrepute to the plaintiff and makes her the subject of unsavoury humour, disrepute and baseless rumours, violating her moral rights in her performances,” the petition said.

Haasan said that the infringement of her personality rights was occurring every day and the circulation of such content had become impossible for her to control. She apprehended that “more unscrupulous individuals may also soon infringe her personality rights by circulating defamatory, infringing and false content”.

Haasan has sought permanent injunctions, takedown of infringing content, and damages worth ₹15 crore on account of the loss of reputation, goodwill and endorsement value.





## EX-CEO OF RCFL GETS BAIL IN ₹4,097-CR BANK FRAUD CASE

Vikrant Jha

vikrant.jha@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** A special CBI court last week granted bail to former director and chief executive officer (CEO) of Reliance Commercial Finance Ltd (RCFL) Devang Mody in a ₹4,097-crore bank fraud case, after noting that the allegations regarding his role were "generic in nature", the investigation was complete and the charge-sheet had been filed.

Special judge Nitin V Jiwane also noted in the order dated August 29 that several persons allegedly involved in approving the loans had not been arrested and that Mody's further custodial interrogation was not required.

Mody, who served as RCFL's director and CEO from April 2017 till December 2018, was arrested by the CBI on June 22 this year.

The CBI case originated from a complaint by Bank of Maharashtra and other lenders who alleged that RCFL had caused losses worth ₹57.47 crore. The CBI subsequently alleged that funds borrowed by RCFL were routed through intermediary and conduit entities to various Reliance Anil Dhirubhai Ambani (ADA) Group companies in violation of loan conditions, causing losses worth ₹4,097 crore to 13 public-sector banks.

While considering Mody's bail plea, the court found no concrete prima facie material showing that he had participated in availing the loans or induced anyone to obtain them. It also noted that the evidence against him was predominantly documentary and had already been seized, reducing the scope for tampering.

The court also noted a change in the charges invoked against Mody between the remand stage and the charge-sheet. Though the CBI had invoked a serious breach-of-trust charge while seeking Mody's custody, the same was not included in the charge-sheet, which accused him of cheating and criminal conspiracy.

## Some BEST double deckers' height to be cut by 17 cm



The AC electric double-decker buses were introduced in the BEST fleet three years ago.

ANSHUMAN POYREKAR/HT PHOTO

Shashank Rao

letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The next time you're on a BEST double-decker bus and you feel you've grown taller by a few centimetres, don't get too excited. It's probably the bus that's getting shorter.

More than three years after introducing air-conditioned electric double-decker buses, the Brihanmumbai Electric Supply and Transport (BEST) undertaking is now seeking a design change after some buses faced a clearance hurdle when passing under flyovers.

The issue has particularly affected the popular 310 bus route, which operates along the Santacruz-Chembur Link Road (SCLR). BEST officials have found that the roof of the double-deckers, which are 457 cm tall, comes dangerously close to, and in some instances brushes against, the underside of the SCLR flyover.

BEST has asked the manufacturer, Switch Mobility, to reduce the height of some of the double-deckers it has yet to deliver by 17 centimetres to allow them to operate on routes that pass under the flyover. "We have asked the manufacturer to reduce the height by 17 cm. This will be for a few buses only," said Trushna Vishwasrao, chairperson of the BEST Committee.

The undertaking is expected to discuss the technical feasibility and cost implications of modifying the buses before finalising the number of vehicles whose height can be reduced, officials said.

The AC electric double-decker buses were introduced three years ago as part of BEST's efforts to modernise its fleet and replace the iconic diesel-powered double-deckers that were gradually phased out. BEST officials and committee members have been pushing for greater utilisation of the double-deckers, particularly on routes with high passenger demand.

### More open-deck buses

BEST is also planning to revive the tourist appeal of double-decker buses by introducing semi-AC, open-deck electric versions. The BEST committee chairperson has proposed converting or procuring five double-decker e-buses in an open-deck configuration specifically for tourist services.

Officials said the buses were also used for birthday celebrations, family outings and get-togethers. During weekends, the tourist double-deckers could carry between 2,000 and 4,000 passengers on Saturdays and Sundays combined, generating revenue of around ₹4 lakh per weekend, according to BEST officials.

# ₹1,111-cr wage revision mooted for BEST, wet-lease employees

Proposal follows stir by employee unions; to be forwarded to study committee formed by state govt

Shashank Rao

letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The BEST has proposed an upward revision in the salaries of its own employees as well as those of wet-lease operators, placing an additional burden of ₹1.11 crore on the undertaking, year on year. This includes ₹475 crore a year for 9,000-odd wet-lease staff, of which 7,000 are bus drivers.

The proposal follows a recent agitation by the BEST Sanyukt Kamgar Kruti Samiti, the joint action committee of employee unions. The committee, in June, had demanded implementation of the Seventh Pay Commission, settlement of pending wage issues and better conditions for contractual and wet-lease workers.

Pay parity between the undertaking's own staff and that of wet lease operators was a prominent demand, with unions demanding a monthly wage hike of ₹3,000 for permanent employees and ₹2,000 for contract workers. The proposal,

## Proposed Wage Revision

### ENHANCED EXPENSES

**₹1,111 crore**

Additional burden per year due to wage revision

**38,200** Total number of beneficiaries, including BEST, wet-lease staff

### ADDITIONAL ARREARS

**₹6,000 crore**

arrears for 27,000 staff for 2016-2025 period under Seventh Pay Commission

**₹475 crore**

Additional expense per year on salaries of 9,000 wet-lease staff, including 7,000 drivers

**₹636 crore**

Additional expense per year on salaries of BEST staff

**₹300 crore**

arrears for absorption of 2,200 casual workers in March 2016

however, does not spell out these details.

The BEST, which depends on borrowings to meet its salary obligations, spends around ₹128 crore on salaries of its own every month. The wage revision will place a further financial burden on the undertaking as implementation of the revised wage settlement from 2016, in line with the Seventh Pay Commission, could result in arrears of ₹6,000 crore. Another ₹300 crore is due to around 2,200 casual workers absorbed by the

undertaking in March 2016.

The proposal, recommended at Thursday's BEST Committee meeting, is expected to benefit a 38,200 workforce, which includes the BEST's own staff as well as 9,000-odd employees of wet-lease operators, of which more than 7,000 are drivers. Revised salaries for these workers would cost ₹475 crore per year.

The BEST administration will forward the proposal through the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) to the Study

Committee constituted by the state government. If cleared, the BMC and state urban development department (UDD) will bear the financial burden of the proposed measures.

The Study Committee, headed by the additional chief secretary of the UDD, was set up after the strike in June. It held its first meeting on August 20, after which discussions were held between the BEST administration and trade unions.

There were three main demands. These included revision

of the wage settlement for the period 2016 to 2025. The BEST Committee has recommended that the undertaking's employees be placed in pay scales equivalent to those applicable to the state government and BMC under the Seventh Pay Commission. Around 27,000 employees would benefit from arrears from 2016. This would cost around ₹6,000 crore.

The second recommendation concerns 2,200-odd casual workers absorbed into regular service from March 31, 2016. The financial burden of their absorption will amount to ₹300 crore.

The third and politically significant proposal relates to wet-lease workers. It recommends that 9,000-odd contractual employees engaged through wet-lease operators receive wages at par with permanent BEST employees performing similar work.

Sources in the BEST said these recommendations are based on legal opinions from the Maharashtra government's law and judiciary department and provisions of Rules 21 and 25 of the Maharashtra Contract Labour Rules, 1971.

After the Study Committee reviews the proposal, it will be discussed by the BMC administration and the UDD, before a final decision is taken.

## No one should politicise Ajit dada's death: Sunetra

Faisal Malik

faisal.malik@htlive.com

**MUMBAI:** "It felt as if the sky had come crashing down on us," said deputy chief minister and NCP president Sunetra Pawar, her first-ever public comment on the death of her husband and predecessor, Ajit Pawar in a plane crash in Baramati in January.

Pawar also hit out at NCP (SP) working president, Supriya Sule, who questioned the absence of an FIR into the crash that claimed her cousin's life even though Ajit's party, the NCP, was a part of the ruling Mahayuti government.

Pawar said her husband's death must not be politicised. "Honestly, who would know better than me and my children, the void caused by the loss of Ajit Dada," asked Pawar. "Everyone wants details of the investigation and we are making efforts. You all know that we have met the Prime Minister and the home minister."

Pawar said chief minister Devendra Fadnis had told the state legislature that he was committed to the investigation. "He is making every possible effort to honour that commitment," she remarked.

Urging restraint, she said the authorities should be given sufficient time to complete their work. "Whatever appears in the media does not necessarily represent the complete picture. I believe repeatedly raising the



Dy CM Sunetra Pawar said CM Devendra Fadnis was committed to the probe into the crash that killed Ajit Pawar.

HT

issue only leads to a media trial," said Pawar, taking a swipe at Sule.

On a more emotional note, she remarked, "We also need to think about Dada's mother, children and wife. Who could be more pained than us? There is no reason to believe we have no feelings," she said, adding that the family wanted the investigation completed at the earliest and is making every effort to expedite it.

"You know such matters are repeatedly discussed in the media. I feel no one should politicise Dada's death in this manner," Pawar said, in another oblique reference to NCP (SP) leaders.

Sule had raised the issue on Wednesday while referring to an FIR registered against MNS chief Raj Thackeray's son Amit

Thackeray, who allegedly removed a photograph of Prime Minister Narendra Modi from a wall at a government polytechnic in Pune.

She pivoted to Pawar's death, saying, "Why has no FIR been registered regarding my brother Ajit Pawar's death? We lost a prominent member of our family. The NCP (Ajit Pawar faction) is part of the current government. Have any of their 40 MLAs or eight-nine ministers ever uttered a single word demanding an FIR or a proper investigation into my brother's death? Our brother is gone, and they are enjoying power."

NCP (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar too has repeatedly expressed apprehensions over the circumstances surrounding the plane crash that claimed Ajit Pawar's life.

## Man who was given expired saline dies; two nurses suspended

G Mohiuddin Jeddy

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NAVI MUMBAI:** A 50-year-old Vashi resident, Gopiram Bhivaji Khadse, died at Hiranandani Fortis Hospital on Thursday, days after allegedly being administered expired intravenous saline at the Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation (NMMC) Hospital in Vashi. Two nurses have been suspended following the incident, NMMC medical officer of health Dr Rajesh Mhatre confirmed.

Khadse was admitted to the civic hospital on 31 August suffering from fever, dizziness, and weakness, subsequently testing positive for dengue and falciparum malaria (the most severe form of malaria). Health officials noted he also suffered from diabetes and hypertension. His condition deteriorated rapidly on 1 September, prompting his transfer under the NMMC quota to Fortis Hospital, where he was placed on life-support.

His elder son, Vijay, said that severe side effects emerged immediately after a second bottle of expired saline was administered. Vijay said that his father suffered intense itching, hives, extreme fever, and severe body discoloration. Upon checking the IV bottle himself, Vijay discovered it had expired in July. Nursing staff allegedly acknowledged the error after being shown photographs of the bottle.



Within moments of the infusion, severe side effects started in his body. He suffered intense itching and he developed a very high fever

**VIJAY KHADSE**, son of the deceased Gopiram Khadse

The victim's family and local activists staged a protest outside the Vashi hospital demanding medical negligence charges, financial compensation, and a government job for a family member. Meanwhile, the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena demanded a thorough investigation and scanning CCTV footage.

NMMC health committee chairperson Dr Jayaji Nath stated that while it remains unconfirmed whether the expired saline directly caused the death, the alleged lapse is extremely serious. Medical superintendent Dr Ravindra Mhatre confirmed a post-mortem examination has been initiated, emphasising that further disciplinary and legal measures will depend directly on the final findings of the official inquiry committee.

## Home safe: 55 pilgrims return from Nepal



It was a moment of emotion, relief and gratitude as 54 pilgrims from Maharashtra, who had travelled to Kailash Mansarovar and were stranded in Nepal after flash floods and landslides, arrived safely in Mumbai on Thursday. The pilgrims were welcomed at Mumbai airport following evacuation efforts in Nepal.

SATISH BATE/HT PHOTO

## End of an era: Workers defy high winds to break down Air India's iconic logo

Yogesh Naik

letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The 38x24-feet Air India logo – an iconic signage atop the 23-storey Air India building – was removed on Wednesday after a week-long operation. It took 10 workers from the Public Works Department (PWD) to dismantle the logo into 40 parts while braving high winds across the Arabian Sea and intermittent rain. The logo was made of perforated aluminium sheets designed to let the wind pass through.

The PWD's Mumbai division has commissioned a new design to the Sir J J School of Art, which will replace the just-dismantled logo atop the building, which will house the state government's offices in the near future.

Pradnya Walke, chief engineer of PWD's Mumbai division, said, "We took over the building on June 2 and will soon issue a tender for its makeover. Removing the logo was a big challenge, as the top area where it was set up does not have a parapet wall. Workers wore harnesses, helmets and took utmost care to achieve the task. The high



It took 10 workers from the Public Works Department (PWD) to dismantle the logo into 40 parts.

winds across the sea added to their problems."

A worker who was part of the team said, "The wind speeds were so intense that we had to

pray hard for our safety even though we wore harnesses. We also had to be careful not to drop a single part of the logo on the road below."

A PWD officer aware of developments said, the Sir JJ School of Art has made at least fresh 15 designs and are creating more options. They will be

examined by senior PWD officials, following which chief minister Devendra Fadnis will make the final selection.

Jitendra Bhargava, former executive director of Air India, and author of "Descent of Air India", which chronicled the financial and operational descent of the once-revered government-owned carrier, said, "When the building came up in 1970s, the revolving Centaur was the Air India logo. A landmark building, many Hindi films were shot in its backdrop. The new logo was planned when Indian Airlines was merged with Air India in 2007."

According to sources, Air India had applied for permission to set up the logo from the Maharashtra Coastal Zone Management Authority in 2014, which was approved in 2015, following which the logo was set up atop the building in 2017.

According to PWD's records, the building was constructed in 1974 on a 7512.60 square meter plot, by architect John Burgee of the New York City architectural firm Johnson/Burgree. The total built up area is five lakh square feet. The site was one of the targets of the 1993 bomb blasts.

### { IN THE HIGH COURT }

## Law officer served notice over 'aggressive' outburst in court

Karuna Nidhi

karuna.nidhi@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The Bombay High Court on Tuesday issued a contempt notice to the Secretary and Senior Legal Advisor of the department of law and judiciary, Dilip Ghumare, for an allegedly "aggressive and high-pitched" outburst against the court administration during the hearing of a public interest litigation (PIL).

Ghumare's "unwarranted outburst and aggressive demeanour deliberately displayed before an open court in full public view while attempting to justify his stand not only scandalised the court but undermined and attempted to lower its authority, constituting contempt under the Constitution of India and the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971", a division bench of justices AS Gadkari and Kamal Khata observed.

Ghumare refused to comment on the development.

The alleged comments were made while the court was hearing an interim application in connection with a 2013 PIL. During the hearing, the court referred to its order dated

**DILIP GHUMARE'S OUTBURST CAME WHEN THE COURT ASKED HIM ABOUT AN AFFIDAVIT CLAIMING 179 NEW POSTS HAD BEEN CREATED FOR FAST TRACK COURTS**

August 24 and an affidavit filed by Ghumare dated August 27, which claimed that 179 new posts had been created for fast track courts.

The court questioned the additional government pleader (AGP) PP Kakade about the averment. As he was unable to provide a clear and unequivocal response, the court asked Ghumare to identify the relevant averments and questioned who had filed the affidavit.

Rather than respond to the court's query, Ghumare responded in "an aggressive, high-pitched tone inter alia blaming the high court administration". He also claimed before a packed courtroom that "the high court administration was

responsible for not filling up the 179 posts".

The bench said that Ghumare's "intemperate outburst against the court's administration in full public view constituted a deliberate and unwarranted assault upon the dignity and authority of this court"; such conduct was manifestly unbecoming of any judicial officer, simply outrageous, and fell far below the standard expected by the court, the judges said.

While Ghumare apologised before the court for his behaviour, the bench observed that his conduct was "wholly unpardonable and cannot be countenanced". Ghumare could not certainly forget that he was a judicial officer and his position did not confer on him the privilege to treat the court with utter disrespect, the bench said.

"To permit this would convey to the public at large a deeply troubling message: that one can commit an otherwise inexcusable act with impunity in open court and then sheepishly, in a theatrical manner, not meaning a word of it, offer an apology to absolve himself of an act which ex facie is contemptuous," the court said.



# Popular anti-noise pollution activist assaulted by goon

Condemning the attack, CM Devendra Fadnavis said police will take action against the accused

Gayatri Vajpeyee  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**PUNE:** In an incident that triggered widespread condemnation from citizens, political leaders and social organisations, Vidyand Bapat, a 37-year-old Narayan Peth resident who has long campaigned against the use of loudspeakers and DJs during Ganeshotsav, was allegedly slapped by Santosh Chavan, a former president of a Ganesh mandal and a habitual offender.

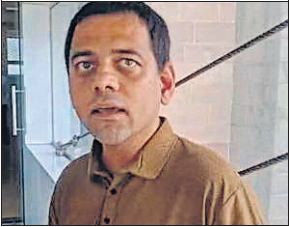
The incident occurred on Thursday morning at Sadashiv Peth in Pune while Bapat, an active member of the anti-superstition outfit Maharashtra Andhashraddha Nirmoolan Samiti (MANS) who also speaks up against noise pollution, was speaking to the media on camera. As a result, the entire incident was recorded and swiftly shared on social media.

His pushback against traditional celebrations impinging on the residents' peace and public health has drawn flak from a cross-section of Ganesh mandals. The Pune police have arrested Chavan for the alleged assault on Bapat and registered cases under sections 353(2), 126(2), 296, 115(2), 351(2) and 352 of the BNS, 2023.

After examining the CCTV footage, deputy commissioner of police, Zone-1 of Pune police, Krushikesh Rawale, said, "One person has been identified, and investigation is ongoing to



Bapat (L) was attacked by Chavan in Pune's Sadashiv Peth on Thursday. VIDEO GRAB



Vidyand Bapat



Santosh Chavan, accused

establish the circumstances surrounding the assault and determine whether any other person was involved."

Chavan, a resident of Kothrud in the heart of Pune, works for a real estate developer. He is the former president of the Priyadarshini Ganesh Mandal in nearby Rautwadi, against whom at least five to six cases of assault have been registered in the past, said Pune police.

After the incident, Chavan allegedly defended his attack on Bapat to media persons on camera. He stated that he took the step because Bapat was allegedly criticising Ganeshotsav, claiming he would repeat the act on anyone who speaks against the Ganesh festival in Pune. Addressing the media after the incident, Bapat said, "I only emphasised that care should be taken to ensure zero noise pollution and traffic congestion during festivals. People are free to celebrate the festival and I have no objection to that."

Assuring stern action against the attacker, police commissioner Amitesh Kumar said, "We are recording the statement of the arrested accused. No one is allowed to use violence against anyone. The police will take strict action against people involved in any kind of violence."

Condemning the attack, chief minister Devendra Fadnavis said, "Police will take appropriate action against the accused." He also appealed to citizens and Ganesh mandals to celebrate the festival in a traditional manner. The assault immediately prompted a protest by representatives of NCP (SP) outside the Pune police Commissionerate. Party MLA Rohit Pawar said that those who disagreed with Bapat's views "should have engaged with him through reasoned debate instead of resorting to violence" and called the assault on Bapat a consequence of a "disturbed mindset".

Activist-influencer held over obscene remarks about Maha minister

Nadeem Inamdhar  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**PUNE:** The Pune police on Thursday arrested activist and influencer Santosh Pandit from his residence for allegedly posting videos containing obscene, defamatory, and objectionable remarks targeting Maharashtra higher education minister Chandrakant Patil, CM Devendra Fadnavis, and a female corporator.

Following a complaint by Sarika Kamble regarding multiple YouTube videos, one of which amassed over 12.16 lakh views, an FIR was registered at Kothrud police station. Pandit was remanded to custody until September 8 under various sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) and the Information Technology Act.

Known for highlighting local civic issues like potholes, Pandit previously faced similar legal action at Deccan police station. Opposition figures, including Pune Congress chief Prashant Jagtap and former legislator Yashomati Thakur, strongly condemned the action. They accused the government of suppressing constitutional freedom of expression and democracy.

## SONOGRAPHY, X-RAY MACHINES NOT WORKING AT SION HOSPITAL

Hepzi Anthony  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The X-ray and sonography facilities at the urban health centre in Dharavi have not been working for the last three months. Located at Dharavi 60-ft Road, patients in the locality either opt the paid but subsidised facilities at the centre or seek treatment at the civic-run Sion Hospital.

"The X-ray machines had been given to the centre as part of CSR donations during Covid-19 but they are not usable. We get barely eight to ten cases for X-ray and there is no point spending on a new machine," said Dr Pramod Ingale, dean of Sion Hospital.

Known as 'Chota Sion' locally, urban health centres are extensions of Sion Hospital. "The private facilities at the centre are subsidised and reasonable compared to private facilities elsewhere. Hence, I recommend them to my patients. For those who can't afford them, we refer them to Sion Hospital," says Dr Anil Pachnekar, a local general practitioner from Dharavi's 90-ft Road.

However, Sion Hospital plans to convert the 200-bed health centre into a new facility. "We are gradually reducing the capacity of this facility, shifting chronic patients from Sion Hospital here or shifting patients when we are overloaded at the hospital. We also propose to set up a dialysis centre and an IVF facility here," said Dr Ingale.

## 38 rescued after ferry breaks down



Yogesh Naik and Vinay Dalvi  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** Thirty-eight people, including four crew members, were rescued after a ferry broke down approximately 1.5 nautical miles from the Gateway of India on Thursday evening.

According to the Colaba police, around 8.30 pm on Thursday, the ferry Anwari, which takes passengers on a 30-minute harbour cruise from the Gateway of India, broke down after a rope got entangled in the propeller. There were 38 people on board, including 34 passengers and four crew members.

"The ferry was around 1.5 nautical miles from the Gateway of India when it broke down," said a police officer from Colaba police station.

After the crew alerted the

The ferry Anwari, which takes passengers on a 30-minute harbour cruise from the Gateway of India, broke down around 8.30 pm on Thursday, after a rope got entangled in the propeller.

police, constable Abhijit Shinde and police naik S Gurav, who were at the beat chowki at Gateway of India, assessed the seriousness of the situation and began gathering information about other boats in the vicinity of Anwari, the officer said.

The police learned that another ferry, named Azad Hind, was near the stranded Anwari.

"The owner of Azad Hind, Junaid Mulla, was immediately contacted, and he contacted the crew. Azad Hind was then diverted towards Anwari, and everyone was safely rescued and brought to jetty number 2 at Gateway of India around 9.10 pm," said the police officer quoted earlier.

The police said they will question Anwari's crew to understand what led to the breakdown.

## 71-YEAR-OLD WOMAN INJURED IN BHANDUP HIT AND RUN DIES

Vinay Dalvi  
vinay.dalvi@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** A 71-year-old woman who was seriously injured in a hit-and-run incident at Quarry Road in Bhandup West on Monday succumbed to her injuries on Wednesday.

According to the Bhandup police, the deceased, Jaywanti Panchal, was on her way to a temple on Monday evening when she was hit by a vehicle. Panchal suffered injuries on her head and legs and was rushed to Devki Hospital by some auto drivers. After the police alerted her son Sanjay Panchal, 56, who works with the BMC, he shifted her to Criticare Hospital for advanced treatment. On Wednesday, she succumbed to her injuries at the hospital.

"The unidentified driver fled the scene after the accident. We have registered a case and a probe is underway," said a police officer. The accused has been booked under sections 106 (causing death by negligence) and 281 (rash driving or riding on a public way) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 and relevant sections of the Motor Vehicles Act.

## THE 71-YR-OLD WOMAN SUFFERED INJURIES TO HER HEAD AND LEGS AND PASSED AWAY AT CRITICARE HOSP

# ED seizes assets worth ₹2.11 crore, freezes ₹37 cr in Parimatch probe

Abhishek Sharan  
abhishek.sharan@hindustantimes.com

**MUMBAI:** The Enforcement Directorate's Mumbai unit on Wednesday seized movable assets worth ₹2.11 crore and froze bank funds worth ₹37 crore as part of its money-laundering investigation into the Cyprus-based illegal online betting platform Parimatch and associated entities. The searches were conducted at 17 locations including Maharashtra, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Delhi and UP.

Apart from gold bars and cash, multiple incriminating documents and digital devices were also seized, ED officials said. The ED has so far frozen/seized assets worth approximately ₹150 crore in the case. Parimatch is accused of generating around ₹3,000 crore from

Indian users in a year.

The agency initiated its investigation based on an FIR registered by the cyber police station, Mumbai. Its investigation revealed an alleged multi-layered mechanism for routing and laundering the proceeds generated through Parimatch. According to ED officials, the betting proceeds were initially routed through multiple mule bank accounts, including accounts on-boarded as merchant accounts.

The probe revealed that Cash Management System (CMS) and Domestic Money Transfer (DMT) agents were utilised for layering the betting proceeds. Funds received in merchant or mule accounts were allegedly routed to CMS and DMT-linked accounts, where banking funds substituted the legitimate cash

The investigation has uncovered a complex network, including mule and merchant accounts, hawala operators, crypto channels

OFFICIAL, Enforcement Directorate

collection cycle, while equivalent physical cash was made available to persons associated with Parimatch.

The cash was thereafter allegedly converted into USDT, a type of crypto currency, through hawala or crypto operators and

transferred to crypto wallets controlled by the offshore Parimatch network.

"Funds were also routed through payment intermediaries into the bank accounts of Indian tour-and-travel operators without a corresponding provision of services," said an ED official. These were used to settle amounts purportedly payable to travel operators by their overseas clients while corresponding amounts were collected from such clients in physical cash allegedly by Parimatch handlers outside India. Transactions of at least ₹200 crore were allegedly routed through two such tour-and-travel operators.

"The investigation has uncovered a complex network of mule and merchant accounts, CMS and DMT agents, tour and travel operators," the ED official said.

36 LAKH INDIANS  
GOT THE BEST VALUE FOR THEIR OLD GOLD

TANISHQ  
— GOLD —  
EXCHANGE

A WIN FOR YOU.  
A WIN FOR INDIA.

A transparent gold exchange process that gives you the best value for your old gold and helps India reduce its imports.

Making it a #WinWinGoldExchange

C%

Flat 0% deduction\* on exchange of old gold (18KT and above) from any jeweller.

₹

Get the best value in cash for your old gold from any jeweller (as low as 9 Kt).

✓ No hidden deductions

🔄 Exchange all year round

🏆 Upgrade to latest gold & diamond designs

🎁 Exchange for weddings, festivals & special occasions

Talk to our jewellery expert to know more ☎ 1800 2966 677 Buy online at tanishq.co.in or Download our App 📱 \*Conditions apply.

TANISHQ  
— GOLD —  
EXCHANGE

A WIN FOR YOU. A WIN FOR INDIA.

TANISHQ



## MY INDIA

## India ready to help end the war between Russia, Ukraine: EAM

Rezaul H Laskar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** India stands ready to help in all efforts to end the war in Ukraine, external affairs minister S Jaishankar told the top Ukrainian leadership in Kyiv on Thursday, days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged Russian President Vladimir Putin to move from "endless war to the end of war".

Peace efforts and the development of bilateral ties, including trade and investment, figured in discussions between the Ukrainian leadership and Jaishankar, the first external affairs minister to make a stand-alone visit to Kyiv. Jaishankar also visited Ukraine as part of the delegation that accompanied Modi on a trip two years ago.

Jaishankar's visit came against the backdrop of a significant increase in Russian attacks on merchant shipping in the Black Sea, which have caused the deaths of five Indian seafarers, and drone and missile strikes on cities across Ukraine. Jaishankar pointed to the death of an Indian national in an attack in Kyiv two days ago and said, "We join in mourning every life lost and convey our deepest sympathy to every affected family."

Jaishankar told a joint media briefing with Ukrainian foreign minister Andrii Sybiha that with



Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy meets external affairs minister S Jaishankar in Kyiv on Thursday. REUTERS

the war in its fifth year, India has maintained that this is "not an era of war", and solutions won't emerge from the battlefield.

He noted Modi had said at the meeting with Putin on the margins of the SCO Summit in Bishkek that "endless war must now give way to the end of war" and said every day of conflict will lead to more deaths and destruction. "Understandably, it is for the parties involved to find a way. But, if India can be of any help in any manner, we are ready, and this was the core of my discussion so far with foreign minister Sybiha," he said.

Sybiha expressed gratitude to Jaishankar for visiting Ukraine amid "non-stop Russian strikes"

and said Kyiv is grateful to New Delhi for backing joint efforts to end the conflict. "The role of India as a global leader is extremely important, especially for the involvement of a wider circle of countries," Sybiha said.

"Prime Minister Modi said in the presence of Putin it is time to end the endless war. We support this position. Ukraine is willing to end the war, we have realistic proposals and it is time to move towards diplomatic efforts," he said, without going into details. Sybiha said he briefed Jaishankar on Russia's attacks on civilian ships, ports and infrastructure. "Because of Russian aggression, the Black Sea has become a battlefield. Among the

victims, unfortunately, are citizens of India. We express our deepest condolences to their families and the people of India," he said.

The two sides discussed ways to ensure freedom of navigation in the Black Sea, with Sybiha saying the issue extends beyond Ukraine as Russia's blocking of vital routes for the delivery of Ukrainian grains is threatening hunger among millions across the world.

Jaishankar said on social media that approaches to end the conflict and deepen bilateral cooperation also figured in his meeting with President Volodymyr Zelenskyy.

Zelenskyy, in a social media post, said Ukraine is "grateful to India for its commitment to ending this unjust war".

He noted that even while Jaishankar was in Kyiv, Russia launched "jet-powered 'shaheds', which were developed not without Iran's help".

"This certainly must not be a time of war. Peace is needed. This is India's clear position," Zelenskyy said.

"We hope that other major world powers will also take a clear stance that this war must end and that a reliable peace must be achieved."

In the context of bilateral ties, Jaishankar and Sybiha discussed cooperation in education, health,

agriculture, digitalisation, innovation, diplomatic training and development cooperation. Jaishankar said trade, which spans sectors ranging from pharmaceuticals, food and agriculture to machinery and chemicals, has seen disruption due to the war and logistical challenges.

"At the same time, there has been a visible resilience and some new possibilities have emerged," Jaishankar said. Sybiha added that two-way trade is valued at \$2.6 billion, leaving significant potential for growth.

Jaishankar responded to a question about the impact of proposed US sanctions on India's purchases of Russian oil by saying that the conflict in Ukraine can only be resolved through negotiations. He pointed to the challenge of providing energy to India's 1.4 billion people at a time when the world energy situation is very difficult.

"This is something where clearly the Ukraine side has its perspective, which we respect, and we have ours, which I would expect others to also respect," Jaishankar said.

"This conflict...will not be solved because somebody is buying or not buying oil, alumina, minerals, metals or fertilisers. This conflict will be solved by dialogue, diplomacy [and] negotiation, and that is why it is something we would encourage."

## 31-member JPC to review FCRA bill; BJP MP to chair

Saubhadra Chatterjee

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Lok Sabha speaker Om Birla on Thursday constituted a 31-member joint committee of Parliament (JPC) to review the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, more than three weeks after the proposal to send the controversial legislation to a parliamentary panel was accepted in the Lower House.

A Lok Sabha bulletin added that Bharatiya Janata Party lawmaker Sanjay Jaiswal, a four-term MP from Bihar, is the chairperson of the panel. The panel has 14 BJP MPs, including Jaiswal and a total of 19 National Democratic Alliance lawmakers. The Telugu Desam Party, Shiv Sena and Nationalist Congress Party have one member each, and the Janata Dal (United) has two members. Three nominated members who had joined the BJP—CSadanandan Master, former external affairs secretary Harsh Vardhan Shringla, and criminal lawyer Ujjwal Deorao Nikam—are part of the panel.

The Congress has five berths. The Samajwadi Party, Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) and Indian Union Muslim League have one member each. The Trinamool Congress—both of them loyal to Mamata Banerjee—and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) have two members each in the panel. No member of the rebel TMC group found a place.

## THE AMENDMENTS ESTABLISH A DESIGNATED AUTHORITY TO OVERSEE VESTING, MANAGEMENT AND DISPOSAL OF FOREIGN FUNDS AND ASSETS

Jaiswal thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Birla. "Heartfelt thanks for this important responsibility," he said.

This will be the 19th joint committee formed on controversial bills since 2014 and the ninth since 2024.

On August 12, the Lok Sabha referred the FCRA amendment bill to a JPC for an extensive review after multiple stakeholders, including church bodies, objected to the legislation's provisions that allowed a Centre-appointed authority to take over assets created through foreign donations if the organisation failed to retain its FCRA license.

First introduced in the budget session but held back at the time, the bill triggered major controversy with the Opposition, several church delegations and three CMs of Christian-majority states raising concerns.

The amendments establish a designated authority for "a comprehensive framework for vesting, supervision, management and disposal of foreign contribution and assets, including provisional and permanent

vesting." A provision stated that the government can appoint a "designated authority" to take over, manage, or sell assets created from foreign funds by a non-governmental organisation (NGO) whose licence under FCRA was cancelled, suspended, or simply not renewed.

The bill plans to do away with section 15 of the current act that limits the scope of the authority to manage the activities of the organisation, utilise foreign contribution or dispose of the assets created out of it, in case adequate funds are not available for running such an activity.

The panel has 21 members from the Lok Sabha and 10 from the Upper House.

Along with Jaiswal, Bhartruhari Mahtab, Tejasvi Surya, Kamlesh Jangde, Mukeshkumar Chandrakant Dalal, Nishikant Dubey, Vishnu Dayal Ram, Ananta Nayak and Arvind Dharmapuri belong to the BJP from the Lok Sabha. CSadanandan Master, Harsh Vardhan Shringla, Ujjwal Deorao Nikam, Sat Paul Sharma and Alka Gurrar are members of the ruling party from the Rajya Sabha.

The Congress lawmakers include Anto Antony, Captain Viratod Fernandes, Md Hamdulah Saeed, Kali Charan Munda and Christopher Manickam. Zia Ur Rehman of the SP, TMC's Kalyan Banerjee and Menaka Guruswamy, JD(U)'s Kaushalendra Kumar and Sanjay Jha, and DMK's A Raja and P Wilson are also part of the panel.

## Rajnath unveils 10-yr roadmap to bolster global defence ties

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday released Raksha, a 10-year strategic roadmap for India's defence diplomacy, outlining the country's vision for strengthening global partnerships, the defence ministry said.

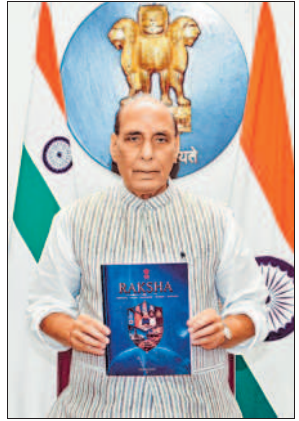
"The Raksha defence diplomacy document marks a shift in India's strategic engagement, aligning national security objectives with proactive global cooperation, fostering long-term stability and mutual growth," the defence ministry said in a statement.

This comes when boosting defence exports is a key government priority. India recently reorganised its defence attaché network abroad to drive military exports, focusing on countries likely to buy weapons and systems from India rather than those selling it military hardware.

The key pillars highlighted in the Raksha blueprint include strategic partnerships, capacity building, exports and maritime security. The goals include deepening bilateral and multilateral security cooperation, enhancing joint military exercises and sharing best practices with friendly nations, and promoting Make-in-India defence platforms to establish the country as a reliable global defence manufacturing hub.

India has aimed for \$50,000 crore in defence exports by 2029-30. The country's defence exports hit a record ₹38,424 crore in 2025-26, up 63% from ₹23,622 crore in the previous financial year. The hardware exported includes missiles, artillery guns, rockets, armoured vehicles, offshore patrol vessels, personal protective gear, radars, surveillance systems, ammunition, components and systems/sub-systems.

Several policy reforms have



Defence minister Rajnath Singh releases the 'RAKSHA' document in New Delhi on Thursday. PIB PHOTO GALLERY

been ushered in by the government in the past few years to boost the Indian defence industry, including simplification of the industrial licensing procedure, removal of parts and components from the license regime and simplification of export authorisation.

Defence public sector undertakings (DPSUs) accounted for 54.84% of defence exports in 2025-26, while the private sector contributed the remaining 45.16%. Official data shows that DPSU exports jumped 151% over the previous year, while private firms recorded a 14% increase. The private sector accounted for ₹17,353 crore worth of defence exports, while DPSUs contributed ₹21,071 crore. Their respective figures in the previous financial year stood at ₹15,233 crore and ₹8,389 crore.

"As defence diplomacy is a core pillar of India's foreign policy, this document provides a clear, actionable vision for the next decade, ensuring that India remains an anchor of peace, stability, and a rule-based order in an evolving global landscape," the defence ministry added.

## CONGRESS SEVERS TIES WITH ASSAM ALLY RAJIOR DAL

**GUWAHATI:** Congress on Thursday severed ties with Rajior Dal, its regional partner in Assam, accusing it of "breaching alliance ethics". This comes five months after the assembly polls and ahead of bye-election to the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat which is expected to be held in the next two months.

"The Rajior Dal leadership continuously engaged in malicious propaganda and character assassination against the Congress party," mentioned a release by the Congress's state unit. "...it is no longer viable to sustain ties with Rajior Dal," it added. Rajior Dal also accused the Congress of failing to be a responsible Opposition party and target BJP over its policies. HT

{ SAYS RAM TEMPLE TRUST'S NEW CEO }

## 'Will take 3-4 days to understand role'

Pawan Dixit

pawan.dixit@htlive.com

**LUCKNOW:** Air Marshal (ret'd) Jeetendra Mishra, appointed the first chief executive officer (CEO) of the Shri Ram Jannabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, arrived in Ayodhya on Thursday morning and said he would take another three to four days to understand his responsibilities before formally taking charge.

Though appointed CEO, Mishra has not formally taken charge of the post yet, people familiar with the matter said.

Mishra held closed-door meetings with trust office-bearers during his first day, understanding its finances, staffing and security protocols.

"Over the next two, three, four, or five days, as the Trust desires, I will sit with them and thoroughly understand my work. Once I have understood it, I will take over as the CEO," he told reporters after his first meeting with trust members.

"I consider myself extremely fortunate to have been given this responsibility twice in my life—once in service of the nation, and now in service of Ram temple, devotees, and the administration of the temple. My heart is filled



Ram Temple trust's first CEO Air Marshal (ret'd) Jeetendra Mishra in Ayodhya on Thursday. PTI

with gratitude," Mishra said.

Mishra, 62, who headed the Western Air Command during Operation Sindoor, arrived from New Delhi around 9.15 am and was received by trust general secretary Govind Dev Giri and treasurer Mahesh Bhagchandka. He also visited the Ram temple and offered prayers.

"Today, I attended the first meeting of the Trust, which was an introductory meeting where we got to know about each

other's work," Mishra said.

Giri said the standard operating procedures specifying his duties and responsibilities will be prepared in the coming days.

"Trust members will meet on Friday and request the CEO to take charge at the earliest," he added. Mishra later attended a meeting on the trust's accounts in the evening, where he was briefed on its administrative and financial arrangements.

The members of the trust said Mishra was briefed in detail by the trustees about the alleged donation theft case, including the developments that followed the controversy.

The CEO's responsibilities are expected to include temple administration, financial oversight, human resource management, crowd and queue management, infrastructure and coordination with police and other government agencies.

One of the CEO's principal responsibilities will be supervising the workforce deployed for the temple's security, cleanliness, maintenance and management.

The number of employees involved in these operations is expected to be around 1,500-2,000.

## MAYAWATI AGAIN REMOVES NEPHEW FROM BSP POST

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**LUCKNOW:** Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) chief Mayawati on Thursday removed her nephew, Akash Anand, as the party's chief national coordinator for the third time since 2024, months after she reinstated him in March following his removal from other key posts and expulsion.

Mayawati said Akash Anand, 31, requires more maturity and entrusting him with major party responsibilities at this stage would be inappropriate. "Time is needed to ensure the party is not harmed in elections by opponents employing tactics such as conciliation, bribery, force, and division to undermine it," she said at a BSP meeting in Lucknow, where she introduced her younger nephew, Ishan Anand, to the party leaders.

Akash Anand's fresh removal came days after the BSP launched the 2027 Uttar Pradesh assembly election campaign with his two rallies in Hathras and Gautam Buddha Nagar on August 10 and 25. Mayawati has groomed him as her political successor since 2017. She first appointed him as the national coordinator in June 2019. In December 2023, she named Akash Anand as her political heir. Mayawati backtracked on her political heir statement in May 2024. People aware of the matter said a family feud and infighting in the party led to Akash Anand's fresh removal.

## ED seizes ₹1 cr in cash, freezes 8 bank accounts in toll fraud case

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**LUCKNOW:** The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has seized approximately ₹1.03 crore in cash and frozen eight bank lockers during searches at 14 premises across five states, Jammu and Kashmir, and the National Capital Region (NCR) as part of the agency's money-laundering investigation into alleged fraudulent toll collection at National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) toll plazas, senior ED officials said on Thursday.

The ED's Allahabad sub-zonal office in Prayagraj had launched searches across Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, J&K, Madhya Pradesh, NCR and West Bengal on Wednesday under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002. The case stems from an FIR registered in January 2025 at Lalgarh police station in Mirzapur in connection with alleged fraudulent toll collection at the Atraila Toll Plaza and several other toll plazas across the country.

ED officials also recovered and seized a large volume of incriminating material, including books of account, financial records, bank-related documents and digital devices.

The agency said the material is likely to provide further leads into the flow of funds generated through the alleged illegal toll collection mechanism.

Investigators have specifically

## 30 premises in South raided as part of drug money trail probe

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Enforcement Directorate on Thursday carried out coordinated searches at 30 locations across Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana and Kerala as part of money laundering probes into multiple drug trafficking networks, including those with cross-border links, officials aware of the matter said.

The searches, conducted under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), were based on nine cases registered by state police and the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) since 2022. The action is part of the Centre's 'Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyan' (Drug-Free India) campaign and focuses on tracing and disrupting the financial networks behind

drug trafficking, they said. The cases involve trafficking of methamphetamine, hashish oil, ganja and MDMA, with links to Sri Lanka and some West Asian countries, involving more than two dozen Indian and foreigners, officials said.

An official, requesting anonymity, said, "In alignment with the government's policy priority to curb the drug menace, we have accorded high priority to narcotics-related investigations, adopting a targeted financial disruption strategy to dismantle drug networks by tracing illicit proceeds and breaking their financial backbone."

"In the last couple of years, we have seen drug trafficking proceeds laundered through real estate, trade-based laundering, and crypto assets," he added.

recovered material relating to toll-wise collection and reporting, non-FASTag collections, bank accounts and financial transactions, suspicious communications and the operation and deployment of unauthorised software applications. The ED probe has also brought under

scrutiny the alleged use of unauthorised mobile applications—'Mobdata' and 'Any'—to facilitate toll collection from vehicles without FASTag or with insufficient FASTag balance and generate fake toll receipts while concealing the collections from NHAI's official system.

TANISHQ

— GOLD —  
EXCHANGE

A WIN FOR YOU. A WIN FOR INDIA.

TANISHQ



# Race to avert traffic chaos on Mum-Goa highway for Ganpati

Faisal Malik  
faisal.malik@htlive.com

**MUMBAI:** Ahead of the ten-day Ganesh festival, when thousands of migrants from Konkarn go back to their native places, the Maharashtra government has stepped up preparations to manage the expected surge in traffic on the Mumbai-Goa highway. It has directed the Public Works Department (PWD), National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), police and other agencies to work in close coordination to keep traffic smooth and uncongested.

PWD minister Shivendrasinhraje Bhosale reviewed the traffic arrangements and the highway project at a meeting in Mahad, Raigad district.

Even though the highway remains incomplete nearly 15 years after work began, Bhosale maintained that 90% to 95% was completed. "The Chiplun bypass will be opened for commuters after the monsoon, and we are planning to open the Mangaon bypass by January 2027," he told reporters.

Launched in 2011, the highway project has missed every single deadline set for its completion, including the latest one of March



The Mumbai-Goa Highway, also known as NH66, is riddled with potholes.

RAJU SHINDE/HT PHOTO

2026. Envisaged as a dream corridor that would cut the Mumbai-Goa journey to around six hours, it remains a nightmare of unfinished stretches, construction bottlenecks and pothole-riddled roads. The 84-km Panvel-Indapur stretch is among the worst-affected sections.

Bhosale directed officials to closely monitor traffic on the Nagothane flyover, particularly to ensure uninterrupted movement of light vehicles during the festival.

Officials have been asked to take immediate corrective measures based on ground conditions and submit daily reports on traf-

## THE PWD MINISTER REVIEWED TRAFFIC ARRANGEMENTS AND THE HIGHWAY PROJECT AT A MEETING HELD IN MAHAD. RAIGAD

fic management. The minister also directed them to ensure that the Mangaon and Indapur bypass works were completed within their stipulated deadlines.

However, the Panvel-Indapur stretch has exposed the government's laxity in time manage-

ment. Although Ganeshotsav begins on September 14, the NHAI plans to open the tender for repairs only on September 2. The entire tendering process, with its scrutiny of bids, award of the contract, signing of the agreement, submission of performance security and mobilisation of labour, machinery and materials, can only begin after the festival.

The government is instead doing what it can on other fronts to ease the situation. Officials have been asked to identify and assess alternative routes to ease congestion. Internal roads that could be used as diversion routes are to be repaired and kept motorable before devotees set off for Konkarn.

Other plans to ease the discomfort of travellers include temporary facility centres at suitable locations along the highway which will provide drinking water, electricity, medical assistance and mobile toilets. Citing the large number of devotees travelling to Konkarn, Bhosale said he would directly approach union road transport and highways minister Nitin Gadkari to pursue a toll waiver on the highway during Ganeshotsav.

# IndiGo flight makes Mayday call, gets diverted to Oman

HT Correspondent  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** A Mayday call signaling a life-threatening emergency was made after one of the pilots of a Doha-Bengaluru IndiGo flight became incapacitated, prompting its diversion to Oman's Muscat on Thursday. Officials said the pilot required urgent medical attention and that flight 6E 1302 landed safely in Muscat, where a medical team attended to the affected crew member.

"The pilot became incapacitated during the flight, and a Mayday emergency was declared," an official said. It was not immediately clear whether the Airbus A320neo aircraft's first officer (co-pilot) or the pilot-in-command needed medical attention.

In a statement, IndiGo said the crew member is feeling better now. It added that an alternate aircraft and a new crew were arranged for the flight from Muscat to Bengaluru. The passengers were being provided refreshments and regular updates in Muscat, it said.

"We regret the inconvenience caused to our customers and are making all efforts to

## AI EXPRESS FLIGHT REPORTS SNAG, LANDS AT LUCKNOW AIRPORT

**LUCKNOW:** An Air India Express flight from Varanasi to Delhi made a precautionary landing at Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport in Lucknow on Thursday morning after a smoke detection alarm allegedly went off in its aft cargo compartment, prompting an emergency response.

All 155 passengers and crew members were safely evacuated, while preliminary checks found no smoke or fire, officials said. The flight took off from Varanasi around 8am and landed in Lucknow at 8.52am. A spokesperson said the crew opted for a precautionary diversion after detecting a technical issue.

HTC

minimise it," the statement said.

The incident came two days after a Goa-Delhi IndiGo flight made an emergency landing

shortly after take-off. A person aware of the matter said the issue was related to one of the engines, even as IndiGo has not confirmed it.



**Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices Bureau of India (PMBI)**  
(Under Department of Pharmaceuticals, Govt. of India)  
B-500, Tower B, 5th Floor, World Trade Center, Naraina Nagar, New Delhi-110029  
Telephone: 011-49431800 / 49431811 / 49431854 / 49431829  
Website: janaushadhi.gov.in

**VACANCY CIRCULAR**

Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices Bureau of India (PMBI) is the implementing agency for the Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP) and is registered under the Societies Registration Act, 1860. PMBI invites applications for the posts of General Manager, Dy. General Manager, Manager, Dy. Manager, Asst. Manager, Sr. Executive, Sr. Marketing Officer, Sr. Pharmacist, Executive, Marketing Officer, and Pharmacist on contractual basis. For details regarding eligibility criteria, vacancies, remuneration, application form and other terms and conditions of appointment, visit the website: <https://www.pmbi.co.in/index.aspx>

Sd/-  
GM (F&A)



**ICMR-NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MALARIA RESEARCH**  
Department of Health Research  
Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India

**WALK-IN-INTERVIEW**

ICMR-NIMR, New Delhi invites eligible candidates for **Walk-in-Interview** for engagement of **01 Consultant (Administration)** purely on contractual basis for short-term administrative support.

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Qualification &amp; Experience</b> | Post Graduate degree in relevant field such as Management/Law/Public Administration/ Finance & Accounts/CA/ICWAI/Commerce/ Economics etc. with min. 8 years' experience in Administration/Finance & Accounts/Audit/Legal in Govt. Dept./PSU/Autonomous Body |
| <b>Age</b>                            | 40-60 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Remuneration</b>                   | ₹80,000-₹1,20,000/- per month                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Walk-in Date</b>                   | 15.09.2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Venue</b>                          | ICMR-NIMR, Sector-8, Dwarka, New Delhi-110077                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

For detailed advertisement, eligibility, application form and terms & conditions, visit: <https://www.nimr.icmr.org.in>

Administrative Officer  
ICMR-NIMR, Dwarka



**पेंशन निधि विनियामक और विकास प्राधिकरण**  
PENSION FUND REGULATORY AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

**EMPLOYMENT NOTICE**

Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) is a statutory regulatory body established by Parliament of India under the PFRDA Act (23 of 2013) and set up under Ministry of Finance, Government of India with the mandate to promote, develop and regulate pension sector in India. PFRDA invites applications from Indian Citizens for filling up of 30 posts of Assistant Managers (Grade 'A') in various streams on direct recruitment basis as under:

| Stream                               | NUMBER OF POSTS |    |     |      |         | Out of which PwBD*                                         | Total Posts |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|----|-----|------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
|                                      | SC              | ST | OBC | EWS* | UR/ GEN |                                                            |             |
| <b>General</b>                       | 4               | 2  | 7   | 3    | 9       | 1(Blindness and Low Vision)<br>1(Deaf and Hard of Hearing) | 25          |
| <b>Research</b>                      | 1               | -  | -   | -    | 1       | -                                                          | 2           |
| <b>Actuary</b>                       | -               | -  | -   | -    | 2       | -                                                          | 2           |
| <b>Official Language (Rajbhasha)</b> | -               | -  | 1   | -    | -       | -                                                          | 1           |
| <b>Total</b>                         | 5               | 2  | 8   | 3    | 12      | 2                                                          | 30          |

2. Details of requisite qualification and experience along with terms and conditions of appointment to the post may be seen at PFRDA website: [www.pfrda.org.in](http://www.pfrda.org.in). Eligible and willing candidates may apply through online mode from 03.09.2026 to 24.09.2026.

3. PFRDA reserves the right to cancel/terminate the exercise at any stage as may be considered appropriate by the Authority.

General Manager  
(Human Resources)

भारत सरकार  
कारपोरेट कार्य मंत्रालय  
त्वरित कारपोरेट समापन प्रसंस्करण केंद्र (सी-पेस)  
आई.आई.सी.ए. बिल्डिंग, 7वीं मंजिल,  
प्लॉट P-6, 7, 8, से.-5, आई.एस.टी. मानेसर,  
गुरुगॉंव, हरियाणा-122050  
Email: [roc.pspace@mca.gov.in](mailto:roc.pspace@mca.gov.in)



**Government of India**  
**Ministry of Corporate Affairs**  
**Centre for Processing Accelerated Corporate Exit (C-PACE)**  
IICA Building, 7th Floor,  
Plot P-6, 7, 8, Sector-5, IMT Manesar,  
Gurgaon, Haryana - 122050  
Email: [roc.pspace@mca.gov.in](mailto:roc.pspace@mca.gov.in)

**FORM No. STK -- 6**  
**PUBLIC NOTICE**

*[Pursuant to sub-section (2) and sub-section (4) of section 248 of the Companies Act, 2013 and rule 7 of the Companies (Removal of Names of Companies from the Register of Companies) Rules, 2016]*

Public: ROC/C-PACE/STK-2/248(2)/2026-27/1099 Date: 18.08.2026

## Reference:

In the matter of striking off or removal of names of (113) companies in the Maharashtra (ROC-Mumbai) state under section 248 of the Companies Act, 2013 in respect of:

| S. No. | Work Item | CIN                   | Company Name                                         |
|--------|-----------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | AC5152641 | U86901MH2026OPC466066 | BE WELL AYURVEDA (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED               |
| 2      | AC5058994 | U62011MH2025PTC454609 | COLLABAUDIT AI INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED                 |
| 3      | AC4375713 | U46410MH2025PTC454521 | CARGO SATHI PRIVATE LIMITED                          |
| 4      | AC4608023 | U46909MH2025OPC454681 | BOM & LIN APPARELS (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED             |
| 5      | AC5161721 | U56290MH2025PTC448989 | VIJAY MEWALAL GUPTA PANIPURI & FOODS PRIVATE LIMITED |
| 6      | AC4932997 | U28219MH2025PTC448557 | GEOLIFE USHASH PRIVATE LIMITED                       |
| 7      | AC5024986 | U24311MH2025PTC443526 | ERYSOLAR STRUCTURES PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 8      | AC4417846 | U37003MH2024PTC432673 | KALPESH ENVIRO LOGISTICS PRIVATE LIMITED             |
| 9      | AC4843554 | U86900MH2024PTC434016 | AJINKYA HEALTHY SE LIFE SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED    |
| 10     | AC5094447 | U78300MH2024PTC434961 | TRIVANTAGE BUSINESS SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED        |
| 11     | AC4664520 | U74101MH2024PTC430635 | INFIONE FASHIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                     |
| 12     | AC4764504 | U47721MH2024PTC430494 | SENNOS BIOTECH PRIVATE LIMITED                       |
| 13     | AC5096579 | U45300MH2024PTC429025 | RAIMUKH INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED                   |
| 14     | AC5129732 | U41001MH2024PTC420755 | PERFICIENT CITY PRIVATE LIMITED                      |
| 15     | AC4554946 | U46497MH2024PTC419969 | AXURE EXPORTS & IMPORTS PRIVATE LIMITED              |
| 16     | AC4956311 | U10719MH2024PTC418298 | MELIORATE HEALTHY LIVING PRIVATE LIMITED             |
| 17     | AC5203255 | U46309MH2024PTC417219 | UTKRISHT OVERSEAS INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED              |
| 18     | AC5175033 | U59140MH2024PTC416526 | ALPHA MEN PRODUCTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                |
| 19     | AC5173566 | U46529MH2023PTC410857 | LUXSPACE CONTROLS & SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED         |
| 20     | AC4870189 | U78300MH2023PTC413444 | DREAMWORLDSPACE RECRUITERS PRIVATE LIMITED           |
| 21     | AC5168750 | U52242MH2023PTC411900 | JETSHIPPING LINES PRIVATE LIMITED                    |
| 22     | AC4636797 | U74109MH2023PTC410708 | BINT-E-AKBAR DESIGN PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 23     | AC5193243 | U70200MH2023PTC410413 | LOYALFILING SOLUTION PRIVATE LIMITED                 |
| 24     | AC5146844 | U46901MH2023PTC407166 | NUTRIVERSE RETAIL PRIVATE LIMITED                    |
| 25     | AC4727802 | U32409MH2023PTC405660 | CAM TOOLS TECHNO PLAST PRIVATE LIMITED               |
| 26     | AC4802074 | U68200MH2023PTC400747 | RAM ROCK REALITY PRIVATE LIMITED                     |
| 27     | AC5064383 | U72200MH2023PTC397525 | KONTENT KITCHEN PRIVATE LIMITED                      |
| 28     | AC5072867 | U62099MH2023OPC399321 | OORTLABS CONSULTANTS (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED           |
| 29     | AC5131055 | U74990MH2023PTC398766 | AAROH TRADERS PRIVATE LIMITED                        |
| 30     | AC5165904 | U72200MH2023OPC397203 | NARENN INFOTECH (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED                |
| 31     | AC5101856 | U17299MH2022PTC389806 | PLANTITUDE ESSENTIALS PRIVATE LIMITED                |
| 32     | AC4833917 | U20121MH2023PTC413878 | CENTURY SOIL ORGANICS PRIVATE LIMITED                |
| 33     | AC5030704 | U22300MH2022OPC387169 | AKSHAY SCREEN (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 34     | AC5160308 | U45309MH2022PTC376144 | N K TECHNO SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                 |
| 35     | AC4690168 | U70109MH2022PTC374920 | ATHARVAN PROPERTIES PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 36     | AC4956204 | U24100MH1983PLC029592 | NOBLE DRUGS LIMITED                                  |
| 37     | AC4618931 | U74999MH2022PTC384936 | FINORICH INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED                       |
| 38     | AC4828188 | U24200MH2021OPC373067 | UNIWE BEAUTIES (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED                 |
| 39     | AC5106764 | U28990MH1990PTC058599 | SHAMVIK MACHINERIES PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 40     | AC5156258 | U01100MH2021PTC364762 | SADHKESHWAR AGRO PRODUCER COMPANY LIMITED            |
| 41     | AC4415215 | U99999MH1993PLC071265 | LACON INDIA LTD.                                     |
| 42     | AC4534102 | U92132MH2000PTC126674 | FISH EYE NETWORK PRIVATE LIMITED                     |
| 43     | AC4677524 | U72900MH2021PTC355670 | AASK DYNAMICS PRIVATE LIMITED                        |
| 44     | AC4655899 | U34102MH1997PTC110013 | G P FREIGHT CARRIER PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 45     | AC4522009 | U52520MH2021PTC359107 | MAKE ASSOCIATES PRIVATE LIMITED                      |
| 46     | AC4480311 | U25200MH2021PTC360353 | PLASTOCONNECT PRIVATE LIMITED                        |
| 47     | AC4825805 | U65990MH2021PLN358058 | AKHILJANSWARAJ NIDHI LIMITED                         |
| 48     | AC4477974 | U72900MH2021PTC353107 | SIVTECH SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                    |
| 49     | AC4727193 | U23109MH2020PTC345051 | MAGNATUS INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED                  |
| 50     | AC5145205 | U15400MH2020PTC350879 | KOOL KORNER PRIVATE LIMITED                          |
| 51     | AC5147891 | U72900MH2020PTC348100 | MAGITT CONSULTANCY SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED          |
| 52     | AC4956603 | U74999MH2020PTC349120 | DHV ADVISORS PRIVATE LIMITED                         |
| 53     | AC5173603 | U33200MH2020PTC344620 | SAARTHY INNOVATION SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED          |
| 54     | AC4754312 | U01100MH2020PTC346551 | SILVER BIRD MEGACORP PRIVATE LIMITED                 |
| 55     | AC5148359 | U27310MH2020PTC342661 | B N A STEEL & ALLOYS INDUSTRIES PRIVATE LIMITED      |
| 56     | AC5153878 | U72200MH2020PTC335767 | QUELLSYS MULTICERV PRIVATE LIMITED                   |
| 57     | AC4680363 | U74999MH2020PTC338064 | TECHZEP MEDIA SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED              |
| 58     | AC5122380 | U24240MH2020PTC339651 | CALMA CARE PRIVATE LIMITED                           |

|     |           |                       |                                                                      |
|-----|-----------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 59  | AC5071207 | U85100MH2020PTC338354 | SPECTRON HEALTH CARE PRIVATE LIMITED                                 |
| 60  | AC5001605 | U92412MH2019PTC327715 | PIXADOO VISUALS MUMBAI PRIVATE LIMITED                               |
| 61  | AC4656533 | U74999MH2019OPC328037 | HIGH PROPEL TECHNOLOGIES (OPC) PRIVATE LIMITED                       |
| 62  | AC4461630 | U29100MH2019PTC328067 | TRANQUIL AGUA SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                              |
| 63  | AC4720628 | U45500MH2019PTC333997 | VRJ PETRO CHEMICALS PRIVATE LIMITED                                  |
| 64  | AC4737961 | U40106MH2019PTC334048 | DATE NASHIK ENERGY PRIVATE LIMITED                                   |
| 65  | AC5145388 | U52500MH2019PTC328392 | KOOL 4 SKOOL PRIVATE LIMITED                                         |
| 66  | AC5157468 | U51226MH2019PTC326542 | INFUSION CHAI AND COFFEE PRIVATE LIMITED                             |
| 67  | AC5149783 | U24299MH2018PTC317946 | YU LIFE SCIENCES PRIVATE LIMITED                                     |
| 68  | AC4825863 | U14296MH2018PTC312630 | IGNEOUS MINERALS PRIVATE LIMITED                                     |
| 69  | AC5126917 | U74999MH2018PTC313905 | PROBITY SPORTS INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED                                 |
| 70  | AC4862179 | U74999MH2018PTC313791 | DPOLL ERA PRIVATE LIMITED                                            |
| 71  | AC4447775 | U15549MH2018PTC312478 | YARANUTRI SELECT PRIVATE LIMITED                                     |
| 72  | AC4854304 | U74999MH2017PTC302785 | POSTMAN PICTURES PRIVATE LIMITED                                     |
| 73  | AC4698805 | U55202MH2017PTC303348 | PVLIC HOTEL PRIVATE LIMITED                                          |
| 74  | AC5117560 | U93090MH2017PTC295290 | ULTRA CINEMA & NUTECH PRIVATE LIMITED                                |
| 75  | AC5205521 | U74999MH2017PTC298529 | DUENDE WIDE FRAMES PRIVATE LIMITED                                   |
| 76  | AC4651268 | U52300MH2016PTC280821 | LIVKON HEALTHCARE PRIVATE LIMITED                                    |
| 77  | AC4941266 | U74999MH2016PTC280468 | JANAGANA ENTERTAINMENT PRIVATE LIMITED                               |
| 78  | AC4777340 | U74999MH2017PTC292576 | SUDISHA MULTITRADES PRIVATE LIMITED                                  |
| 79  | AC4460673 | U15100MH2017PTC296442 | AVH BEVERAGES PRIVATE LIMITED                                        |
| 80  | AC4806860 | U74999MH2017PTC293166 | BANU IRANI BAKERS PRIVATE LIMITED                                    |
| 81  | AC4708429 | U74999MH2017PTC289534 | JYC SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                                        |
| 82  | AC5122782 | U74910MH2007FTC172293 | V.HOLDINGS MANPOWER PRIVATE LIMITED                                  |
| 83  | AC4833630 | U74999MH2016PTC282657 | OYEKIDHAR PRIVATE LIMITED                                            |
| 84  | AC4558507 | U92140MH2015PTC263034 | SISTER CONCERN ENTERTAINMENT PRIVATE LIMITED                         |
| 85  | AC4919976 | U67190MH2017PTC291459 | RIGHT FOREX PRIVATE LIMITED                                          |
| 86  | AC4699569 | U74999MH2017PTC290242 | SECO AGRO FOOD PRIVATE LIMITED                                       |
| 87  | AC4706110 | U72900MH2017PTC290160 | APPLUS WAVE TECHNOLOGY PRIVATE LIMITED                               |
| 88  | AC4901908 | U74990MH2015PTC265512 | INDIVOYAGES TRAVEL & HOSPITALITY MANAGEMENT SERVICES PRIVATE LIMITED |
| 89  | AC5024238 | U64202MH2007PTC176363 | RAPIDCONNECT NETWORK PRIVATE LIMITED                                 |
| 90  | AC4521883 | U51396MH2008PTC182937 | SALASAR NEWSPRINTS PRIVATE LIMITED                                   |
| 91  | AC4593189 | U21023MH2008PTC183700 | PHOENIX INTERPLAST PRIVATE LIMITED                                   |
| 92  | AC4472898 | U72300MH2012PTC227922 | UNOVATION DIGITAL TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED                       |
| 93  | AC4708652 | U40300MH2015PTC267826 | BRAHMADITYA POWERTECH PRIVATE LIMITED                                |
| 94  | AC4625608 | U74999MH2015PTC268043 | EXICON HOLDING PRIVATE LIMITED                                       |
| 95  | AC4313020 | U74140MH2001PTC132277 | KALZOOM MANAGEMENT SERVICE TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED              |
| 96  | AC5108531 | U17299MH2006PTC162748 | ENTITY TEXTILES (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED                              |
| 97  | AC4674257 | U29240MH2003PTC142464 | VIJAYA CONSTRUCTION EQUIPMENT PRIVATE LIMITED                        |
| 98  | AC4267147 | U72200MH2005PTC151058 | QUINTESSENCE SOLUTIONS PRIVATE LIMITED                               |
| 99  | AC5173197 | U80100MH2005PTC151941 | PAN ACADEMY PRIVATE LIMITED                                          |
| 100 | AC4931471 | U74120MH2013PTC246727 | MAHYOG INVESTMENT CONSULTANCY PRIVATE LIMITED                        |
| 101 | AC4772650 | U74120MH2011PTC221453 | INFRA FENESTATION PRIVATE LIMITED                                    |
| 102 | AC4683648 | U74140MH2011PTC224450 | J2J ADVISORY PRIVATE LIMITED                                         |
| 103 | AC4270963 | U29253MH2011PTC225151 | CHASM TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED                                   |
| 104 | AC4694858 | U45205MH2008PTC189238 | OPTIMO INFRAPROJECTS PRIVATE LIMITED                                 |
| 105 | AC4839434 | U74120MH2013PTC240997 | MEDICOUNTS LIFESCIENCES PRIVATE LIMITED                              |
| 106 | AC5199510 | U45309MH2013PTC242984 | PRASADAM ENTERPRISES PRIVATE LIMITED                                 |
| 107 | AC5195048 | U74120MH2012PTC235418 | DEVKINANDAN ENTERPRISES PRIVATE LIMITED                              |
| 108 | AC4477704 | U45200MH2006PTC159326 | MY ASSOCIATES INFRAPROJECTS PRIVATE LIMITED                          |
| 109 | AC5185508 | U01403MH2010PTC199317 | SSGRP FOOD AND AGRO PRIVATE LIMITED                                  |
| 110 | AC4699464 | U74990MH2009PTC194200 | ASPIRE INFINITE (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED                              |
| 111 | AC4745063 | U70102MH2010PTC203471 | SHADOW PROPERTIES PRIVATE LIMITED                                    |
| 112 | AC5091746 | U26960MH2011PTC215179 | DOLSON MINERALS PRIVATE LIMITED                                      |
| 113 | AC5118516 | U52300MH2009PTC196268 | MIDARA FASHION PRIVATE LIMITED                                       |

- Notice is hereby given that the Registrar of Companies had received applications from the above-mentioned companies under section 248(2) of the Companies Act, 2013 for removal of its/their name (s) from the register of companies either on the ground that they have failed to commence business within one year of their incorporation or on the ground that the company(ies) is/are not carrying on any business or operation for a period of two immediately preceding financial years and has/have not made any application (s) within such period for obtaining the status of a dormant company under section 455 of the Companies Act, 2013 or the company(ies) have obtained the status of dormant company/ subscribers to the memorandum have not paid the subscription which they had undertaken to pay at the time of incorporation of a company and a declaration to this effect has not been filed within one hundred and eighty days of its incorporation under subsection (1) of section 10A/ have not been carrying on any business or operations, as revealed after the physical verification carried out under sub-section (9) of section 12, but it/they do not wish to continue its/their registration as companies and have, therefore, requested for removal/ strike off of its/their names from the register of companies.
- Accordingly, the Registrar of Companies proposes to remove or strike off the names of the above-mentioned companies from the Register of Companies.
- Any person objecting to the proposed removal or striking off name of the companies from the register of companies may send his or her objection to the office address mentioned here above within thirty days from the date of publication of this notice.

Raunak Agrawal  
Deputy Registrar

CBC 07123/11/0502/2627

Centre for Processing Accelerated Corporate Exit



**RAJASTHAN URJA VIKAS AND IT SERVICES LIMITED**  
(Formerly Known as Rajasthan Urja Vikas Nigam Ltd.) (A Government of Rajasthan Undertaking)  
Corporate Identity Number (CIN) - U40104RJ2015SGC048738  
Regd. Office - Vidya Bhawan, Jangpeth, Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur-302005  
Work Office at: 1st Floor, HUDCO Building, Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur-302005  
E-mail: [RAJVN@rajasthan.gov.in](mailto:RAJVN@rajasthan.gov.in), Website: [www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/RAJVN](http://www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/RAJVN)

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER**  
Online bids are invited to procure upto 500 MW power from 14th September 2026 to 31st March 2027 on short term basis from various Generators/ State Utilities/ CPPs/ Distribution Licensees/ SEBs/ Trading Licensees as per specification under TN-34/RUVITL/FY 2026-27. May visit website [www.mstcecommerce.com/](http://www.mstcecommerce.com/) [www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/ruvks/#/home/dptHome](http://www.energy.rajasthan.gov.in/ruvks/#/home/dptHome) for further details.  
raj.samwad/C/26/10518 RUVITL-PR-129 (2026) Superintending Engineer (PP)  
For Electricity Complaints Toll Free No. 1800 180 6507

**Maharashtra-State Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.**  
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)  
CIN-U43900MH2023SGC412992  
Head Office : 13/B, 13th Floor, Bakhtawar Building, 229, Nariman Point, Mumbai -400 021  
Telephone No. 022-20822686 Website: [www.msidsc.org](http://www.msidsc.org)  
022-20822687 E-mail: [maha-infra@outlook.com](mailto:maha-infra@outlook.com)

No. MSIDC/advertisement/2909/2026 Date : 02.09.2026

**Contractual appointment of Technical Post of retired officers**  
Maharashtra State Infrastructure Development Corporation, Govt. of Maharashtra undertaking is inviting application for the contractual appointment of technical posts on re-appointment basis from retired officers of State / Central Government / PSU of Govt. Authorities, Local Bodies for the following posts.

**Superintending Engineer 2**

2. A detailed advertisement regarding qualification, experience and Terms and conditions for the above posts is displayed on websites: [www.msidsc.org](http://www.msidsc.org). The provisions of GoM G.R. No. CBE-1525/CR-37/EST(Desk-13), dated 10.06.2025 is applicable.

3. The candidates are requested to send application in prescribed format by post and email id [cao@msidsc.org](mailto:cao@msidsc.org) on or before 15.09.2026.

**Sd/-**  
**Chief Administrative Officer,**  
**Maharashtra-State Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.**  
DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 2624

**मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम**  
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, इन्दौर संभाग क्र. 1,  
जी-13 प्रथम तल, एम.आई.जी. कॉलोनी, क्रिश्चियन एमीनेंट  
स्कूल के पीछे, इंदौर, दूरभाष : 9425601533

**निविदा सूचना क्र. 14/2026-27**

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम, इन्दौर संभाग क्र. 1, इन्दौर द्वारा मुख्यमंत्री पुलिस आवास योजना (चतुर्थ चरण) के अंतर्गत 12 एन.जी.ओ. एवं 48 आरक्षक (G+2) आवास गृहों का निर्माण कार्य, खुडेल, जिला इन्दौर, अनुमानित लागत रु. 1143.07 करोड़ हेतु निविदा (क्र. 2026\_MPPHC\_533458) आमंत्रित की गई है। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण Portal : <https://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।  
म.प्र. माध्यम/127850/2026 परियोजना यंत्री

**OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, PHED, REGION, BHARATPUR**  
Phone: 05644-222731, E-mail: [rj\\_acebha@nic.in](mailto:rj_acebha@nic.in)

No: 4520-40 Date: 20.08.2026

**Corrigendum No. 02, NIT No. 11-12/2026-27**

The following corrigendum is hereby issued for the NIB No. 11 to 12/2026-27 of this office due to technical problem in e-proc. site.

| Activity                                                                               | NIT No. 11 to 12/2026-27             |                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
|                                                                                        | Existing Provision                   | Amended Provision                    |
| Availability of Bid Document                                                           | 09.07.2026 to 20.08.2026<br>06.00 PM | 09.07.2026 to 07.09.2026<br>06.00 PM |
| Last date & time for Online Submission of Bid Document                                 | 15.07.2026 to 20.08.2026<br>06.00 PM | 15.07.2026 to 07.09.2026<br>06.00 PM |
| Last date & time for physical Submission of Bid Security and other mandatory Documents | Up to 01.00 PM on 21.08.2026         | Up to 01.00 PM on 08.09.2026         |
| Date of online opening of Technical Bids                                               | 21.08.2026 03.00 PM                  | 08.09.2026 03.00 PM                  |

All other terms and conditions shall remain same as mentioned in original NIT.

NIB Code: PHE2627A1370  
UBN No.: PHE2627WLB0802663, PHE2627WLB0802664

(Mohan Lal Meena)  
Addl. Chief Engineer  
PHED, Region Bharatpur

DIPR/C/15506/2026

**M.P. ROAD DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED**  
(Govt. of M.P. Undertaking)  
45-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462 011, Madhya Pradesh  
Ph. : 0755-2527290, 2765205 (EPBX), Fax : 0755-2572643  
Website : [www.mprdc.gov.in](http://www.mprdc.gov.in), CIN : U45203MP2004SGC016758  
NIT No. : 717/MPRDC/Proc/2026

**NOTICE INVITING TENDERS**  
Madhya Pradesh Road Development Corporation Limited (MPRDC) Bhopal invites online tenders for the following works.

| S. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | PAC Value (in INR Crore) | Bid Security (EMD) (in INR Lacs) | Cost of Tender Document (i/c GST) (in Rs.) | Period of Contract |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1.     | Consultancy Services for preparation of Detailed Project Report for Development of Bhopal-Gwalior 4-lane with Paved Shoulder Greenfield Access control Corridor in the State of Madhya Pradesh. (Project Corridor Length - 320 Km approximately) (Package-A)  | 11.36                    | 10.00                            | 35,400/-                                   | 12 Months          |
| 2.     | Consultancy Services for preparation of Detailed Project Report for Development of Bhopal-Jabalpur 4-lane with Paved Shoulder Greenfield Access control Corridor in the State of Madhya Pradesh. (Project Corridor Length - 240 Km approximately) (Package-B) | 9.61                     | 9.61                             | 23,600/-                                   | 12 Months          |
| 3.     | Consultancy Services for preparation of Detailed Project Report for Development of Katni-Singrauli 4-lane with Paved Shoulder Greenfield Access control Corridor in the State of Madhya Pradesh. (Project Corridor Length - 235 Km approximately) (Package-C) | 9.69                     | 9.69                             | 23,600/-                                   | 12 Months          |
| 4.     | Consultancy Services for preparation of Detailed Project Report for Development of Sagar-Jabalpur 4-lane with Paved Shoulder Greenfield Access control Corridor in the State of Madhya Pradesh. (Project Corridor Length - 135 Km approximately) (Package-D)  | 6.82                     | 6.82                             | 23,600/-                                   | 12 Months          |

The dates for purchase, submission, etc. are mentioned in the key dates. Tender forms can be purchased online only upto 15:30 hrs. on 13.10.2026 from website [www.mptenders.gov.in](http://www.mptenders.gov.in). The bidders have to submit the Technical bid as well as Financial Bid online only. The Addendum/Corrigendum (if any) shall only be published on the website of [www.mptenders.gov.in](http://www.mptenders.gov.in) only. If holiday is declared by Govt. of M.P. on the date of opening, the same will automatically be shifted to subsequent working days.  
MPRDC reserves the right to accept/reject any/all tenders without assigning any reason therefor.  
M.P. Madhyam/127888/2026

**MANAGING DIRECTOR**

**WESTERN RAILWAY-RATLAM CORRIGENDUM**

Tender No. RTM/2026-27/86 published in NIT No. W/623/NIT/1 Date 25.08.2026, Name of Work: "1. Malhargarh - Dalauda (UP) - TRR(P) - 29.911 Tkms. 2. Naml - Barayla Chaurasi & Harkia Khal - Malhargarh - TRR(P)" which is to be opened on dated 17.09.2026. This tender has corrigendum as mentioned below, which has been updated in IREPS.

All other tender condition are same.

1. Field name: Number of JV Member Allowed. Existing value: 3. Modified Value: 0. 2. Field name: JV Firm Allowed. Existing value: Yes. Modified Value: No. 0236

हमें लागू कर: [facebook.com/WesternRly](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRly)

**CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
BHUSAVAL DIVISION  
E-TENDER NOTICE NO.:  
DRM(W)Bhusawal/28/2026  
Dtd. 01.09.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Works), Central Railway, Bhusawal for & on behalf of President of India invites E-TENDER from registered Tenderers on website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) for the following work :  
(1) (E-TENDER NO. DRM W BSL 28 2026t1) (Short Name). Name of work : Provision of High-Level platform at Lahavi - Provision of High-Level platform UP DN (450mx6m) at Lahavi Railway station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.030). (2) Asvali: Provision of High-Level platforms, UP & DN (450mx5m) at Asvali Railway station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.026). (3) Provision of Divyangjan Amenities at Anikali, Lahavi, Summit & Ugaon Railway stations (NSG-6) (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.029). Approx. Cost : ₹ 127149054.12. Bid Security : ₹ 2543000.00. (2) (E-TENDER NO. DRM W BSL 28 2026t2) (Short Name). Name of work : Provision of Waiting hall with Hall agent room, toilet, drinking water facility & divyangjan facilities at (i) Morda Tandar, (ii) Mohadi Railway Station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.040). (2) Mordad Tandar: Provision of High-Level platform of 410m x 6m at Mordad Tandar station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.028). (3) Naydongri: Provision of High-Level Island platform (300m x 9.20m) at Naydongri railway station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.028). (4) Mohadi: Proposed High-level platform of (410m x 6m) with station building and minimum essential amenities including Divyangjan facilities. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.031). (5) Galan - Provision of High-Level platform UP & DN (410m x 6m) at Galan Railway station. (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.031). (6) Hirapur: Proposed raising of Rail Level PF to High level platform PF No. 1 & 2/3 (Island) at Hirapur Railway station (300.00m x 9.00m). (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.027). (7) Provision of Divyangjan Amenities at Nagardevia Railway stations (NSG-6) (PID: 01.01.53.25.3.50.029). Approx. Cost : ₹ 18498757.41. Bid Security : ₹ 3770000.00. (3) (E-TENDER NO. DRM W BSL 28 2026t3) (Short Name). Name of work : Jalgaon-Provision of 800m Precast Boundary wall at NRL Goods shed. (ID No.01.01.53.25.3.50.037). Approx. Cost : ₹ 11637331.75. Bid Security : ₹ 232800.00. (4) (E-TENDER NO. DRM W BSL 28 2026t5) (Short Name). Name of work : Proposed construction of new staff quarters at Kherwad-RB III-4, Lahavi-RB III-4, Asvali-RB III-4 units. (ID No.01.01.51.25.3.50.020). Approx. Cost : ₹ 36192182.68. Bid Security : ₹ 723900.00. Notes : (i) Tender Closing Date Time of Sr. No. 1, 2 tender up to 15.00 Hrs. of 24.09.2026. & Sr. No. 3, 4 tender up to 15.00 Hrs. of 18.09.2026. (ii) The prospective tenderers are requested to visit the Website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) For details of tenders & Corrigendum, if any. (iii) The tender notice is also displayed on Notice Board of DRM(W) Office, Bhusawal. (iv) Tenderer may participate in above E-tender electronically through website [www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in) only & submission of manual offers against e-tender are not allowed & if any manual offers submitted shall neither be opened nor considered. (v) The cost of tender document & EMD can be paid through on Line payment mode like net banking, debit/credit cards etc. available on IREPS portal. EXP-04 DRM(W), Bhusawal

**RailMadad Helpline 139**

# 306 killed in ethnic violence since May '23: Manipur HM

Thomas Ngangom  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**IMPHAL:** At least 306 people have been killed, and 49 are still missing in the ethnic violence that broke out in May 2023, Manipur home minister Govindas Konhoujam informed the state's legislative assembly on Thursday.

The northeastern state was rocked by ethnic strife that broke out on May 3, 2023 between the numerically dominant Meitei community that mostly inhabit Imphal Valley and tribal Kuki-Zo communities, who live primarily in the hill districts. Violent clashes broke out after a 'Tribal Solidarity March' was organised in the hill districts to protest against the Meitei community's demand for Scheduled Tribes (ST) status.

"Since the violence started on May 3, 2023, 306 people have died, and 49 people are still missing as of August 31, 2026," Konhoujam



Manipur home minister Govindas Konhoujam

said, responding to a query by BJP legislator Sapam Ranjan Singh.

The ethnic strife — which also saw other communities like Nagas getting involved in the later stages — led to President's rule being imposed in the state on February 13 last year after the BJP-led government headed by Biren Singh resigned on February 9. It was revoked on February 4 this year, hours before the formation of a new state government with BJP leader Y Khemchand Singh as the chief minister.

The assembly proceedings also

witnessed a war of words between the treasury and opposition benches when Congress legislator Kangujam Ranjit raised the issue of the killing of four Naga civilians in Kangpokpi district in May.

Konhoujam said four suspects had been arrested and that the National Investigation Agency (NIA) was investigating the case.

When asked about allegations that cadres of the Kuki National Front (P) and its leader, who is the husband of deputy chief minister Nemcha Kipgen, were involved in the killings, the minister said: "There is no concrete information on whether KNF (P) was involved in the killings or not."

"NIA is a premier agency in the country. We also pursue the case with them from time to time. We will try to ensure that justice is delivered," he added. Responding to the home minister, the Congress MLA said, "Please, work hard," and added, "Let's hand over the government to NIA."

Chief minister Y Khemchand Singh intervened, saying allegations made in public and findings of a probe were two different matters. "There was pressure that the village chief of Leiton Vaiphei be arrested for his alleged involvement in the killing. However, when NIA investigated the case, it was learnt that the village chief was in Guwahati for medical treatment for more than a week before the incident happened," he said.

Kuki MLA Kimmeo Haokip Hangshing on Thursday urged the state government to ensure the supply of food, medicines and fuel to every part of the state.

The Kuki People's Alliance MLA, along with Independent MLA Haokholet Kipgen, on Wednesday became the first Kuki legislators to attend a session of the Manipur Assembly in person since ethnic violence broke out in the state in May 2023.

(With agency inputs)

## Accused stabs sexual assault complainant to death in Hry

**KARNAL:** A 24-year-old sexual assault victim was stabbed to death at her residence in Haryana's Yamunanagar allegedly by the accused in the case, who was out on bail, police said on Thursday. According to police, the incident took place at 7 pm on Wednesday.

The victim, a mother of two children aged four years and nine months, was rushed to the civic

hospital by her brother-in-law, where doctors declared her dead.

The man reportedly barged into the woman's residence, and she ran for safety to a neighbour's house. The accused followed her and started attacking her neck with a knife while her husband was away for work. However, when the woman's brother-in-law arrived, the accused fled with the weapon.

The woman's husband said the accused, who was their neighbour, had been harassing the family for two years.

He alleged that the accused had previously raped his wife inside their home, leading to the registration of a case against him.

"Later, the accused fought with me over the same issue. We lodged another case against him, but now my wife has been murdered," the woman's husband said. Station House Officer (SHO), Jagadhari city police station, inspector Virender Kumar said a case was previously registered against the accused under section 74 (assault or the use of criminal force against a woman with the intent to outrage her modesty) of the Bharatiya Nyay Sanhita (BNS). He was jailed but later released on bail. **HTC**

## { FROM PAGE 1 }

### INDIA-BELGIUM TALKS

ation is a key pillar of our relationship. Today, we agreed to enhance military exchanges and training cooperation between the two countries," Modi said. "The agreements between our governments and defence industries will open up new opportunities for defence co-development and co-production. We will also strengthen intelligence-sharing and cooperation between our agencies in combatting crime."

Besides establishing an Investment Fast-Track Mechanism for Belgian companies, making the India-Belgium Business Forum a regular mechanism and strengthening coordination among the financial, fintech and regulatory institutions of both countries, India and Belgium have set a target of doubling bilateral trade over the next five years, Modi said.

Two-way trade is currently worth about \$13 billion, with diamonds accounting for almost 30% of the total figure.

"Belgium's expertise in semi-conductors and India's scale are complementary to each other. In this direction, we will work together to connect Belgium's IMEC Institute with India's semiconductor ecosystem," Modi said. The two sides will soon conclude a migration and mobility partnership agreement, he said.

De Wever described India as an increasingly important partner in a turbulent world and said Belgium, one of the most internationally connected economies, can serve as India's gateway to European markets. "We live in a more fragmented and uncertain world, prosperity and security increasingly go hand-in-hand," he said.

The Letter of Intent on Defence Cooperation finalised by the two sides provides a new framework for everything ranging from military exchanges to research, co-development and co-production of defence hardware, De Wever said. He said he looked forward to welcoming Modi in Brussels in December.

### EL NINO FORECAST

(SSTs) across the central-eastern equatorial Pacific — the region at the heart of El Niño — are already well above average and continuing to rise. The widely used Niño 3.4 index, which measures SST anomalies in that stretch of ocean, has strengthened from an average of +1.5°C above normal during May-July 2026 and +2°C in July to between +2.2°C and +2.6°C in late July to mid-August, indicating continued intensification.

The temperature deviation beneath the surface is worse. WMO said subsurface ocean temperatures in some areas were more than 8°C above average during July and early August. Together, the surface and subsurface conditions provide "strong support for continued El Niño conditions and the potential for further strengthening" over the coming months.

Experts said a strong El Niño is a serious concern for India. "It can alter rainfall distribution and raise temperatures. Its immediate impact on the withdrawing southwest monsoon may be limited, but it could influence the northeast monsoon and increase the possibility of a warmer-than-

normal winter," said Mahesh Palawat, vice-president at Skymet. "If El Niño persists into early 2027, India may face an enhanced risk of an unusually warm pre-monsoon season and heatwaves. However, El Niño alone does not determine India's weather; the Indian Ocean Dipole, snow cover, local sea temperatures and other atmospheric factors will also shape the eventual impact."

Anjal Prakash, an IPCC author and professor of public policy at FLAME University, called WMO's warning a red flag for India. "With August already 16% rain-deficient and September forecast below-normal, the event threatens kharif yields, water security and rural incomes, while pushing temperatures to record highs. For policymakers, this is also a macro-economic and food-security risk. We need immediate drought-proofing in vulnerable districts, flexible crop advisories, and pre-positioned relief," he said. For September to November 2026, WMO's multi-model forecasts point to an increased likelihood of above-normal temperatures across almost all land areas.

### GLORIA STEINEM DIES

Times interview.  
Taymor directed the 2020 film "The Glorias," depicting Steinem's life across the years and based on her 2015 best-selling autobiography "My Life on the Road." She was also the subject of a 2018 play, "Gloria: A Life," and a 2011 HBO documentary "Gloria: In Her Own Words."

Steinem said she considered herself "an entrepreneur of social change."

"I want to do justice to the women I meet, to tell their stories," she told the New Yorker magazine in 2015. "It's making connections, and using myself to listen, because we can't empower women without listening to their stories."

Steinem founded the National Women's Political Caucus in 1971 with former US Representatives Bella Abzug and Shirley Chisholm and writer Betty Friedan, whose 1963 book "The Feminine Mystique" ushered in the second wave of feminism.

Among other groups, she also created the Coalition of Labor Union Women, the Women's Media Center, Voters for Choice, and the Ms. Foundation for Women. In 2013 then-President Barack Obama awarded her the Presidential Medal of Freedom, the highest US civilian honor.

With her signature long, blonde-streaked, center-parted hair and aviator glasses, Steinem was the glamorous, hip symbol of the feminist movement, which she emphasized should embrace women of every race.

"If you've suffered discrimination, you're sensitive to it on every level. I learned feminism largely from Black women. Women of colour basically invented feminism," she told the New Yorker.

Steinem was born on March 25, 1934, in Toledo, Ohio, the younger of two daughters. Her father was a travelling antique dealer. Her parents separated when she was 11, following which Steinem lived with and took care of her mother, who suffered from depression.

The experience impacted Steinem's views on social injustice and marriage, which she believed robbed women of choices and many of their civil rights.

**International Institute for Population Sciences**  
(Deemed to be University)  
An Autonomous Organization of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of India  
Govandi Station Road, Deonar, Mumbai - 400088.

**ADVERTISEMENT NOTIFICATION NO. ADMIN. 01/2026**

Applications are invited through proper channel for 01 post of Chief Administrative Officer (Group 'A') on Deputation basis in Pay Level-13 of the 7<sup>th</sup> CPC Pay Matrix. Eligible officers with the prescribed qualifications and experience may apply. Last date for receipt of application: 05<sup>th</sup> October, 2026. The prescribed application format and detailed advertisement are available on the Institute's website: [www.iipsindia.ac.in](http://www.iipsindia.ac.in)

**Director & Sr. Professor, IIPS**

**HT Classifieds Friday**  
[www.htclassifieds.com](http://www.htclassifieds.com)

**TENDER NOTICE**

**पंजाब नेशनल बैंक**  
punjab national bank

Circle Office Mumbai Western,  
5th Floor, Pragati Tower C-9  
Block-G, BKC, Mumbai - 400051

**PREMISES REQUIRED**

Punjab National Bank requires suitable ready built and well-constructed hall type building for New/Existing Branch premises having Carpet Area including space for ATM on lease /rental basis premises should be preferably in Ground Floor and if in first floor, lift facility at

| Sl No. | Branch Name                                   | Required Carpet Area | Location                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | BO Bangur Nagar, Goregaon West<br>D No 123110 | 1600 to 2000 sq.ft.  | Shifting of Existing branch within radius of 500 mtrs approx. Currently existing branch located at 1st Floor, Max Heal House, Plot No. 169, Near Ayyappa Mandir, Bangur Nagar, Goregaon West, Mumbai - 400090           |
| 2      | 7 Bungalows Garden Versova<br>D No 106410     | 1600 to 2000 sq.ft.  | Shifting of Existing branch within radius of 1 KM approx. Currently existing branch located at Ground Floor, Flat No 1 & 2 Sterling Co-Op Hsg Sty, J.P.Road, 7 Bungalows Garden, Versova Andheri (West) Mumbai - 400061 |
| 3      | Dahanu, District Palghar                      | 1200 to 1600 sq.ft.  | New Branch                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

Premises offered should have all clearance certificates from statutory authorities. Interested owners / registered Power of attorney Holders of such premises in the desired locality who are ready to lease out their readily available premises on long term lease basis preferably for 15 years or more may send their offers in the prescribed format available on Bank's website [www.https://pnbbank.in](https://pnbbank.in) or the same may be obtained from the above address during office hours. The complete offer duly sealed & signed and should reach the undersigned on or before 10.09.2026 UPTO 04.00 PM at the above address. No brokerage will be paid by the Bank. Bank reserves the right to accept or reject any or all offers at its sole discretion without assigning any reasons whatsoever

**Sd/-**  
Date : 04.09.2026 Circle Head

**SIHT**

Readers are recommended to make all enquiries and seek appropriate advice before acting on any advertisement appearing in this publication. Any subscriber sending money, incurring any expenses or acting on any medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication, shall do so entirely at his/her discretion, intelligence and risk. The Company, Publisher or any of its employees do not vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of products and services and shall not be held liable for any damages, loss, consequences, suffered by any person on account of relying on such advertisements.



{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

Across

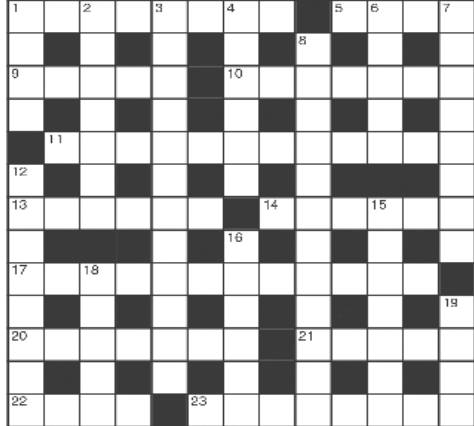
- 1 Completely wrong direction (8)  
5 Reputed to be unhappy about one (4)  
9 A primate goes into church with a troublemaker (5)  
10 He became proverbially rich from various sources (7)  
11 One needs it to understand information (12)  
13 Left a number at the gate (6)  
14 A small bureau's made up of experts (6)  
17 Increasing distress suffered by the young? (7,5)  
20 About ten Tolstoy's heroine is on the radio (7)  
21 Vegetable has one on both sides (5)  
22 Foolish people pass out (4)  
23 The boss sent around pupils (8)

Down

- 1 Twice reduced by 50% (4)  
2 Used by economical painters - it's not so wide (7)  
3 I can't promise to make changes. Curses! (12)  
4 Break into a politician's address (6)  
6 Clergyman has no head for crime (5)  
7 The last thing a crowd will do (8)  
8 A worthy person, as yet lacking polish (5,7)  
12 Telescope for a secret agent on a vessel (8)  
15 Board one first writes on (7)  
16 Horrified at being cut by jagged gash (6)  
18 Where to keep the hose readily available (2,3)  
19 We appear to be bearing the responsibility (4)

PUZZLE 17512

©GeminiCrosswords2018 All rights reserved



QUICK CLUES

Across

- 1 A governmental finance department (8)  
5 Commotion over trivia (4)  
9 Dull yellowish-brown (5)  
10 Having pleasant smell (7)  
11 Everything needed for a business (5-2-5)  
13 North polar region (6)  
14 Writing instrument (6)  
17 Less than amount paid for (5,7)  
20 Archipelago off Florida coast (7)  
21 Hatred and contempt (5)  
22 Be paid as wage (4)  
23 Much sought after (2,6)

Down

- 1 Amount of money received (4)  
2 Springy (7)  
3 Opportune remedial action (6,2,4)  
4 Of country workmanship (6)  
6 Prefix implying extremely (5)  
7 Without warning (8)  
8 Have one's revenge (6,1,5)  
12 Just adequate (8)  
15 Island birthplace of Napoleon (7)  
16 Rational motive (6)  
18 Contrasting (5)  
19 Surrounded by (4)

SOLUTIONS FOR 17511

Cryptic



Quick



{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ■ HIGH ■ LOW



FRIDAY  
Generally cloudy sky with moderate rain

32°C | 26°C



SATURDAY  
Generally cloudy sky with moderate rain

31°C | 25°C



SUNDAY  
Generally cloudy sky with light rain or drizzle

32°C | 25°C

ALMANAC

Today is 4th September 2026

21 Rabi ul Awwal, 1448

08, Bhadracharya, Krishna

Paksha, 08

Samvat 2083

Sunset: Friday at 06:50 pm

Sunrise: Saturday at 06:24 am

Moonrise: Saturday at 12:08 am

Moonset: Friday at 01:02 pm

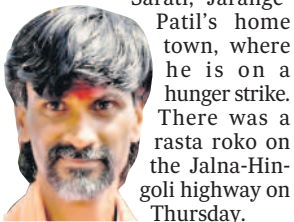
TEMPERATURE IN FOUR METROS

Delhi 32°C | 26°C

Mumbai 32°C | 26°C

Kolkata 32°C | 28°C

Chennai 37°C | 27°C



JARANGE WON'T BACK DOWN, AWAITS NOD ON ALL DEMANDS

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil refused to back down and end his six-day-old indefinite hunger strike on Thursday, even though the state government has accepted all but one of his demands and promised to start implementing them immediately.

State water resources minister Radhakrishna Vikhe-Patil, who leads the sub-committee for Maratha reservations, met with the expert committee appointed by Jarange-Patil, which then apprised the quota activist on the details. Jarange-Patil then met the Vikhe-Patil-led committee for over two hours, until 11:00pm on Thursday. He said he would end his hunger strike only if the government began issuing Kunbi certificates to Marathas from Friday, and a government resolution was issued based on his demands.

Agreeing to the first demand, the government said the government resolution would be issued by September 10. It, however, said the implementation of the Satarra Gazette could not begin until legal opinion is sought. "I urge Jarange-Patil to call off the indefinite strike as we have admitted all his demands," Vikhe-Patil claimed.

The activist, however, said, "I respect the government's efforts, which is why I have started drinking water. However, I will not withdraw my hunger strike. A call will be taken on moving to Mumbai on September 12 based on the response from the government," he said.

Meanwhile, Jarange-Patil's supporters took to the streets, staging protests on state and national highways to mount pressure on the government.

Maratha supporters from various districts have started marching towards Antargali Sarati. Jarange-Patil's home town, where he is on a hunger strike. There was a rasta roko on the Jalna-Hingoli highway on Thursday.

**SURAT MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**  
FIRE AND EMERGENCY SERVICES  
E-Tender No. Deputy Commissioner/FES/06/2026-27  
E-Tender (Online) Notice No. Deputy commissioner/ FES/06/2026-27. Tender are invited for the following works through online on <https://smctender.nprocure.com>

| Sl. No. | NAME OF THE DEPARTMENT                        | FIRE & EMERGENCY SERVICES |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1       | NO. OF WORKS                                  | 02                        |
| 3       | TOTAL ESTIMATED COST OF TENDER (RS. IN CRORE) | 5.31                      |

The detail Tender notice will be made available on web site [www.suratmunicipal.gov.in](http://www.suratmunicipal.gov.in) or [www.suratmunicipal.org](http://www.suratmunicipal.org)  
P.R.O. No. /211/2026-27  
Date: 02-09-2026  
Deputy Commissioner  
Surat Municipal Corporation

WESTERN RAILWAY

CONSTRUCTION WORK

Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction), Western Railway, Churchgate - 400 020 invites E-Tender No.: Dy.CE/CJCG/363. Name of Work: Earthwork in formation, Construction/strengthening of Major/Minor bridges, Construction of side drains, boundary walls and retaining walls etc between Mumbai Central to Khar Road stations in connection with the 6th line between Mumbai Central to Borivali stations of Mumbai Division of Western Railways. NIT Value: ₹ 85,76,20,583.25. EMD: ₹ 1,71,52,400/-. E-Bid Closing Date: On 24.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. E-Bid Opening Date: On 24.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. For further details please visit our website [www.iimps.gov.in](http://www.iimps.gov.in)

Like us on: [facebook.com/WesternRly](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRly)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No.: SER-OBHS-REFORMS-2026, dtd. 02.09.2026.

Special Limited Tender on Single Packet System is invited by Sr. Coaching Depot Officer, Santragachi, South Eastern Railway, Kharapur Division for and on behalf of President of India through e-tendering in [www.iimps.gov.in](http://www.iimps.gov.in) website as per details mentioned below. Eligible tenderers are requested to apply for the same through online only in [www.iimps.gov.in](http://www.iimps.gov.in) website as per details mentioned below. No offline tender will be accepted. Please read the tender document uploaded in the document section for details. Name of the work: Better On-Board Services (OBHS and Linen Distribution) in identified trains of South Eastern Railway through Empaneled Firms for a period of two years. Tender Value : ₹ 50,28,59,925.13. Earnest Money: ₹ 26,64,300/-. Cost of tender document: ₹ 25,000/-. Closing date of tender: 19.09.2026 at 11:30 hrs. (PR-715)

WESTERN RAILWAY

DEVELOPMENT OF NEW COACHING TERMINUS

Sr.DME(Co./Mumbai Central invites Tender Notice No: Re-M137-I-BSR-ChgTr Dtd.- 31-08-2026. Name of Work: Vasai Road-Development of New Coaching Terminus for Platform Return Trains. Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 2,20,03,115.46 (All Inclusive). Bid Security: ₹ 4,40,100/-. Tender Submission Closing Date & Time: on 29.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. For further details please visit our website [www.iimps.gov.in](http://www.iimps.gov.in)

Like us on: [facebook.com/WesternRly](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRly)

**Vacancy Notice**  
**Office of Head, Department of Water Supply and Sanitation Punjab**  
Water works complex, Phase-2, SAS Nagar  
Phone No. 0172-2270101, 3575689  
Recruitment Notice Reference No. Admin/DWSS/2026/9  
Applications are invited for the following post

| Sr. No. | Name of post                                | Number of Vacancies | Monthly consolidated Remuneration (in Rs.)                                                        |
|---------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.      | Training Manager (On purely Contract Basis) | 01                  | Rs.1,05,000/- to Rs. 1,10,000/- per month (fixed). Negotiable based on qualification & experience |

Last date & time: 21.09.2026 upto 05.00 pm  
For details log onto: <https://dwss.punjab.gov.in/>  
Note  
(1) Any corrigendum (s) to this recruitment notice shall be published on above website.  
(2) Applications received through any mode other than online application will not be considered.  
RD No. 1040/12/2026/27/14862  
Head, DWSS

**OFFICE OF THE: ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER, RUSHIKULYA BAHUDA BASIN, BERAHPUR - 760004**  
E-mail ID- [se\\_sicbam@yahoo.com](mailto:se_sicbam@yahoo.com)  
Corrigendum e-Promement Notice No - ACE, RBB - 02/2026-27  
The Period of Completion of Bid Identification No. ACE, RBB (BNID) - 07 / 2026-27 for the work, "Construction of C.C. Lining work to Doha Right Distributary from RD 16500 m to 25500 m Doha Irrigation Project; and Bid Identification No. ACE, RBB (BNID) - 08 / 2026-27 for the work "Construction of C.C. Lining work to Doha Right Distributary from RD 2500 m to 11500 m Doha Irrigation Project." of the above tender call notice may be read as 15 (Fifteen) Calendar months.  
Additional Chief Engineer  
Rushikulya Bahuda Basin, Berhampur  
OIPR - 32001/32411/1/26-27/0004

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA**  
**DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES**  
Office of the Additional Chief Engineer,  
Rushikulya Bahuda Basin, Brahmapur - 760004, e-mail id: [se\\_sicbam@yahoo.com](mailto:se_sicbam@yahoo.com)  
e-Procurement Notice No. ACE, RBB — 03/2026-27

| Sl. No. | Procurement officer                                           | Bid Identification No.     | Name of the Work                                                                                                | Bid Amount (Rs. in lakh) | Availability & Submission of Bid On-line             | Date and Place of opening of Technical Bids online                                                         |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1       | Additional Chief Engineer, Rushikulya Bahuda Basin, Brahmapur | ACE, RBB (BNID) 09/2026-27 | Construction of C.C. Lining work to Doha Left Distributary from RD 650 m to 7500m under Doha Irrigation Project | 819.33                   | From 10.09.2026, 10.00 A.M. to 25.09.2026, 5.00 P.M. | 23.09.2026 (11.30 A.M.) in the office of the Additional Chief Engineer, Rushikulya Bahuda Basin, Brahmapur |

Bidders are to participate in online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the Govt. of Odisha e-Procurement Web-site [www.tendersorissa.gov.in](http://www.tendersorissa.gov.in). Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of the tender can be seen in the above website only  
Additional Chief Engineer, Rushikulya Bahuda Basin, Brahmapur  
OIPR - 32001/32411/1/26-27/0003

**वसई विरार शहर महानगरपालिका**  
**मुख्यालय, विरार (पश्चिम)**  
**ई-निविदा माहिती**  
कामाचे नाव - वसई विरार शहर महानगरपालिका आयोजित १३ व्या राष्ट्रीय वसई विरार महापौर मैथिलीन स्पर्धेचे इन्व्हेन्ट मॅनेजमेंट, पीआर व मार्केटिंग करणे, आर्टवर्क, स्पर्धेच्या प्रसिद्धी करिता जिगत, थिम सॉन्ग व इतर अनुषंगिक कामे, सुरक्षा रक्षक व सुरक्षा उपकरणे पुरविणे व इतर तत्सम कामे करणे.  
जावक क्र.: व.वि.श.म. क्रीडा/४०३/२०२६-२७  
दिनांक : ०३/०९/२०२६  
सहई- (अजित मुढे)  
उपायुक्त (क्रीडा)  
वसई विरार शहर महानगरपालिका

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA**  
**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, CENTRAL RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BHUBANESWAR**  
Phone-0674-2540742 Email- [se\\_ccrw@yahoo.co.in](mailto:se_ccrw@yahoo.co.in)  
No. 4927 /Date:19.08.2026

**"e" Procurement Notice for Road Works**  
T.C.N No. Tender- Online-C-18 of 2026  
1. Name of the Work : Road works under MMSY-Transferred Road Improvement Programme (MMSY-TRIP) for the year 2025-26 / MMSY-CMRL for the year 2025-26 and MMSY-Improvement to Existing RD road for the year 2026-27  
2. Total No. of Packages : 16 Nos. of Road Works  
3. Estimated Cost of the Package : Varies from Rs.119.97 lakhs to Rs.778.54 lakhs  
4. Class of Contractor :  
a) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 lakhs up to Rs. 3.00 Crores  
b) Estimated cost more than Rs. 1.00 Crore up to Rs. 20.00 Crores.  
c) Estimated cost more than Rs. 6.00 Crores up to Rs. 50.00 Crores  
d) Estimated cost more than Rs. 20.00 Crores  
5. Period of completion : As mentioned in Column-8 of Annexure  
6. Offered rates by bidder : The offered rate by the contractor shall be excluding GST.  
7. Other details :  
i) Officer inviting tender : Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rura Works Circle, Bhubaneswar  
ii) Availability of Tender : Dt.07.09.2026 from 11.00 AM to Dt.28.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM  
iii) Date of opening of Technical Bid : Dt.29.09.2026 at 11.00 AM  
iv) Date of opening of Financial Bid : To be intimated later on  
Further details can be seen from the web site [www.tendersodisha.gov.in](http://www.tendersodisha.gov.in)  
Chief Construction Engineer, Central Rural Works Circle, Bhubaneswar  
OIPR - 25001/25082/1/26-27/0018

**OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF, RURAL WATER SUPPLY & SANITATION, JAL "O" PARIMAL BHAWAN, UNIT-V, BHUBANESWAR-751001, ODISHA**  
Tel: 0674-2395734, FAX: 0674-2394946, e-mail: [cerwssodisha@gmail.com](mailto:cerwssodisha@gmail.com).

**NOTICE INVITING BID**  
**NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-PROCUREMENT FOR EXECUTION OF RURAL PIPED WATER SUPPLY PROJECTS IN DIFFERENT DISTRICTS ON EPC CONTRACT**  
No. 9964 / Date : 02-09-2026  
The Engineer-in-Chief, RWSSAS, Odisha, Bhubaneswar, on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites proposals for Consultancy Services for engagement of Authority's Engineer (AE) for supervision of various Mega Piped Water Supply projects on the basis of National Competitive Bidding for the works detailed in the table given below. The firm is advised to examine carefully all instructions in the RFP Document.

| S No | Name of the Rural Water Supply Project                                                                                                                                                       | Bid ID No.            | Assignment Period (months)                       | Availability of Bid Documents for Online Bidding |                           |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
|      |                                                                                                                                                                                              |                       |                                                  | From                                             | To                        |
| 1    | RFP for Consultancy Services for engagement of Authority's Engineer (AE) for supervision of various Mega Piped Water Supply projects in Berhampur Circle & Bolangir Circle (Phase-I balance) | EIC/ RWSS- 01/2026-27 | 12 months (extendable by further upto 12 months) | 17.00 hours of 09.09.2026                        | 17.00 hours of 09.10.2026 |

Name & address of officer inviting Bid: Engineer-in-Chief, RWSS, Jal "O" Parimal Bhawan, Unit-V, Bhubaneswar, Ph: 0674-23957341 / 0674-2531533, e-mail: [cerwssodisha@gmail.com](mailto:cerwssodisha@gmail.com)  
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal <http://tendersodisha.gov.in>  
Engineer-in-Chief, RWSS  
OIPR - 25001/25040/1/26-27/0002

**SHREE SAIBABA SANSTHAN TRUST, SHIRDI**  
At Post, Shirdi, Tal.- Rahata, Dist. A. Nagar - 423 109.  
Phone No. (02423) 258671 / 258676  
(Website - [www.sai.org.in](http://www.sai.org.in))  
E-mail- [hospital\\_purchase@sai.org.in](mailto:hospital_purchase@sai.org.in)

**E-Tender Notice**  
Shree Saibaba Sansthan Trust, Shirdi invites online E-Tenders from eligible and experienced Contractors / Agencies for: "Conversion of Existing Casualty Department at Shri Saibaba Hospital into a Modern Modular Casualty Unit on Turnkey Basis, including Civil, Electrical, Plumbing, HVAC, Medical Gas Pipeline, Modular Furniture, Interior and allied works.". Detailed Tender Document containing Scope of Work, Technical Specifications, Eligibility Criteria, BOQ, Terms & Conditions etc. is available on : [www.mahatenders.gov.in](http://www.mahatenders.gov.in) for downloading and submission of E-Tender [www.sai.org.in](http://www.sai.org.in) for detailed information. Tender submission starts date 04/09/2026, Site Inspection Visit date 04/09/2026 to 11/09/2026, Pre Bid Meeting date 15/09/2026, Tender submission end date 05/10/2026.  
Goraksha Gadilkar, I.A.S.  
Chief Executive Officer,  
DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 2623

**KALYAN DOMBIVLI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**  
**Environment Department**  
**TENDER NOTICE NO: 10 (2026-27)**  
The Commissioner, Kalyan Dombivli Municipal Corporation (KDMC), Kalyan invites e-tenders in B-2 Form from experienced and eligible contractors / agencies for the following work.

| Sr. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Tender Fee | EMD        | Contract Period |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|-----------------|
| 1.      | Operation and Comprehensive Maintenance of 20 KLD Capacity Effluent Treatment Plant (ETP) at Slaughter House, Patripul, Kalyan (V), including maintenance and repair of all associated civil, mechanical and electrical infrastructure and equipment, collection and transportation of effluent generated from the Mutton Market and Fish Market, supply of all chemicals, consumables, spare parts, labour, testing, and comprehensive operation and maintenance of the ETP for a period of Two (2) Years on Turnkey Basis. | Rs.1180/-  | Rs.83616/- | 24 Months       |

The detailed tender document will be available on the Maharashtra e-Tender Portal [www.mahatenders.gov.in](http://www.mahatenders.gov.in) from 04/09/2026 to 11/09/2026 up to 3:00 PM. The completed online bids shall be submitted through the e-Tender Portal from 11/09/2026, up to 3:00 PM. The technical bids will be opened on 15/09/2026 at 11:00 if possible, in the e-Tendering Section of KDMC, Kalyan. As per Government Circular GST-1017/Pr.Kr.81/Taxation-1, dated 11/08/2017, the bidder shall quote the offer after duly considering GST and all applicable taxes as per the applicable provisions of law. The Commissioner, Kalyan Dombivli Municipal Corporation, reserves the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason, and the decision of the Commissioner shall be final and binding on all tenderers.  
Sd/- (Anita Pardeshi)  
City Engineer  
Kalyan Dombivli Municipal Corporation, Kalyan  
KDMC/PRO/HQ/387  
Date :- 03/09/2026

**M.T.D.C.**  
Maharashtra Tourism Development Corporation Registered Office: Mafatlat House, 1st Floor, H.T. Parekh Marg, 169, Backbay Reclamation, Mumbai-400020, Phone: 022-41580998  
MTDC/HO/IT/E-Tender/Digital Scanning/2026/R2  
Request for Proposal (RFP) for Document ABCD Classification, Digitization, Meta Data Entry & Document Management System in Maharashtra Tourism Development Corporation. The Detail tender Document including terms and conditions is available on [www.mtdc.co](http://www.mtdc.co) & <http://mahatenders.gov.in> websites for the bidders from 04/09/2026, 05.00 PM onwards and last date for bid submission is 25/09/2026 upto 05.00 PM.  
-Sd- Managing Director  
MTDC Ltd, Mumbai  
DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 2633

**GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA**  
**Office of the Executive Engineer, Mahad Public Works Division, Mahad-Raigad.**  
Email :- [mahad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in](mailto:mahad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in) Ph.No. 02145 222167  
Tender Notice No.14 for 2026-27 II Call

Online percentage rate tenders in B-1 Form are invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Mahad, District Raigad 402301 for the following works from Contractors registered in appropriate class of the Public Works Department of Maharashtra State. The name of work, estimated cost, earnest money, security deposit, time limit for completion etc. The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Maharashtra e-tendering Portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> as under.

| Sr. No. | Name of work                                                                                                                         | Estimated Cost (Rupees) | Bid Security (E.M.D.) (Rupees) via Offline | Cost of Tender Form. (Rupees) via Offline | Period of completion of work (including monsoon) | Class of Contractor |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 1       | Improvement to Road From Purar to Mhapral Road SH-101 Tal. Mangaon Dist. Raigad II Call.                                             | 34797215/-              | 175000/-                                   | 2360/-                                    | 12 Months                                        | NA                  |
| 2       | Improvement and Widening of Kharavali Phata Pen Usar Talegaon Panheli Road MDR-60 Km 9.500 to 12.500 Tal. Tala Dist. Raigad II Call. | 27198460/-              | 150000/-                                   | 2360/-                                    | 12 Months                                        | NA                  |
| 3       | Construction of Minor Bridge on Goregaon Harkol Govele Fata Road MDR 85 at Km 7/100 Tal. Mangaon Dist. Raigad II Call.               | 21030473/-              | 150000/-                                   | 2360/-                                    | 12 Months                                        | NA                  |
| 4       | Widening of Minor Bridge and Approaches on Dhalghar Hodggaon Gharoshi Road MDR 62 Km 8/800 Tal. Mangaon II Call.                     | 17781572/-              | 150000/-                                   | 1180/-                                    | 12 Months                                        | NA                  |

| Seq. No. | Stage                                                                                                                                                                          | Start Date | Time  | Expiry Date | Time  |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------|-------------|-------|
| 1.       | Period of online sale & online Submission of bid documents.                                                                                                                    | 04.09.2026 | 10.00 | 11.09.2026  | 18.00 |
| 2.       | Pre Bid meeting in the Office of the Chief Engineer. (P.W.) Region, Kokan, Fort Mumbai Office of the Superintending Engineer, Raigad (P.W.) Circle, Kokan Bhavan, Navi Mumbai. | 08.09.2026 | 12.00 | 09.09.2026  | 15.00 |
| 3.       | Online opening of Technical bid & Price bead (If possible) in Office of the Superintending Engineer, Raigad (P.W.) Circle, Kokan Bhavan, Navi Mumbai.                          | 15.09.2026 | 11.00 |             |       |

Note: Bid documents are available on <https://mahatenders.gov.in>  
No. MHD/AB/TC/3080  
Date : 02.09.2026  
DGIPR/2026-27/ROC 2619  
Sd/- (S. M. Kamble)  
Executive Engineer  
Public Works Division, Mahad





# OPINION

The  
**Hindustan Times**  
ESTABLISHED IN 1924

{ OUR TAKE }

## Climate models' clarity on calamity

Adaptation has limits, and irreversible losses and permanently changed conditions are certain

The UN Environment Programme said on Wednesday that global temperature rise will, now inevitably, cross 1.5°C within a few years, and that even the most optimistic pathway it modelled peaks at 1.8°C above pre-industrial levels. Most other pathways peak higher. The overshoot can still be held short and then reversed, the report argues, and that possibility needs to be taken seriously to stave off unseen catastrophes.

The report is also candid about what comes now: Adaptation has limits, and irreversible losses and permanently changed conditions are certain. Risks intensify with every additional fraction of a degree and every year spent above the threshold, some impacts accumulate and others arrive abruptly, and the tipping points grow likelier the longer the world stays beyond 1.5°C: major ice sheets destabilising, the Atlantic circulation disrupted, and a cascade of floods, droughts and other effects that come with it follow.

Last week, a flash flood in the Bhotokoshi river killed more than a thousand people in Nepal and left thousands more missing. Hundreds are feared to have died in China too. Nepal's ministers have since written to a UN Fund for Responding to Loss and Damage, arguing that its losses exceed anything the country can absorb on its own.

The Fund was indeed built for incidents like these. Its founding document lists displacement, relocation and permanent loss among the harms it exists to address although, till now, it has not paid a dollar to any country. Its first funding window drew roughly 180 applications, seeking \$2.8 billion against a paltry \$250 million available, and the first approvals have been put off to December.

Implicit in the mechanism was that disasters would be rare — countries pay into it when they choose to, claims go in during a window of applications and wait their turn. And when governments set it up, they agreed it would create no liability and no right to compensation.

The truth is, nobody has seen what 1.8°C warming looks like. While climate models are clear about what becomes of ice sheets and ocean currents, it is hard to imagine what truly happens to people — just like it was unthinkable to tie the notion of glacial collapses with the scenes seen in Nepal last month. Nepal may not be an exception in a few years' time, and it is time for the reckoning that the climate crisis is here.

## Forex boost delivered, over to markets now

The forex swap facility, including an FCNR deposit scheme, launched in June has attracted \$136.4 billion in foreign currency, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said on Wednesday. What are its larger macroeconomic implications? Three of them can be listed.

The scheme was launched as a one-time foreign currency mobilisation effort in the wake of weak capital flows to India, which could have put pressure on the external account despite a relatively benign current account deficit. The objective has been achieved for now. However, the FCNR deposit scheme is a one-time arrangement that can't be deployed on a more regular basis to manage current account deficits. Capital flows will need to revive going forward.

While the scheme has fulfilled its primary objective, it is not a costless exercise. The reason why it attracted such large inflows was the highly attractive returns being offered to the depositors. The RBI has offered to cover the costs of currency depreciation for the banks offering these deposits and its closure has seen rates being revised down by three percentage points. The cost will eventually reflect in things such as lower RBI dividends to the exchequer overtime.

Its medium to long-term implications aside, the scheme will also have an immediate fallout. The most important of them all is the sharp spike in banking system liquidity, which data shows increased from ₹1.85 lakh crore on June 5 to ₹7.8 lakh crore on September 1. This will have to be taken care of by the central bank via various policy interventions.

Is there a simpler takeaway beyond these technical details? It is the following: India's macro-credibility, when backed with the sovereign's commitment, remains strong with investors. The challenge is to make India's markets as convincing about their long-term returns.

## When no number high enough is enough

The 7.8% first quarter growth in a world in turmoil is not enough to satisfy the sceptics. We should ignore the noise and carry on with reskilling, reform and growth

Just two months ago, the dominant story was of doom. The oil price rise due to the West Asia war, outflow of capital and rupee depreciation were all cited as reasons to prove that India was in a downward spiral.

The external shock, it was said, revealed the real problems of the Indian economy. But nations don't roll over and die. They respond to crisis. Quick moves by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) offering a rupee dollar swap window to attract NRI deposits stemmed the rupee slide and had to be discontinued due to the positive inflows.

Even before the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MOSPI) released the first quarter data on August 31, the high frequency indicators were already telling the story of a strong growth spurt in the months when everything went wrong. Industrial production, vehicle registration, goods exports, corporate earnings were showing green. The 7.8% first quarter GDP growth is built on both manufacturing growing at 9.2% and services at

10%, with both consumption and capital formation doing well.

A gym body does not happen overnight. It takes years of careful eating and regular workouts. The steadiness of the Indian economy today comes on the back of tough decisions and financial prudence manoeuvred by the finance minister and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). The hawk-like focus on the fiscal deficit number post-Covid has reduced it to 4.4%, down a full 200 basis points from FY 2022-23. This

gave the government elbow room to absorb the oil price shock, removing the risk of runaway inflation. The push to manufacturing, and exports, and the focus on deregulation and decriminalisation of laws are all arrows in the quiver of reform. But sceptics remain unconvinced.

The biggest criticism is that the government reduced last year's numbers to make this year look good. One former finance secretary has made the allegation that Q1 FY26 numbers were reduced to give the 7.8% number. The problem with this argument is that data from two different statistical series are being taken and compared.

Think of it this way: If the measuring tape changes, you have to go back and use the new tape to measure last year's data to remeasure before you compare it with the present.

We know that India is in the process of moving to a new GDP series with a new base year — all countries do this. For the Q1 2026-27

estimate, the statistical system is effectively dealing with two different series — the older series and the new series — and the historical data have been revised to make the new series comparable.

There is an additional problem with the argument that data is fudged. The GDP computation maps billions of transactions across millions of aggregated data points, collected from diversified sources. It is humanly impossible to tinker with these data points in any meaningful manner.

The methodology has been developed after vast consultations over the past few years and the use of actual data, not just surveys, has been a change for the better.

For example, there are data sets that report on GST data, industrial production, consumption of steel, air traffic, results of listed companies, deposit and credit growth, vehicle sales data from e-VAHAN, food offtake data, tolls collected and many more.

The argument then moves to inflation: Inflation data is wrong because prices 'feel' higher. It is impossible to build a metric that takes into account the inflation experience of each individual. The average height of a class might be five feet, but there will be individuals much shorter or taller.

Averages are important to compare the direction of change as well as to allow us to collapse into a number the average experience of the group.

So, if inflation 'feels' higher to you,



Monika Halan



### WHAT IS THE REAL CONSTRAINT ON INDIA'S NUCLEAR AMBITION?

{ RAHUL TONGIA } RESEARCHER

## Nuclear ecosystem's big risk is safe fuel supply, not finance

Nuclear power divides people. While some environmentalists value its zero-carbon energy, others worry about its safety, weapons potential, and waste-management risks, not to mention cost, especially when renewable energy is getting cheaper. But many countries are eyeing it for the same reason India is: energy security. NITI Aayog's net-zero study projected a cost-effective greener pathway would need ~100 GW of nuclear power by 2047, a more than 10x growth from now.

Many supporters of nuclear power projects in India have held the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act, 2010, responsible for making it difficult for India to attract foreign entrants. Now, India has signed the SHANTI Act, 2025, which caps the liability for nuclear power system developers, specifically removing the automatic liability for equipment suppliers. This is vital since the operator could be Indian but equipment would invariably come from abroad.

Traditionally, India's nuclear power programme was domestically based, with a three-phase plan going from natural uranium — in Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs) — to plutonium in fast breeder reactors, to thorium-based reactors over time. To accelerate the installed capacity of nuclear power, India opened up its sector to international collaboration, including under the A123 deal signed with the US in 2008. It was a period of hope, but few global partnerships materialised — Russia being a notable exception, with work on the Kudankulam plant predating the A123 deal.

The SHANTI Act is a welcome move, but will it suffice? To truly scale nuclear power, India's planning will have to think beyond just liability towards a more holistic view of risk.

Global experience, especially with international collaborations, shows that the real risks for nuclear power beyond accidents span cost overruns to never getting built. With that lens, we need to look at other dimensions.

Finance is the easiest to scope. Is the global supplier bringing in capital? At what rate? In rupees? Is the project set up to be paid in fixed Rs/kWh electricity or is it a capex play (leaving operations as a risk)?

For India, details about fuel and fuel cycles matter more. But when it comes to nuclear power plants, India chose PHWR technology, which is not what most countries use. India lacks enrichment facilities to convert natural uranium, which can only be directly used PHWRs. Enrich a little Lightly Enriched Uranium (LEU) and it's usable in light water reactors (LWRs), but enrich much more and you can make a bomb.

Thus, for typical reactors based on LEU, India would need a secure supply for fuel. This is before considering the question of what happens to spent fuel. Will the supplier be willing to take it back?

Established infrastructure players such as Tatas, Adani, National Thermal Power Corpo-



ration have expressed interest in nuclear power. They would all need to build contracts around not just nuclear technology (hardware) but also assured fuel supply. India is in a position to ask for not just fuel but even LEU production facilities as part of a package deal. India can ameliorate global concerns by placing such facilities and linked reactors open to external inspections. Such facilities would take time. Is that worth it? Given the scale of nuclear power planned, it should be, and initially, LEU fuel can be imported.

If one is making a wish list, new fuel cycles, especially based on thorium, which India has in abundance, are worth developing. Not only does this address fuel security, such fuel cycles can also lead to lower spent fuel nuclear waste problems.

Let's say that the entire deal is worked out as a package. A mix of entities come together and offer technology, finance, and LEU fuel. And the plant gets built and starts running. The question remains: How sure are we that fuel would be available for a lifespan of 50+ years? How does a country manage the risk of geopolitical considerations trumping commercial ones? These aspects aren't independent — technology transfer can be both commercial and strategic, where the intellectual property owner doesn't want the buyer to end up becoming a competitor.

Ultimately, the SHANTI Act is a vital step forward, but the real work now moves to building the ecosystems around new nuclear power technologies. India will have to take explicit calls on the interplay between costs, security, and environmental concerns — the inevitable "energy trilemma" facing policy-makers worldwide.

Rahul Tongia is senior fellow, Centre for Social and Economic Progress (CSEP), a not-for-profit think tank. The views expressed are personal

{ RIA SINHA AND ABHINAV JINDAL } RESEARCHERS

## Nuclear capacity needs new financing tools, patient capital

India's decision to expand nuclear power capacity from around 8 GW to 100 GW by 2047 represents one of the most ambitious infrastructure programmes in the country's history. Achieving this target is expected to require investments of approximately ₹20-22 lakh crore over the next two decades. While much of the policy debate has centred on liability laws, reactor technologies and private-sector participation, India's nuclear ambitions will ultimately depend on whether it can build a financing architecture capable of mobilising capital at unprecedented scale and for sufficiently long durations.

The problem is not simply that nuclear power is presently expensive. It is that the financial ecosystem required to support such long-gestation projects has yet to evolve. A utility-scale solar project in India typically costs ₹3.5-5 crore per MW, while coal-fired plants require around ₹8-10 crore per MW. Large nuclear reactors, by comparison, can cost ₹15-20 crore per MW. Yet the headline capital cost tells only part of the story. Because nuclear projects typically require eight to ten years before generating revenue, financing becomes a critical determinant of project viability.

International studies suggest that financing costs can account for 30%-50% of the levelised cost of nuclear electricity. The Govt's Roadmap for Achieving 100 GW Nuclear Capacity by 2047 assumes a borrowing cost of around 9%, under which Interest During Construction (IDC) alone accounts for nearly 15%-20% of total project cost.

Every additional year of construction delay compounds financing costs, raising tariffs and eroding project economics. While any reduction in cost of capital has a salutary effect on financing costs for the underlying generation technology, in case of nuclear it may have a greater impact on affordability than marginal reductions in engineering or equipment costs.

Private investment will also depend on the underlying risk-return equation. Investors compare nuclear projects with renewable energy, transmission, battery storage and other infrastructure assets that often require lower upfront investment, shorter construction periods and lower execution risk. If expected returns are broadly similar, capital naturally gravitates towards projects with lower opportunity costs and faster capital recycling.

Equally important is recognising that balance-sheet financing alone may not deliver a 100 GW programme. Even India's largest public enterprises and industrial groups cannot indefinitely lock up enormous amounts of capital in projects that may take a decade before generating cash flows. At the scale envisioned, India would need to mobilise roughly ₹1 lakh crore every year for more than two decades.

Nuclear projects may also require a larger viability-gap-funding (VGF) envelope than solar, wind or battery storage because of their much higher upfront capital needs and construction risk. Rather than relying on one-time budgetary support, VGF could be combined with low-cost long-tenor loans, construction-period interest



subvention, sovereign or partial credit guarantees, and post-commissioning refinancing. The objective should be to use public support to crowd in commercial capital, not replace it.

India today has insurance companies, pension funds and provident funds managing assets worth well over ₹100 lakh crore, yet little of this long-term capital reaches nuclear infrastructure or green infrastructure more broadly. A post-commissioning refinancing market through infrastructure bonds, InvIT-like structures or other long-tenor instruments could release bank and sponsor capital for subsequent reactors.

Construction risk also needs sharper allocation. Delays arising from changes in law, regulatory approvals or force majeure should not be treated like delays caused by weak project management or contractor underperformance. Automatically passing all IDC to consumers weakens incentives for efficient execution. Costs should instead be borne by the parties best placed to manage them.

International experience offers useful lessons. France relied heavily on state-backed utility finance; South Korea combined utility finance with policy-bank support and standardised fleet construction; and China has used State-owned utilities and banks alongside domestic manufacturing. India has already undertaken important regulatory reforms to enable wider participation and strengthen domestic manufacturing. Financial innovation can reinforce these reforms. Existing instruments, public financial institutions, infrastructure bonds, credit guarantees, long-tenor lending, insurance and institutional capital provide a base that can be adapted rather than built from scratch. Used in a coordinated manner, they can lower financing costs, recycle capital and make nuclear projects progressively more investable. India's 100 GW target, therefore, is more a financial innovation challenge.

Ria Sinha is senior fellow, Chintan Research Foundation and Abhinav Jindal is a senior economist. The views expressed are personal



The steadiness of the Indian economy today comes on the back of tough decisions and financial prudence manoeuvred by the finance minister and the Reserve Bank of India.

HT ARCHIVE

then it simply means that your consumption basket is not the average CPI basket. The July inflation point at 4.45% is well below the higher 6% band that RBI must not breach.

Then it shifts to the falling rupee. The rupee is falling, and that shows the weakness of the economy. But what is less understood is that the weakness of the rupee is related to inflation being managed and kept within a band of 2% to 6% by the RBI. A country has to choose between running an independent monetary policy that is setting interest rates to manage inflation, and a fixed exchange rate. India has chosen the former as runaway inflation is harmful to everyone.

If exchange rates are market-linked, then the rupee will react to market forces. RBI's quick action in gathering NRI dollars has stopped both the rupee slide and the doomsday talking heads. But, what about stock markets, they are still down. True. While the domestic investment cycle is gathering momentum, the

global capital flows remain an important source of volatility. Remember that the world is at its most unstable since the two world wars. However, July and August have seen the beginnings of a return of FII money into Indian equity, with net inflows of around ₹50,000 crore over the two months, after months of net outflows.

India is in a unique position in the world with high growth rates and low inflation amidst a very difficult global environment which is unlikely to change anytime soon. At the government, corporate and individual level we must not let down the guard.

And while we should criticise the government for urban planning, air quality, corruption and so on, the macroeconomic stability that has come by design and not chance, must be celebrated.

Monika Halan is the best-selling author of the Let's Talk series of books on money.

The views expressed are personal



WORLD



'Canada ready for US trade deal that benefits both sides'

OTTAWA: Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said on Thursday his government was ready to sign a trade deal with the US that benefits both countries, adding any agreement would need to have stability and credibility.

REUTERS

Trump admin's bid limiting birthright citizenship blocked

WASHINGTON: A US federal judge on Wednesday blocked the Trump administration from enforcing a new executive order limiting who qualifies for birthright citizenship. The move thwarts President Donald Trump's latest attempt to restrict the constitutional right, which comes after the US Supreme Court rejected his previous effort.

AFP

Apple faces \$2.7bn UK lawsuit over app tracking rules

LONDON: Apple is facing a £2 billion (\$2.7 billion) London lawsuit brought on behalf of app developers over its app tracking rules, with the iPhone maker accused of abusing its power to unfairly impose greater restrictions on third parties.

REUTERS

37 die from fumes during oil pipeline theft in Nigeria

PORT HARCOURT: At least 37 people died on Thursday in Nigeria's oil-rich southern Niger Delta after inhaling fumes during the theft of fuel from a pipeline, a local NGO said.

AFP

Iran targets Kuwait even as it mourns victims of US strike

Reuters

letters@hindustantimes.com

DUBAI: Iranian mourners carried caskets on Thursday at a funeral for victims of a US airstrike said to have struck a wedding party, and Tehran launched missiles and drones overnight at a US base in Kuwait, after the war's biggest escalation in more than a month.

Mourners assembled in the late afternoon outside the village of Kuhestak in Sirik County, along a stretch of the coast of the Strait of Hormuz that was hit by heavy US airstrikes late on Tuesday.

Iranian officials say four people died and nearly 70 were wounded by a strike that hit a home during a wedding. State TV reported on Thursday that a fifth person, a 22-year-old woman, had since died in hospital.

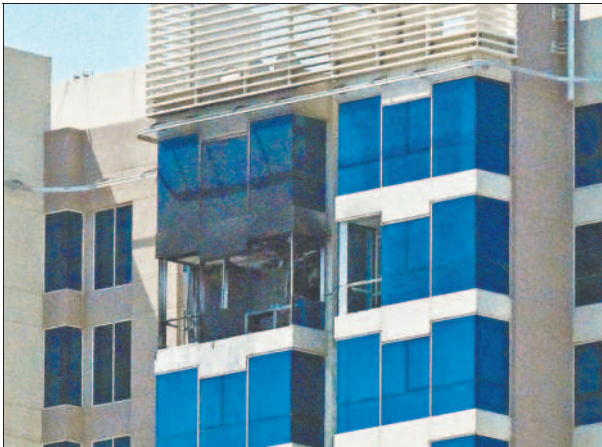
The US military said it was aware of the Iranian reports but that it "never targets civilians".

"This is the body of Martyr Amir-Mohammad Karimi, a 4-year-old child who was martyred in an attack on the country's south by the criminal American regime," a reporter from Iran's Mehr news agency said in footage filmed in front of a pickup truck carrying a flag-draped coffin beneath a canopy of palm fronds.

In other footage of the funeral, mourners threw petals into the air as doleful music played from a loudspeaker. A casket was carried past a row of soldiers standing at attention with rifles.

"If it was a military location, it wouldn't be so painful. This was a wedding ceremony, but they turned people's joy into mourning," the semi-official Tasnim news agency quoted a local man as saying.

Washington launched the airstrikes on Tuesday, hitting what it said were military targets along the coast in retaliation for Iranian attacks on shipping in the Strait of



A residential building was damaged following an Iranian drone attack in Kuwait City on Thursday.

AFP

SEAFARERS' DEATHS: SAUDI ACCUSES IRAN OF ATTACK ON TANKER

RIYADH: Saudi Arabia has claimed that Iran targeted an oil tanker, the Sids, as it transited through the Strait of Hormuz, resulting in fatalities among the vessel's crew.

In an official statement, Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs expressed stern condemnation of the action.

In the statement, Riyadh extended its condemnation to broader regional military action, citing Iranian attacks directed at Jordan, Bahrain, and Kuwait.

ANI

HEGSETH EXTENDS U.S. DEPLOYMENT INTO 2027 IN WEST ASIA

NEW DELHI: US defence secretary Pete Hegseth has extended West Asia military deployment in a sign that the war could drag well into next year, the Wall Street Journal (WSJ) reported on Thursday.

The deployment of 19 warships, air defence units, fighter squadrons and paratroopers in US war campaign against Iran, is straining service members, the Journal reported, quoting people familiar with the matter.

HTC

out further attacks early on Thursday, saying it was targeting another US base, in Kuwait.

Kuwait's military said its air defences had intercepted missiles and drones.

The month of August was largely quiet in the Gulf after US President Donald Trump abruptly halted two weeks of intensive airstrikes in July, having been warned by his military that Washington was running low on munitions.

Hormuz. The sudden escalation of the Iran war has caused a surge in oil prices to levels unseen since July. Price rose for a fourth straight day on Thursday, taking Brent crude futures over \$96 a barrel.

Iran reported 18 dead in the last US assault, including the four killed at the wedding. It responded on Wednesday to the US strikes with attacks on US bases in Iraq, Jordan, Qatar, Kuwait and Bahrain, and carried

{ UKRAINE WAR } DEAL TO SUPPLY ARTILLERY SHELLS

Estonian defence minister quits over botched EU-funded deal involving Indian firm

HTC & Agencies

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Estonia's defence minister Hanno Pevkur resigned from government following a furore over a botched European Union-funded deal to buy artillery shells for Ukraine from a company owned by an Indian entity, which denied allegations of wrongdoing.

Pevkur, who has been in office since 2022, announced his decision in a TV appearance late on Wednesday. He has been the longest-serving minister since Estonia gained independence in 1991 and is well-known internationally.

On Wednesday, Estonian newspaper Eesti Ekspress reported that in 2024 Estonia made a deal for shells with Italian-registered company Datasel SRL, which, it stated, is owned by the Indian company Neco Defence Munitions. Neither firm had produced shells before, it reported.

Pevkur has been facing calls to resign after the Estonian Prosecu-



Hanno Pevkur

AFP

tor's Office opened a criminal investigation into the ammunition procurement process that had been plagued by long delivery delays and inferior products.

Ramesh Jayaswal, director at Jayaswal NECO Industries — the parent company of NECO Defence System Pvt Ltd — disputed the reporting and told HT: "We supplied artillery shells following quality checks by concerned Estonian officials. They subsequently awarded us more contracts but later halted them due to a lack of funds."

The funding for the deal was provided by the EU as part of a

multi-billion-euro effort to shore up Kyiv's weapons stocks at a time when 155mm artillery shells were in short supply. The defence ministry's procurement agency made large upfront payments to the company in 2024 to secure deliveries.

Estonian defence officials have also launched a lawsuit against the supplier at a European arbitration court. Pevkur faced a grilling by lawmakers at a public special committee session on Wednesday morning. He called the situation an "ordinary contract dispute", that had to be judged in the context of international pressure to urgently aid Kyiv's defences against Russia's invasion amid a global shortage of weapons supply.

Estonia's defence procurement agency has prided itself for being fast and nimble, putting it in a position to act as a facilitator for other European nations buying weapons for Ukraine. It has executed around 400 million (\$464 million) in contracts on behalf of international donors, according to Pevkur.

Deadlock in US over Russia sanctions bill

Shashank Mattoo

letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: The political deadlock over the Sanctioning Russia Act — which threatens up to 100% tariffs on India and four other countries for buying Russian energy — continued in Washington on Thursday, despite an intense lobbying effort by Ukraine to secure the bill's passage in the House of Representatives.

Influential Congressman Gregory Meeks — who has led opposition within the Democratic party to the bill — met with Vladyslav Vlasniuk, a top adviser to Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, who has backed the bill.

Meeks emerged from the meeting on Wednesday stating publicly that he will continue to oppose the bill on the grounds that it grants too much tariff authority to President Trump.

Meeks' statement comes amid disagreements within the opposition Democratic party about the bill. Members of the party in the Senate were enthusiastic backers of the bill, playing a role in its passage in the upper house by a decisive 86-12 margin. The lawmakers have urged their colleagues in the House to pass the Sanctioning Russia Act, complete with the tariff provisions. For his part, Meeks has called for a "good-faith compromise" that would place eco-

nomics pressure on Russia to end the war while addressing concerns like-minded lawmakers have about the tariff provisions.

These disagreements continue even as the House of Representatives and the Senate reconvened this week after a recess in August. Persons aware of the matter on Capitol Hill told HT that substantial uncertainty remained as to when the bill would be introduced for a vote. The Democratic Party will attempt to bridge internal divides through this week, minority leader Representative Hakeem Jeffries was quoted as saying in US media reports.

Some believed that the visit of China's President Xi Jinping in

'NEPAL NEEDS TO REBUILD NEARLY 20,000 HOUSES IN FLOOD-HIT AREAS'

Reuters

letters@hindustantimes.com

KATHMANDU: Nepal will have to rebuild around 20,000 houses in flood-ravaged areas, authorities said on Thursday, as rescuers continued to search for workers trapped in tunnels linked to hydropower projects and thousands remain missing after last week's catastrophe.

A glacier collapse on August 26 sent a deluge of ice, rock and mud sweeping through the impoverished nation's border region with China, wiping out settlements and villages and leaving few houses standing and undamaged.

"Our preliminary estimates are that 7,500 houses have been completely destroyed, either washed away or buried under debris and mud," Dharmaraj Upreti, chief of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRMA), told Reuters.

Even houses still standing were not habitable, Upreti said, with authorities estimating that around 20,000 houses would have to be rebuilt in different, safer locations. At least 1,252 people were killed in Nepal last week as houses, streets and schools in towns and villages near the border with China's Tibet were swept away.

BUSINESS

Powered by  
mint

Nvidia buys AI platform Hugging Face for \$13 bn

Reuters

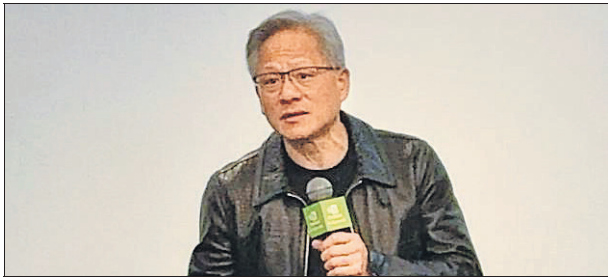
feedback@livemint.com

BENGALURU: Nvidia will buy popular developer platform Hugging Face for \$12.93 billion, betting that support for open AI models will drive future demand even as its biggest customers develop their own chips to reduce reliance on the semiconductor giant.

Shares of the company were up 1.5% after the deal was announced on Thursday, which ranks among its biggest.

The deal will cement Nvidia as a central player in the market for open models that users can freely download, run and customise, unlike the closed systems built by OpenAI and Anthropic. Nvidia has already played an active role in backing the open AI industry with its widely used Nemotron model.

Acquiring Hugging Face will give it direct access to a platform developers use to collaborate, test and share tools using various open AI models, potentially providing valuable insight and data to help it narrow the tech-



Jensen Huang, CEO, Nvidia.

AFP

nology gap with top U.S. and Chinese labs.

Demand for open-weight models has surged from businesses balking at the steep bill of deploying the technology, with Chinese companies such as DeepSeek and Z.ai emerging as crucial players with models that can match the best from the U.S. in tasks, including generating computer code at a lower cost.

That surge has fueled fears that some American firms could become reliant on Beijing's models as both countries race to dominate a technology they see as crucial to their future.

"Hugging Face will remain an

open platform for the entire AI ecosystem," Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang said, adding that his company's chips would not be required to build on or deploy through Hugging Face.

Under the deal, Nvidia will pay about \$11.9 billion to Hugging Face investors, while offering an equity-based retention program of up to \$1 billion for employees who join Nvidia.

The two companies already work together to help developers use Nvidia's computing services on the platform.

Hugging Face was valued at \$4.5 billion in its last disclosed funding round in August 2023,

when it raised \$235 million from investors such as Salesforce, AMD and Amazon.

Nvidia, meanwhile, exited its July quarter with \$22.44 billion in cash and cash equivalents, more than double January's \$10.61 billion, giving the chipmaker substantial capacity to fund the deal.

That financial strength reflects a rapidly expanding business. Late last month, Nvidia issued a rare year-ahead outlook, forecasting revenue growth of about 70% in fiscal 2028 as the AI infrastructure boom rages on.

But the chipmaker's use of its balance sheet has also drawn scrutiny. Deals such as its agreement to guarantee up to \$105 billion for OpenAI's Ohio data-center lease have intensified investor concerns that Nvidia is supporting the demand driving its growth. For Nvidia, building up open source may help it cushion a demand slowdown from customers such as Meta, OpenAI and Microsoft, which are developing their own AI chips to cut reliance on its costly and supply-constrained processors.

India awaits comparative advantage to seal US deal

Rajeev Jayaswal

letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The government is focused on maximising the utilisation of free trade agreements (FTAs) after securing preferential access to two-thirds of the global market through nine trade deals, commerce minister Piyush Goyal said on Thursday, even as India is on course to forge several more FTAs with major economies such as the US, Canada and Chile.

Goyal, who is scheduled to visit the US later this month, said finalisation of the interim bilateral trade agreement (BTA) with Washington awaits a tariff structure that gives India a comparative advantage over its competitors.

India and the US finalised a framework for an interim BTA on February 2, but an agreement could not be signed after the US Supreme Court invalidated the legal basis for the preferential tariff Washington had offered.

"As soon as the US is able to give us the preferential rate in comparison to our competition, we will finalise the BTA and announce the final details," Goyal said at a workshop on FTA utilisation.

India has concluded nine



Piyush Goyal, commerce and industry minister.

PTI

FTAs under the Narendra Modi government, ensuring that each provides Indian exporters a comparative advantage in the respective markets, Goyal said. Since 2021, India has signed and operationalised FTAs with Mauritius, the United Arab Emirates (UAE), Australia, the European Free Trade Association (EFTA), Oman and the UK. FTAs with New Zealand and the EU are in the process of being operationalised, while the framework of an interim BTA with the US has been agreed, pending finalisation of the tariff architecture.

According to trade experts, India is facing several tariff actions by the US. A 10% tariff has already been imposed on several labour-intensive goods this July for alleged use of forced

labour under Section 301, they said, requesting anonymity. The threat of another penal tariff is looming as the US has launched another Section 301 investigation into alleged excess industrial capacity. All such uncertainties must be resolved to conclude a fair, equitable and mutually beneficial trade agreement, they said.

Apart from the India-US BTA, India is expected to conclude several bilateral trade deals over the next few months to couple of years, Goyal said, referring to ongoing talks with Canada, Mexico, Chile, Mercosur, the Southern African Customs Union (SACU), the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) and Israel. Referring to these potential trade deals, along with ongoing efforts to review and expand existing FTAs with ASEAN, South Korea and Japan, Goyal said such trade arrangements would secure greater market access and give India access to 75% of global trade at rates lower than those faced by its competitors.

Government officials, who did not want to be named, said India is very close to finalising a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) with Chile, a country rich in critical minerals.

SEBI PLANS PAPER ON CLOSING AUCTION SESSION

Apoorva Ajith

apoorva.ajith@livemint.com

MUMBAI: The stock market regulator on Thursday said it will review how settlement prices for derivative contracts are determined, following industry feedback on the impact of the new closing auction session (CAS) on expiry-day pricing. A consultation paper proposing changes to the methodology is likely next week, even as the one-month-old CAS remains marred by low participation and occasional abrupt price swings.

Designed to enhance pricing transparency, CAS was introduced in the equity cash segment for 213 derivative-traded stocks on 3 August. The closing price, established by matching the maximum number of buy and sell orders in the last 15 minutes of trading, is also used to determine settlement prices for derivative contracts on expiry.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India said it had monitored the functioning of CAS closely and held discussions with market participants.

Under the CAS framework, market participants once used to full price visibility at the day's end now wait in suspense, as the auction and pricing mechanism plays out over the last 15 minutes. On Thursday, the BSE Sensex plunged about 2,100 points in the first five minutes of the auction session, only to recover soon after. The index ultimately closed 417 points lower at 76,152.86.

Trade volumes during CAS declined 24.3% from 3 August to 19.6 million on 28 August, while the trade value dropped 26% to ₹944.94 crore, NSE data showed. Participation recovered at the end of the month following the MSCI index rebalancing on 31 August. By 3 September, volumes rose by 4.7%, while value rose 14.2% to ₹1,457.74 crore.

It was not only the cash market which was struggling about half of the volume and value in Bank Nifty futures vanished since CAS was introduced.

Volumes fell 42% to 14,180 contracts, while value declined similarly to ₹2,445.72 crore on 2 September.

KENYA ORDERS TATA CHEMICALS TO STOP ITS OPS

Reuters

feedback@livemint.com

NAIROBI: Kenya's President William Ruto said on Thursday he had ordered India's Tata Chemicals to stop its operations in Kenya, saying its presence had failed to benefit the country.

Ruto said the government would bring in two new companies to take over operations for Tata Chemicals.

"That Tata company ... had that contract for 100 years. They have not built anything in Kajiado," Ruto said during a visit to the region in southern Kenya.

Tata clears key hurdle in chairman search

Bloomberg

feedback@livemint.com

Tata Trusts said it received relief in a regulatory probe, potentially allowing the controlling shareholder of Tata Group's holding company to resume business as usual as it seeks to pick a new chairman. The Trusts received an order from the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner dated September 2, closing a complaint related to a 1989 share transfer, according to a statement Thursday. That complaint had triggered restrictions that prevented one of the Trusts from convening internal meetings.

The relief comes as a boost at

a time of heightened leadership uncertainty triggered by Natarajan Chandrasekaran's unexpected decision to step down as chairman of Tata Sons Pvt. Sir Ratan Tata Trust, one of the 13 Tata charities, had been unable to nominate a member for the new chairman-selection process because of the curbs.

Tata Trusts owns 66% in Tata Sons — which oversees the listed companies of the sprawling group that owns Taj hotels to Tetley tea. The 32 companies under the group's umbrella — of which 26 are publicly listed — generated a combined revenue of about \$185 billion in the year ended March 31.

THE RELIEF COMES AS A BOOST AT A TIME OF HEIGHTENED LEADERSHIP UNCERTAINTY

The Charity Commissioner's probe relates to a petition filed by Vijay Singh, a trustee of Tata Trusts. He alleged that 833 Tata Sons shares were improperly transferred from the Navajbai Ratan Tata Trust to Naval H. Tata without fair consideration, valid documentation, or proper approvals. These shares were subsequently inherited by

Naval's sons — Ratan, Noel, and Jimmy Tata. Tata Trusts said the allegations were "part of a willful, malicious and orchestrated campaign" to discredit the Tata Group's philanthropic arm.

The dismissal of the complaint strengthens the position of Noel Tata, head of Tata Trusts, at a moment when the group is seeking to reassure shareholders, market regulators and policymakers about its stability. It also bolsters confidence that the conglomerate can continue delivering on initiatives central to PM Narendra Modi's ambitions to turn India into a global technology and manufacturing powerhouse.



## SPORT

# BCCI backs Rohit, says too much cricket hurting team

In review meeting among stakeholders, many concern areas were raised with no easy solutions

Rasesh Mandani

rasesh.mandani@htlive.com

**MUMBAI:** "Rohit Sharma is playing superbly in all matches. So what more do you want?" With that rhetorical expression, BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia gave the former India captain additional time to convince the selectors that he had the required mileage for another ODI World Cup campaign.

Saikia's media comments came minutes after attending a BCCI forward-planning gathering that also comprised ODI captain Shubman Gill and head coach Gautam Gambhir.

The national selection committee led by Ajit Agarkar had noticed signs of slumping benchmarks in the 39-year-old's batting tempo and overall fitness standards. But that was before India's last ODI at Lord's in July where Rohit struck a powerful 110-ball 138, batting for 39 overs after spending 50 overs on the field. Although cramps troubled him toward the back-half of that innings, it was a statement knock under immense pressure in light of speculations of impending retirement.

The next World Cup is a little over a year away, which can quickly look distant at 39; but for now, Rohit has the board's backing. "In the last match, he scored 138 runs, so why is there speculation? I don't want to give fodder for speculators," said Saikia.

To make it to the 2027 World Cup, which Saikia called "the ultimate goal" for the Indian cricket team, Rohit will take fresh guard against West Indies starting September 27.

## Too much cricket

The two-hour "soul searching" exercise as Saikia put it, was an attempt to iron out past scheduling and planning shortcomings, which manifested as inconsistent Test cricket performances and a decline in white-ball results across bilateral series.

"There are too many matches in the year," Saikia admitted. After winning the T20 World Cup, India has undertaken trips to Ireland and England. They are scheduled to play Afghanistan in Delhi next, followed by the Asian Games in Japan, then away matches against New Zealand, before closing the year with home matches against Sri Lanka. Few teams engage in such a spread of bilateral cricket, that too across formats.

The ODI team's engagements



(Clockwise L-R) File image of Rohit Sharma; Gautam Gambhir and Shreyas Iyer; VVS Laxman, Shubman Gill in Mumbai on Thursday.

ANSHUMAN POYREKAR/HT/PT/ANI

are equally busy. A case in point is the upcoming West Indies ODI series clashing with the Asian Games, forcing the selectors to release some ODI regulars for the T20 medal hunt. BCCI's fostering of boardroom friendships has also contributed to an overcrowded calendar, leaving even Indian cricket's vast bench strength, strained.

"In the next FTP (future tours programme), we will take certain measures. We have instructed that our FTP should be such that there is proper rest for the players as well. (They have) some kind of acclimatisation or friendly matches before any major series in SENA (South Africa, England, New Zealand, Australia) countries," the board secretary said.

In the immediate future, the Test team will face the brunt of a jam-packed itinerary. A shadow tour comprising three four-day matches has been scheduled before the New Zealand Test-series in November, which will

determine India's chances for the World Test Championship final. But a bulk of that action will run parallel with India's white-ball action in New Zealand. Gill will be among several other two-format players who will have to pick and choose. It's precisely such ill-planned schedules that Gill has raised concerns over in the past, and he is known to have made his views known again in the meeting.

For next year's marquee series against Australia, the team management sentiment is that the batters should get a platform to improve their play against the turning ball, allowing them to push for turning tracks. That can be achieved by preparing challenging pitches in the upcoming A series at home against Australia, but it could also be counter-productive, helping the opponents sharpen their game. The operations team led by BCCI General Manager Abey Kuruvilla is tasked with devising a strategy for India to regain Test

dominance at home.

## Fitness protocols

The excessive matches have also hit the players' fitness hard, but there are other structural shortcomings at the Centre of Excellence (COE) too. The swanky new COE facility in Bengaluru has been without a sports science head for nearly 18 months. On the record, Saikia played down the impact of a leadership vacuum in the sports science wing. "I would like to reiterate once more that the vacant position of the head of sports science is not a deterrent to our activities in COE. That post is required (to be filled), but that is a very high-level post and a proper qualified person should be positioned," he said.

There were discussions, though, that return-to-play protocols would have to be strengthened. Both Gill and Gambhir are known to have given feedback on ways to avoid in-tournament player breakdowns, of which

there have been many recently. Nitish Reddy, Washington Sundar, Harshit Rana and Varun Chakravarthy were unable to complete the series in which they were picked after experiencing muscle injuries.

## Agarkar's future

There have also been some concerns over instances of the selection committee's lack of communication with the team management and the COE. Those issues could not be addressed in Agarkar's absence. The chief selector was out of town and in a no-network zone. Agarkar's current tenure ends this month amid speculations over his continuation, even though he is eligible for a year's extension. The BCCI is expected to have discussions with Agarkar soon.

The BCCI refuted reports of VVS Laxman being considered for a higher role of Director of Cricket. "We haven't had any such discussions, nor do we have such an intention," said Saikia.

# Record-breaking day for Smriti as India have it easy

Samreen Razzaqui

samreen.razzaqui@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Few things in cricket match the sight of Smriti Mandhana when she enters a flow state. Against Hong Kong, she found that rhythm and never quite let go, producing a sublime 124 off 64 balls to help India win by 137 runs in their Asia Cup fixture in Dubai on Thursday.

The Indian bowling line-up backed up Mandhana with a commanding display to bowl Hong Kong out for 56 runs, unsurprisingly led by Deepti Sharma (3/9) who also became the leading wicket-taker in T20Is with 174 wickets. Prema Rawat, Shree Charani and Nandini Sharma picked up two wickets apiece.

The opener from Sangli reached her highest individual score in T20Is, while also surpassing Mithali Raj to become the highest run-scorer in women's international cricket.

It's not as if Mandhana never has an off day. But she has shown time and again that she cannot remain quiet for too long, reinforcing her reputation as one of the most consistent and dependable performers not just for India, but in international women's cricket.

Her 10,880 international runs, and counting, have come by age 30, in a career spanning 13 years and precisely 302 matches. Going by the rate at which she is going, she has at least another five years to contribute to the game, making the magnitude of the achievement — and what may still lie ahead — even more exciting. Just last year, she broke the record for the most international runs by a woman in a calendar year, scoring 1,703 runs.

Mandhana's second century

## Rewriting the record books

With 124 against Hong Kong, Mandhana brought up her second T20I ton and broke several records

### Most runs in international cricket

| PLAYER                 | MATCHES    | RUNS           |
|------------------------|------------|----------------|
| <b>Smriti Mandhana</b> | <b>302</b> | <b>10,880*</b> |
| Mithali Raj            | 333        | 10,868         |
| Suzie Bates            | 370        | 10,740         |
| Charlotte Edwards      | 309        | 10,273         |
| Sarah Taylor           | 307        | 10,007         |

### MOST CENTURIES IN INTERNATIONAL CRICKET

| SMRITI MANDHANA | MEG LANNING | LAURA WOLVAARDT |
|-----------------|-------------|-----------------|
| 18              | 17          | 17              |



in the format was also the highest individual score in the Women's T20 Asia Cup, surpassing Chamari Athapaththu's 119\* against Malaysia in 2024.

It was a difficult outing for Hong Kong, who struggled to hit their lengths and exert any real pressure on the Indian batters. Plagued by dropped catches and far too many loose deliveries, they were fortunate to get away early on when Mandhana and Shafali Verma got off to a relatively cautious start. India still reached 60/1 in the Powerplay.

After Shafali fell for 28, and with wickets continuing to tumble at the other end, Mandhana shifted gears to unleash total dominance and take India to 193/5. Such was the impact of her knock that the rest of the middle order's underwhelming show with the bat — the other Indian batters scored 62 from 56 deliveries — will be overshadowed yet again but will need a massive rethink from the

management.

Funnily, it wasn't even Mandhana at her best. Her acceleration came late, but once she settled in, the lines and lengths of the bowlers ceased to matter. She found gaps almost at will, cleared the ropes with ease and, as the innings wore on, made a difficult target look almost inevitable.

"I didn't know all of this happened," Mandhana said on breaking several records en route to her century. "It's really hard for me to play slower bowlers, but credit to them. They were really disciplined in the Powerplay. They bowled pretty well, and the kind of energy they showed was something which we all can learn from. Having said that, I just love batting, and I'm happy that I could contribute."

**Brief scores:** India 193/5 in 20 overs (S Mandhana; M Lampough 2/46) beat Hong Kong 56 all out in 16.2 overs (D Sharma 3/9) by 127 runs.

## { DULEEP TROPHY } FINAL

# Rahul, Padikkal, Siraj asked to play, Vaibhav and Tilak is Gambhir's call

Press Trust of India

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Veteran opener KL Rahul, Sri Lanka series hero Devdutt Padikkal and seasoned pacer Mohammed Siraj have been asked to play the Duleep Trophy final for South Zone against East Zone starting September 6 in Chennai.

It is understood that participation of South Zone skipper Tilak Varma, rising sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and keeper Ishan Kishan, all of whom are in India's T20I team, will depend on approval from India head coach Gautam Gambhir. "Rahul, Padikkal and Siraj do not have any competitive cricket right now. The national selectors want any

India player who is available should play the Duleep Trophy final. The trio played last on August 27. The next they will play is September 27 against West Indies in the ODIs. Now Padikkal is not a part of ODIs so he might play India A series. But Duleep final if there is a chance, they should play," a BCCI source privy to the development told PTI on condition of anonymity.

In the case of Sooryavanshi, Kishan and Tilak, it will be coach Gambhir's prerogative. "The Indian team will assemble in Delhi on either September 9 or 10. If head coach wants all three to report as per T20I team's itinerary, then the trio can't play. But if head coach wants them to play the final and report to Delhi on September 10 late evening,

they can also do that," he added. Even as the mystery surrounding his impending extension remains after he was excused from the all-important BCCI review meeting due to family commitments, chairman of selectors Ajit Agarkar will be in Chennai to watch the Duleep Trophy final. As of now his contract gets over on October 4 and it will be interesting whether BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia discusses the matter of his extension with him.

The BCCI is planning to send Mayank Yadav, Kartik Tyagi and left-arm Mohsin Khan to the Asian Games in Japan to help the Indian team's training session as net bowlers on specific request of head coach VVS Laxman.

# Yashvir comes in for injured Neeraj

HT Correspondent

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Athletics Federation of India (AFI) on Thursday named Yashvir Singh as Neeraj Chopra's replacement for the Asian Games (September 19-October 4) while long-distance runner Abhishek Pal and 110m hurdler Tejas Shirshe have been omitted from the squad. India's track and field squad now stands at 77.

Yashvir, a bronze medalist at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games, expectedly made the cut after duffing out due to a torn ankle ligament. Yashvir will join Rohit Yadav as India's medal hope in men's javelin. The 2023 edition of Asian Games saw a first-ever Indian 1-2 in javelin with Chopra and Kishore Jena taking the top two spots. "We have brought in Yashvir who is a CWG medal winner in place of Neeraj Chopra who is currently injured. It was an injury replacement, so there was no problem (in Yashvir coming in)," AFI President Bahadur Singh Sagoo said in Ludhiana.

Hurdler Shirshe, who made the initial list, sustained two stress fractures in his left foot during the Glasgow CWG, which brought a premature end to his season. "Long-distance runner Abhishek Pal has been dropped because of the issues he is facing. So this is the final team for the Asian Games," Sagoo added.

Abhishek was served notice by the National Anti-Doping Agency



Yashvir Singh.

PTI

(NADA) last month after his sample was found to contain a female fertility drug which officials said was "below threshold level". "It's not a case of (Abhishek) returning dope positive. The presence of the substance was below threshold level. NADA is currently investigating but we did not want to take any risk. So, we have dropped Abhishek from the team," AFI's planning commission chief Lalit Bhanot said.

Shirshe and Abhishek were included in the 73-member Indian athletics team announced by the sports ministry this month. The ministry added six more track and field athletes on Wednesday.

Meanwhile, the list of coaches and support staff released by the ministry features a first-ever Safeguarding Officer in the contingent following a mandate by the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA). Softball Association of India president Neel Narang has been given that charge. She will be the athletes' point of contact for matters related to harassment, abuse or neglect.

# Back from the brink, Asiad-bound Rahi aims for the bullseye yet again

Shantanu Srivastava

sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** When Rahi Sarnobat boards the flight to Japan this month for her third Asian Games, she will have marked a significant personal milestone. Having almost quit four years ago due to neuropathic pain syndrome, Rahi, over 18 excruciating months, found the wherewithal to push her mind and body enough to make it to the Indian team alongside young stars Manu Bhaker and Esha Singh. "It still feels like a dream," Rahi said. "To suddenly lose your skills one day, struggle to get through your days, unlearn, relearn, and somehow be good enough to compete for India... it's a rebirth of sorts."

A gold medalist in the 2018 edition, Rahi remains the only Indian to win an individual 25m pistol gold at the Asiad. The Indian shooting landscape, particularly in pistol disciplines, has undergone a sea change since then. The squad has become younger, the scores have gone higher, and the medal count in elite competitions has become more consistent. "I still feel I am relevant. That said, shooting is not the centre of my life anymore," she said.

That's because, in the autumn of 2022, Rahi woke up one morning with her right leg immobile. "I knew that instant my shooting career was over," she remembered. A world No.1 just a year

## On comeback trail

Pistol veteran **Rahi Sarnobat**, having recovered from neuropathic pain syndrome, will represent India in her pet 25m pistol event at the Asian Games. A quick look at her career:

### AT ASIAN GAMES

|                                       |                                             |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bronze in Incheon, 2014 (team)</b> | <b>Gold in Palembang, 2018 (individual)</b> |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|

### AT WORLD CUPS (individual only)

|                               |                             |                             |                                  |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Gold in Changwon, 2013</b> | <b>Gold in Munich, 2019</b> | <b>Gold in Osijek, 2021</b> | <b>Silver in New Delhi, 2021</b> |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|

before, Rahi spent the next 18 months recovering from neuropathic pain syndrome. A chronic condition affecting the nervous system, it left her dealing with debilitating pain across her body. "Everything from my eyelashes to my toe pained. Just getting through the day was a task. Pain became a constant companion, the mind began to play tricks

too...sometimes, on a perfectly sunny day, I would feel drenched. There were times when sitting on a sofa, I would feel my body sinking into quicksand. It was crazy."

Rahi began taking baby steps into shooting in 2023 and only now is she completely off medication. Her return necessitated technical and equipment resets. She shed 20kg, tweaked her pis-



VIPIN KUMAR/HT PHOTO

Rahi missed the cut for the Hangzhou Asian Games where Esha announced herself as one of India's leading 25m pistol shooters. Sporadic competitive appearances followed in 2024 without success and Rahi lost her place in the Indian team. "That was a rude shock. It was the first time in 15-17 years that I wasn't good enough to make the Indian team. But I had no option but to stay humble and bide my time."

Rahi's return to the practice range was equally humbling. For an athlete used to training 6-7 hours a day, firing a half-decent shot became tough. "I just couldn't stand still. It needed tremendous mental strength. I had to create neuropathic pathways again. It was a slow process but I kept pushing, one step at a time. It was like starting from scratch," she recalled.

A gold in the 2025 National Games in Uttarakhand was a reminder that the skills hadn't totally deserted her. She made it back to the national squad and competed in Cairo World Championships, Ningbo and Munich editions of World Cup, Asian Championships in Shymkent — all in 2025.

The comeback took a decisive turn in 2026 when Rahi won the selection trials (T4) that pushed her to third in national rankings, behind Esha and Manu. "I had forgotten how to stand still. And here I am, still standing, still fighting."



## Srikanth stuns Lai in China Masters

**SHENZHEN:** Indian shuttler Kidambi Srikanth beat world No.9 Victor Lai of Canada 21-18, 21-19 to enter the men's singles quarter-finals of China Masters. Men's doubles pair of Chirag Shetty and Satwiksairaj Rankireddy beat French Christo and Toma Jr Popov 21-15, 22-24, 21-9 to reach the quarters.

## Anahat upsets world No.11

**LONDON:** World No.20 Anahat Singh advanced to the quarter-finals of the London Squash Classic with a thrilling 2-1 win over 11th-ranked Nele Gilis here on Thursday, winning 13-11, 4-11, 11-8 in 39 minutes.

## Rahul, Rathika bag squash titles

**MUMBAI:** Rahul Baitha and Rathika Suthanthira Seelan clinched the men's and women's titles, respectively, in the 49th Bombay Gymkhana Maharashtra State Open Squash Tournament 2026. Baitha beat top seed Om Semwal 2-11, 11-7, 3-11, 11-5, 11-7, while Rathika cruised past Mumbai's Akanksha Salunkhe 11-5, 11-3, 11-3.







# Amul Mithai

## Janmashtami's Purest Offering

Order Amul Mithai online and get delivery in minutes.

**Gulab Jamun**  
1 Kg / ₹270\*

**Malai Peda**  
200 g / ₹130\*

**Kaju Katri**  
200 g / ₹250\*

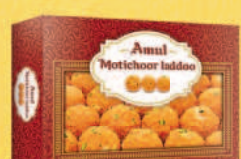
**Milk Cake**  
200 g / ₹140\*

**Amrakhand**  
200 g / ₹60\*

**Panchamrit**

Amul Mithai is made from pure Amul Milk, Amul Ghee and Amul Khoa, enriched with Cardamom and the finest Cashews and Pistachios.

**Amul Mithai**

|                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                      |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |
| <b>Motichoor Laddoo</b><br>200 g / ₹120*<br>500 g / ₹280*                           | <b>Kesar Kaju Katri</b><br>200 g / ₹275*<br>500 g / ₹610*                           | <b>Gud Kaju Katri</b><br>200 g / ₹275*<br>500 g / ₹610*                             | <b>Kaju Katri</b><br>200 g / ₹250*<br>500 g / ₹570*                                  | <b>Malai Peda</b><br>200 g / ₹130*<br>500 g / ₹300*                                   | <b>Badam Pista Shrikhand</b><br>200 g / ₹60*<br>500 g / ₹140*                         | <b>Amrakhand</b><br>200 g / ₹60*<br>500 g / ₹130*                                     | <b>Elaichi Shrikhand</b><br>200 g / ₹55*<br>500 g / ₹125*                             |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |
|  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>Kesar Peda</b><br>200 g / ₹140*<br>500 g / ₹325*                                 | <b>Panchamrit</b><br>(Pack of 5)<br>5 X 10 mL<br>₹25*                               | <b>Khoa Plain</b><br>200 g / ₹105*<br>500 g / ₹250*                                 | <b>Milk Cake</b><br>200 g / ₹140*<br>500 g / ₹325*                                   | <b>Besan Laddoo</b><br>200 g / ₹130*<br>500 g / ₹305*                                 | <b>Dry Fruit Burfi</b><br>200 g / ₹250*                                               | <b>Rasmalai Pista</b><br>100 g / ₹55*<br>500 g / ₹260*                                | <b>Gulab Jamun</b><br>500 g / ₹140*<br>1 Kg / ₹270*                                   | <b>Sugar Free Gulab Jamun</b><br>500 g / ₹220*                                        | <b>Rosogolla</b><br>500 g / ₹125*<br>1 Kg / ₹230*                                     |

Also Try: Kesar Modak, Mysore Pak, Sugar Free Peda, Kala Jamun, Mohanthai, Rajwadi Halwa, Kaju Modak, Angoori Rasmalai, Rabdi, Kheer, Kalakand and Rabdi Jalebi.



SHOP NOW  
Amul  
shop.amul.com



Contact us for corporate orders and gifting.  
E-mail: amulsweets@amul.coop





To Get All The Popular Newspapers.  
Save My Contact Number 8890050582 send Message telegram ya  
Whatsapp

If You Want to get these Newspapers Daily at earliest

## English Newspapers»»»

Indian Express, Financial Express, The Hindu, Business Line, The Times of India, The Economic Times, Hindustan Times, ET wealth, Business Standard, First India, Mint, Greater Kashmir, Greater Jammu, The Himalayan, The Tribune, Brill Express, The Sikh Times, Avenue Mail, Western Times, Millennium Post, The Statesman, State Times, The Pioneer, Hans India, Free Press, Orissa Post, Mumbai Mirror, Mid-Day, Deccan Chronicle, Deccan Herald, Telangana Today, Financial Times, The Asian Age, The Telegraph, Oheraldo, Gulf of Times, The New York Times, The Washington Post, Los Angeles Times, USA Today, The Wall Street Journal, The Guardian, The Times

## Hindi Newspapers»»»

दैनिक जागरण, राजस्थान पत्रिका, दैनिक भास्कर, दिव्यभास्कर, हिंदुस्तान, नवभारत टाइम्स, बिज़नेस स्टैंडर्ड, अमर उजाला, जनसत्ता, द पायोनीर, राष्ट्रीय सहारा, प्रभातखबर, लोकसत्ता

## Others»»»

Hindi & English Editorial, Employment News, Malayalam Newspapers, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Gujarati

Type in Search box of Telegram @NewsTG8 And you will find a Channel named NewsTG join it and receive daily editions of all popular newspapers at the earliest

Or

you can click on this link

<https://t.me/NewsTG8>



# All ENGLISH Newspaper And Magazines

## INDIAN English Newspaper

Deccan Chronicle,  
Economics times,  
Times of India,  
Mirror  
Financial Express,  
Hans india,  
Indian Express,  
New Indian Express NIE  
The Hindu,  
Mint, Newspaper  
Business standard,  
Business Line  
, States Man  
, Tribune, Newspaper  
pioneer Newspaper  
millennium Post Newspaper  
Hitavada Newspaper  
The Daily Guardian,  
The Telegraph  
Eastern Chronicle  
The Goan  
First India  
Free Press Journal  
Mid day English Gujarati  
Maharashtra time  
And also editorials of all English newspapers.  
Etc.....

☪ Also avialble Hindi, Andhra Pradesh Telangana  
kannnada, Malayalam, Tamil Telugu  
language papers ☪  
Bengali | |  
Marathi:  
Kannada  
Mumbai samachar  
Sandesh news paper

The Assam Tribune  
The Goan  
Daily Excelsior  
International Magzine  
International Newspaper  
Gujrati Marathi newspaper  
Urdu Newspaper



***More Newspaper and Magazines Details Search***

***[@Magazines\\_8890050582](https://t.me/Magazines_8890050582)***



**Click Here To Join our  
Telegram Channel**